

Introductory Material (*main file*)

The Pearl	1
Notes to <i>The Pearl</i>	105
Cleanness	37
Notes to <i>Cleanness</i>	[108]
Patience	89
Notes to <i>Patience</i>	[115]
Glossarial Index (<i>separate file</i>)	117

1

THE PEARL.

I.

- Perle plesaunte to prynces paye,
 To clanly clos in golde so clere,
 Oute of oryent I hardyly saye,
 4 Ne proued I neuer her precios pere,
 So rounde, so reken in vche araye,
 So smal, so smoþe her syde3 were.
 Quere-so-euer I lugged gemme3 gaye,
 8 I sette hyr sengeley in synglure;
 Allas! I leste hyr in on erbere,
 þur3 gresse to grounde hit fro me yot;
 I dewyne for-dolked of luf daungere,
 12 Of þat pryuy perle with-uten spot.

[Fol. 3

Description of a lost pearl (*i.e.*
beloved child).

The father laments the loss of
pearl.

yot] ? got.

VISITS HIS CHILD'S GRAVE,

- Syþen in þat spote hit fro me sprange,
 Ofte haf I wayted wyschande þat wele,
 þat wont wat3 whyle deuoyde my wrange,
 16 & heuen my happe & al my hele,
 þat dot3 bot þrych my hert þrange,
 My breste in bale bot bolne & bele.
 3et þo3t me neuer so swete a sange,
 20 As styлле stounde let to me stele,
 For-soþe þer fleten to me fele,
 To þenke hir color so clad in clot;
 O moul þou marre3 a myry mele.
 24 My priuy perle with-uten spotte,

He often visits the spot where
pearl disappeared,

and hears a sweet song.

moul] ? mould.

Where the pearl was buried th
he found lovely flowers.

2

þat spot of spyse3 my3t nede3 sprede,
 þer such ryche3 to rot is runnen;

- Blomeȝ blayke & blwe & rede,
 28 þer schyneȝ ful schyr agayn þe sunne.
 Flor & fryte may not be fede,
 þer hit doun drof in moldeȝ dunne,
 For vch gresse mot grow of grayneȝ dede,
 32 No whete were elleȝ to woneȝ wonne;
 Of goud vche goude is ay by-gonne.
 So semly a sede moȝt fayly not,
 þat sprynɡande spyceȝ vp ne sponne,
 36 Of þat precios perle wyth-uten spotte.

- To þat spot þat I in speche expoun
 I entred in þat erber grene,
 In augoste in a hyȝ seysoun,
 40 Quen corne is coruen wyth crokeȝ kene.
 On huyle þer perle hit trendeled doun,
 Schadowed þis worteȝ ful schyre & schene
 Gilofre, gyngure & gromylyoun,
 44 & pyonys powdered ay by-twene.
 Ȝif hit watȝ semly on to sene,
 A fayr reflowr ȝet fro hit flot,
 þer wonys þat worþyly I wot & wene,
 48 My precious perle, wyth-uten spot.

RE FALLING ASLEEP, HE DREAMS.

- Bifore þat spot my honde I spenn[e]d,
 For care ful colde þat to me caȝt[e];
 A denely dele in my hert denned,
 52 þaȝ resoun sette my seluen saȝt[e].
 I playned my perle þat þer watȝ spenned
 Wyth fyrte skylleȝ þat faste faȝt[e],
 þaȝ kynde of kryst me comfort kenned,
 56 My wreched wylle in wo ay wraȝte.
 I felle vpon þat floury flawt[e],
 Suche odour to my herneȝ schot;
 I slode vpon a slepyng slaȝte,
 60 On þat prec[i]os perle *with*-uten spot.

3

II.

- F**ro spot my spyryt þer sprang in space,
 My body on balke þer bod in sweuen,
 My goste is gon in godeȝ grace,
 64 In auenture þer meruayleȝ meuen;
 I ne wyste in þis worlde quere þat hit wace,
 Bot I knew me keste þer klyfeȝ cleuen;
 Towarde a foreste I bere þe face,
 68 Where rych rokkeȝ wer to dyscreuen;
 þe lyȝt of hem myȝt no mon leuen,
 þe glemande glory þat of hem glent;
 For wern neuer webbeȝ þat wyȝeȝ weuen,
 72 Of half so dere adubmente.

A BEAUTIFUL FOREST,

rot] ? rote.

Each blade of grass springs from
 a dead grain.

sprynɡande] The MS. reads
sprynɡande.

[Fol. 3

In the high season of August the
 parent visits the grave of his little
 child.

Beautiful flowers covered the
 grave.

From them came a delicious
 odour.

The bereaved father wrings his
 hands for sorrow, falls asleep
 upon the flowery plot, and
 dreams.

In spirit he is carried to an
 unknown region,

where the rocks and cliffs
 gleamed gloriously.

Dubbed wern alle þo downeȝ sydeȝ
 With crystal klyffeȝ so cler of kynde,
 Holte-wodeȝ bryȝt aboute hem bydeȝ;
 76 Of bolleȝ as blwe as ble of ynde,
 As bornyst syluer þe lef onslydeȝ,
 Þat þike con trylle on vch a tynde,
 Quen glem of glodeȝ agaynȝ hem glydeȝ,
 80 Wyth schymeryng schene ful schrylle þay schynde.
 Þe grauayl þat on grounde con grynde
 Wern *precious* perleȝ of oryente;
 Þe sunne bemeȝ bot blo & blynde,
 84 In respecte of þat adubement.

The adubemente of þo downeȝ dere
 Garten my goste al greffe for-ȝete
 So frech flauoreȝ of fryteȝ were,
 88 As fode hit con me fayre refete.
 Fowleȝ þer flowen *in* fryth *in* fere,
 Of flaumbande hweȝ, bope smale & grete,
 Bot sytole stryng & gyternere,
 92 Her reken myrþe moȝt not retrete,
 For quen þose bryddeȝ her wyngȝ bete
 Þay songen wyth a swete asent;
 4 So grac[i]os gle coupe no mon gete
 96 As here & se her adubement.

So al watȝ dubbet on dere asyse;
 Þat fryth þer fortwne forth me fereȝ,
 Þe derþe þer-of for to deuyse
 100 Nis no wyȝ worþe þat tonge bereȝ.
 I welke ay forth *in* wely wyse,
 No bonk so byg þat did me dereȝ,
 Þe fyrre *in* þe fryth þe feier con ryse,
 104 Þe playn, þe plontteȝ, þe spyse, þe pereȝ,
 & raweȝ & randeȝ & rych reuereȝ,
 As fyldor fyn her b[o]nkes brent.
 I wan to a water by schore þat schereȝ,
 108 Lorde! dere watȝ hit adubement!

The dubbemente of þo derworth depe
 Wern bonkeȝ bene of beryl bryȝt;
 Swangeande swete þe water con swepe
 112 Wyth a rownande rourde raykande aryȝt;
 In þe founce þer stonden stoneȝ stepe,
 As glente þurȝ glas þat glowed & glyȝt,
 A stremande sterneȝ quen stroþe men slepe,
 116 Staren *in* welkyn *in* wynter nyȝt;
 For vche a pobbel *in* pole þer pyȝt
 Watȝ Emerad, saffer, oþer *gemme* gente,
 Þat alle þe loȝe lemed of lyȝt,
 120 So dere watȝ hit adubement.

AUSES HIS GRIEF TO ABATE.

III.

The dubbement dere of doun & daleȝ,

[Fol. 4

The hill sides were decked wit
 crystal cliffs.

The leaves of the trees were lil
 burnished silver.

The gravel consisted of precio
 pearls.

The father forgets his sorrow.

He sees birds of the most
 beautiful hues,

hweȝ] Or *hiweȝ*.

and hears their sweet melody.

No tongue could describe the
 beauty of the forest.

All shone like gold.

The dreamer arrives at the ban
 a river,

[Fol. 4

which gave forth sweet sounds

In it, stones glittered like stars
A] ? *As*.

in the welkin on a winter night

Of wod & water & wlonk playneȝ,
 Bylde in me blys, abated my baleȝ,
 124 For-didden my [dis]tresse, dystried my payneȝ.
 Doun after a strem þat dryȝly haleȝ,
 I bowed in blys, bred ful my brayneȝ;
 Þe fyrre I folȝed þose floty valeȝ,
 5 128 Þe more strengþe of ioȝe myn herte strayneȝ,
 As fortune fares þer as ho frayneȝ,
 Wheþer solace ho sende oþer elleȝ sore,
 Þe wyȝ, to wham her wylle ho wayneȝ,
 132 Hytteȝ to haue ay more & more.

More of wele watȝ in þat wyse
 Þen I cowþe telle þaȝ I tom hade,
 For vrbely herte myȝt not suffyse
 136 To þe tenþe dole of þo gladneȝ glade;
 For-þy I þoȝt þat paradyse
 Watȝ þer oþer gayn þo bonkeȝ brade;
 I hoped þe water were a deuyse
 140 By-twene myrþeȝ by mereȝ made,
 By-ȝonde þe broke by slente oþer slade,
 I hope[de] þat mote merked wore.
 Bot þe water watȝ depe I dorst not wade
 144 & euer me longed a more & more.

More & more, & ȝet wel mare,
 Me lyste to se þe broke by-ȝonde,
 For if hit watȝ fayr þer I con fare,
 148 Wel loueloker watȝ þe fyrre londe.
 Abowte me con I stote & stare
 To fynde a forþe, faste con I fonde,
 Bot woþeȝ mo i-wysse þer ware,
 152 Þe fyrre I stalked by þe stronde,
 & euer me þoȝt I schulde not wonde
 For wo, þer weleȝ so wyne wore.
 Þenne nwe note me com on honde
 156 Þat meued my mynde ay more & more,

IER SEES HIS LOST CHILD DRESSED IN WHITE ROBES.

More meruayle con my dom adaunt;
 I seȝ by-ȝonde þat myry mere,
 A crystal clyffe ful relusaunt,
 160 Mony ryal ray con fro hit rere;
 At þe fote þer-of þer sete a faunt,
 A mayden of menske, ful debonere;
 Blysnande whyt watȝ hyr bleaunt,
 6 164 (I knew hyr wel, I hade sen hyr ere)
 As glysnande golde þat man con schere,
 So schon þat schene an vnder schore;
 On lenghe I loked to hyr þere,
 168 Þe lenger I knew hyr more & more

The more I frayste hyr fayre face.
 Her fygyre fyn, quen I had fonte,
 Suche gladande glory con to me glace,
 172 As lyttel byfore þerto watȝ wonte;
 To calle hyr lyste con me enchace,

His grief abates, and he follow
 the course of the stream.

No one could describe his great
 joy.

He thought that Paradise was on
 the opposite bank.

The stream was not fordable.

[Fol. 4
 More and more he desires to see
 what is beyond the brook.

But the way seemed difficult.

The dreamer finds new marvels

He sees a crystal cliff,

at the foot of which, sits a maiden
 clothed in glistening white.

He knows that he has seen her
 before.

He desires to call her but is afraid

Bot baysment gef myn hert a brunt,
 I seȝ hyr in so strange a place,
 176 Such a burre myȝt make myn herte blunt
Þenne vereȝ ho vp her fayre frount,
 Hyr vysayge whyt as playn yuore,
Þat stonge myn hert ful stray atount,
 180 & euer þe lenger, þe more & more.

at finding her in such a strange place.

IV.

More þen me lyste my drede aros,
 I stod ful styлле & dorste not calle,
 Wyth yȝen open & mouth ful clos,
 184 I stod as hende as hawk in halle;
 I hope þat gostly watȝ þat porpose,
 I dred on ende quat schulde byfalle,
 Lest ho me eschaped þat I þer chos,
 188 Er I at steuen hir moȝt stalle.
Þat gracios gay with-outen galle,
 So smoþe, so smal, so seme slyȝt,
Ryseȝ vp in hir araye ryalle,
 192 A prec[i]os pyece in perleȝ pyȝt.
 Perleȝ pyȝte of ryal prys,
 Þere moȝt mon by grace haf sene,
 Quen þat frech as flor-de-lys,
 196 Doun þe bonke con boȝe by-dene.
 Al blysnande whyt watȝ hir beau uiys,
 7 Vpon at sydeȝ & bounden bene
 Wyth þe myryste margarys at my deuyse,
 200 Þat euer I seȝ ȝet with myn yȝen;
 Wyth lappeȝ large I wot & I wene,
 Dubbed with double perle & dyȝte,
 Her cortel of self sute schene,
 204 With precios perleȝ al vmbe-pyȝte.
 A pyȝt coroune ȝet wer þat gyrlе,
 Of mariorys & non oþer ston,
 Hiȝe pynakled of cler quyt perle,
 208 Wyth flurtd flowreȝ perfet vpon;
 To hed hade ho non oþer werle,
Her here heke al hyr vmbe-gon;
Her semblaunt sade, for doc oþer erle,
 212 Her ble more blaȝt þen whalleȝ bon;
As schorne golde schyr her fax þenne schon,
 On schyldereȝ þat leghe vnlapped lyȝte;
 Her depe colour ȝet wonted non,
 216 Of precios perle in porfyl pyȝte,
 Pyȝt watȝ poyned & vche a hemme,
 At honde, at sydeȝ, at ouerture,
 Wyth whyte perle & non oþer gemme,
 220 & bornyste quyte watȝ hyr uesture.
 Bot a wonder perle with-outen wemme,
 In myddeȝ hyr breste watȝ sette so sure;
A manneȝ dom moȝt dryȝly demme,

[Fol. 4

So he stands still, like a well trained hawk.

He fears lest she should escape before he could speak to her.

His long lost one is dressed in royal array—decked with precious pearls.

pyece] MS. looks like *pyete*.

She comes along the stream towards him.

Her kirtle is composed of 'sute' ornamented with pearls.

She wore a crown of pearls.

Her hair hung down about her.

here heke] In the MS. it is *le leke*.

Her colour was whiter than whalebone.

Her hair shone as gold.

The trimming of her robe consisted of precious pearls.

[Fol. 4

A wonderful pearl was set in her breast.

224 Er mynde moȝt malte *in* hit mesure;
 I hope no tong moȝt endure
 No sauerly saghe say of þat syȝt,
 So watȝ hit clene & cler & pure,
 228 þat *precios* perle þer hit watȝ pyȝt,

DEN ADDRESSES HER FATHER.

Pyȝt in perle þat *precios* p[r]yse.
 On *wyȝer* half water com down þe schore,
 No gladder gome heȝen *in* to grece,
 232 þen I, quen ho on brymme wore;
 Ho watȝ me nerre þen aunte or nece,
 8 My Ioy for-þy watȝ much þe more.
 Ho *profered* me speche þat special spyce,
 236 Enclynande lowe *in* wommon lore,
 Caȝte of her coroun of grete tresore,
 & haylsed me wyth a lote lyȝte.
 Wel watȝ me þat euer I watȝ bore,
 240 To sware þat swete *in* perleȝ pyȝte!

No man from here to Greece, ⁊
 so glad as the father, when he
 his pearl on the bank of the
 stream.

The maiden salutes him.

V.

“O perle,” *quod* I, “in perleȝ pyȝt,
 Art þou my perle þat I haf playned,
 Regretted by *myn* one, on nyȝte?
 244 Much longeyng haf I for þe layned,
 Syȝen into gresse þou me aglyȝte;
 Pensyf, payred, I am for-payned,
 & þou *in* a lyf of lykyng lyȝte
 248 In paradys erde, of stryf vnstrayned.
 What wyrde hatȝ hyder my iuel vayned,
 & don me in þys del & gret daunger?
 Fro we *in* twynne wern *towen* & twayned,
 252 I haf ben a Ioyleȝ Iuelere.”

The father enquires of the mai
 whether she is his long-lost pe

and longs to know who has
 deprived him of his treasure.

.S HIM OF HER BLISS.

That Iuel þenne in *gemmyȝ* gente,
 Vered vp her vyse *with* yȝen graye,
 Set on hyr coroun of perle orient,
 256 & soberly after þenne con ho say:
 “Sir ȝe haf *your* tale myse-tente,
 To say *your* perle is al awaye,
 þat is *in* cofer, so comly clente,
 260 As *in* þis gardyn gracios gaye,
 Here-inne to lenge for euer & play.
 þer mys nee mornyng com neuer here,
 Her were a forser for þe *in* faye,
 264 If þou were a gentyl Iueler.

[Fol. 4

The maiden tells him that his
 pearl is not really lost.

She is in a garden of delight,
 where sin and mourning are
 unknown.

Bot Iueler gente if þou schal lose
 9 Þy ioy for a *gemme* þat þe watȝ lef,
 Me þynk þe put *in* a mad porpose,
 268 & *busyeȝ* þe aboute a raysoun bref,

For þat þou leste3 wat3 bot a rose,
 þat flowred & fayled as kynde hyt gef;
 Now þur3 kynde of þe kyste þat hyt con close,
 272 To a perle of prys hit is put *in* prief;
 & þou hat3 called þy wyrde a þef,
 þat o3t of no3t hat3 mad þe cler;
 þou blame3 þe bote of þy *meschef*,
 276 þou art no kynde Iueler.”

A Iuel to me þen wat3 þys geste,
 & iuele3 wern hyr *genty*l sawe3.
 “I-wyse,” *quod* I, “my blysfol beste,
 280 My grete dystresse þou al to-drawe3,
 To be excused I make requeste;
 I trawed my perle don out of dawe3,
 Now haf I fonde hyt I schal ma feste,
 284 & wony *with* hyt *in* schyr wod schawe3,
 & loue my lorde & al his lawe3,
 þat hat3 me bro3[t] þys blys ner;
 Now were I at yow by-3onde þise wawe3,
 288 I were a ioiful Iueler.”

“Iueler,” sayde þat gemme clene,
 “Wy borde 3e men, so madde 3e be?
 þre worde3 hat3 þou spoken at ene,
 292 Vn-avysed, for soþe, wern alle þre,
 þou ne woste in worlde quat on dot3 mene,
 þy worde byfore þy wytte con fle.
 þou says þou trawe3 me *in* þis dene,
 296 By cawse þou may *with* y3en me se;
 Anoper þou says, *in* þys countre
 þy self schal won *with* me ry3t here;
 þe þrydde, to passe þys water fre,
 300 þat may no ioiful Iueler.

busye3] Looks like *husye3* in MS.

The rose that he had lost is become a pearl of price.

The pearl blames his rash spee

The father begs the maiden to excuse his speech, for he really thought his pearl was wholly lost to him.

[Fol. 4

The maiden tells her father that she has spoken three words without knowing the meaning of one.

The first word.

The second.

The third.

He is little to be praised who loves what he sees.

loue3] Looks at first sight like *lyue3*—MS. rubbed, but read *leue3*.

loue3] Read *leue3*.

To love nothing but what one sees is great presumption.

is] The MS. reads *is*.

VI.

I halde þat iueler lyttel to prayse.
 þat loue3 wel þat he se3 wyth y3e,
 & much to blame & vn-cortoyse,
 304 þat *loue3* oure lorde wolde make a ly3e,
 þat lelly hy3te *your* lyf to rayse,
 þa3 fortune dyd *your* flesch to dy3e;
 3e setten hys worde3 ful *westernays*
 308 þat *loue3* no þynk bot 3e hit sy3e,
 & þat *is* a poynt o sorquydry3e,
 þat vche god mon may euel byseme
 To leue no tale be *true* to try3e,
 312 Bot þat hys one skyl may dem[e].

THE ROAD TO PARADISE.

Deme now þy-self, if þou con, dayly
 As man to god worde3 schulde heue.
 þou sayt3 þou schal won *in* þis bayly;
 316 Me þynk þe burde fyrst aske leue,

To live in this kingdom (*i.e.* heaven) leave must be asked.

& 3et of graunt þou my3te3 fayle;
 þou wylne3 ouer þys water to weue,
 Er moste þou ceuer to oþer counsayl,
 320 Þy corse *in* clot mot calder keue,
 For hit wat3 *for-garte*, at paradys greue
 Oure 3ore *fader* hit con mysse3eme;
 Þur3 *drwry* deth bo3 vch ma dreue,
 324 Er ouer þys dam *hym dry3tyn* deme.”

This stream must be passed ov
 by death.

“Deme3 þou me,” *quod* I, “my swete
 To dol agayn, þenne I dowyne;
 Now haf I fonte þat I for-lete
 328 Schal I efte for-go hit er euer I fyne?
 Why schal I hit boþe mysse & mete?
 My *precios* perle dot3 me gret pyne,
 What serue3 tresor, bot gare3 men grete
 332 When he hit schal efte *with* tene3 tyne?
 Now rech I *neuer* forto declyne,
 Ne how fer of folde þat man me fleme,
 11 When I am partle3 of perle3 myne.
 336 Bot *durande doel* what may men deme?”

[Fol. 4

The father asks his pearl whetl
 she is about to doom him to
 sorrow again.

If he loses his pearl he does nc
 care what happens to him.

T ABIDE GOD’S DOOM.

“Thow deme3 no3t bot doel dystresse,”
 Þenne sayde þat wy3t “why dot3 þou so?
 For dyne of doel, of lure3 lesse,
 340 Ofte mony mon for-gos þe mo;
 Þe o3te better þy seluen blesse,
 & loue ay god & wele & wo,
 For anger gayne3 þe not a cresse.
 344 Who nede3 schal þole be not so þro;
 For þo3 þou daunce as any do
 Braundysch & bray þy braþe3 breme,
 When þou no fyrre may, to ne fro,
 348 Þou moste abyde þat he schal deme.

The maiden tells her father to
 suffer patiently.

&] *in* or *an* (?).

Though he may dance as any c
 yet he must abide God’s doom

Deme dry3tyn, euer *hym* adyte,
 Of þe way a fote ne wyl he wryþe,
 Þy mende3 mounte3 not a myte,
 352 Þa3 þou for sor3e be *neuer* blyþe;
Stynst of þy strot & fyne to flyte,
 & sech hys blyþe ful *swefte* & swyþe,
 Þy prayer may hys pyte byte,
 356 Þat mercy schal *hyr* crafte3 kype;
 Hys comforte may þy langour lyþe,
 & þy lure3 of ly3tly leme,
 For marre oþer madde, morne & myþe,
 360 Al lys *in* hym to dy3t & deme.”

He must cease to strive.

swefte] MS. *sweste*.

All lies in God’s power to mak
 men joyful or sad.

BEAVED PARENT ASKS HIS CHILD’S PITY.

VII.

Thenne demed I to þat damyselle,
 Ne worþe no wrath þe vnto my lorde,
 If rapely *raue* spornande *in* spelle.

[Fol. 4

raue] *rane* (?).

364 My herte wat3 al *with* mysse remorde,
 As wallande water got3 out of welle;
 I do me ay *in* hys mysrecorde.
 Rebuke me *neuer with* worde3 felle,
 368 þa3 I forloyne my dere endorde,
 12 Bot lyþe3 me kyndely *your* coumforde,
 Pytosly þenkande vpon þysse;
 Of care & me 3e made acorde,
 372 þat er wat3 grounde of alle my blysse;
 My blysse, my bale 3e han ben boþe,
 Bot much þe bygger 3et wat3 my mon,
 Fro þou wat3 wroken fro vch a woþe.
 376 I wyste *neuer* quere my perle wat3 gon;
 Now I hit se, now leþe3 my loþe,
 & quen we departed we wern at on,
 God forbede we be now wroþe,
 380 We meten so selden by stok oþer ston;
 þa3 cortaysly 3e carp con,
 I am bot mol & *marere3* mysse,
 Bot crystes mersy & mary & Ion,
 384 þise arn þe grounde of alle my blysse.

In blysse I se þe blyþely blent
 & I a man al mornyf *mate*,
 3e take *þer-on* ful lyttel tente,
 388 þa3 I hente ofte harme3 hate.
 Bot now I am here *in your* presente,
 I wolde bysech wythouten debate,
 3e wolde me say *in* sobre asente,
 392 What lyf 3e lede, erly & late,
 For I am ful fayn þat *your* astate
 Is worþen to worschyp & wele I wysse,
 Of alle my Ioy þe hy3e gate
 396 Hit is *in* grounde of alle my blysse.”

“Now blysse burne mot þe bytyde;”
 Þen sayde þat lufsoum of lyth & lere,
 “& welcum here to walk & byde,
 400 For now þy speche is to me dere;
 Maysterful mod & hy3e pryde
 I hete þe arn heterly hated here;
 My lorde ne loue3 not forto chyde,
 404 For meke arn alle þat wone3 hym nere,
 & when *in* hys place þou schal apere,
 Be dep deuote *in* hol mekenesse;
 My lorde þe lamb, loue3 ay such chere,
 408 þat is þe grounde of alle my blysse.

CRIBES HER MODE OF LIFE.

A blysfyl lyf þou says I lede,
 Þou wolde3 know *þer-of* þe stage;
 Þow wost wel when þy perle con schede,
 412 I wat3 ful 3ong & tender of age,
 Bot my lorde þe lombe, þur3 hys god-hede,
 He toke my self to hys maryage,
 Corounde me quene *in* blysse to brede,

The father beseeches the pearl
 have pity upon him.

He says that she has been both
 bale and bliss.

And when he lost her, he knew
 not what had become of her.

And now that he sees her in bl
 she takes little heed of his sorr

He desires to know what life s
 leads.

[Fol. 4
 The maiden tells him that he n
 walk and abide with her, now
 he is humble.

All are meek that dwell in the
 abode of bliss.

All lead a blissful life.

She reminds her father that she
 was very young when she died

416 *In* lenghe of daye3 þat euer schal wage,
 & sesed *in* alle hys herytage
 Hys lef is, I am holy hysse;
 Hys prese, hys prys & hys parage,
 420 Is rote & grounde of alle my blysse.”

THE EMPRESS OF HEAVEN.

VIII.

“**B**lysful,” *quod* I, “may þys be trwe,
 Dysplese3 not if I speke *errour*;
 Art þou þe quene of heuene3 blwe,
 424 Þat al þys worlde schal do honour?
 We leuen on marye þat grace of grewe,
 Þat ber a barne of vyrgyn flour,
 Þe croune fro hyr quo mo3t remwe,
 428 Bot ho hir passed *in sum* fauour?
 Now for synglerty o hyr dousour,
 We calle hyr fenyx of arraby,
 Þat freles fle3e of hyr fasor,
 432 Lyk to þe quen of cortaysye.”

“Cortayse quen” þenne s[a]yde þat gaye,
 Knelande to grounde, folde vp hyr face,
 “Makele3 moder & myryst may,
 436 Blessed *bygynner* of vch a grace!”
 þenne ros ho vp & con restay,
 14 & speke me towarde *in* þat space:
 “*Sir* fele here porchase3 & fonge3 pray
 440 Bot supplantore3 none *with-inne* þys place;
 Þat emperise al heuen3 hat3,
 & vrþe & helle *in* her bayly;
 Of erytage 3et non wyl ho chace,
 444 For ho is quen of cortaysye.

ERS ARE KINGS OR QUEENS.

The court of þe kyndom of god alyue,
 Hat3 a *property in* hyt self beyng;
 Alle þat may þer-*inne* aryue
 448 Of alle þe reme is quen oþer kyng,
 & neuer oþer 3et schal depyue,
 Bot vchon fayn of oþere3 hafyng,
 & wolde her coroune3 wern worþe þo fyue,
 452 If possyble were her mendyng.
 Bot my lady of quom Iesu con spryng,
 Ho halde3 þe empyre ouer *vus* ful hy3e,
 & þat dysplese3 non of oure *gyng*,
 456 For ho is quene of cortaysye.

Of courtaysye, as sayt3 saynt poule,
 Al arn we *membre3* of ihesu kryst,
 As heued & arme & legg & naule,
 460 *Temen* to hys body ful trwe & *t[r]yste*;
 Ry3t so is vch a krysten sawle,
 A longande lym to þe mayster of myste;

Now she is crowned a queen in
 heaven.

The father of the maiden does
 fully understand her.

Mary, he says, is the queen of
 heaven.

No one is able to remove the
 crown from her.

[Fol. 4
 The maiden addresses the Virg

bygynner] MS. reads *bȳgyne*

She then explains to her father
 that each has his place in heav

The court of God has a proper
 in its own being.

Each one in it is a king or quee

The mother of Christ holds the
 chief place.

We are all members of Christ's
 body.

þenne loke what hate oþer any gawle,
 464 Is tached oþer tyzed þy lymmeȝ by-twyste,
 þy heued hatȝ nauþer greme ne gryste,
 On arme oþer fynger, þaȝ þou ber byȝe;
 So fare we alle wyth luf & lyste,
 468 To kyng & quene by cortaysye.”

“Cortayse,” *quod* I, “I leue
 & charyte grete be yow among,
 Bot my speche þat yow ne greue,
 472
 þy self in heuen ouer hyȝ þou heue,
 15 To make þe quen þat watȝ so ȝonge,
 What more-hond moȝte he acheue
 476 þat hade endured *in* worlde stronge,
 & lyued *in* penaunce hys lyueȝ longe,
 With bodyly bale hym blysse to byye?
 What more worschyp moȝt ho fonge,
 480 þen corounde be kyng by cortayse?”

Look that each limb be perfect

[Fol. 4

The father replies that he cann
 understand how his pearl can l
 queen.

He desires to know what great
 honour she can have.

IX.

That cortayse is to fre of dede,
 ȝyf hyt be soth þat þou coneȝ saye,
 þou lyfed not two ȝer *in* oure þede,
 484 þou cowþeȝ neuer god nauþer plese ne pray,
 Ne neuer nawþer pater ne crede,
 & quen mad on þe fyrst day!
 I may not traw, so god me spede,
 488 þat god wolde wryþe so wrange away;
 Of countes damysel, par ma fay,
 Wer fayr *in* heuen to halde asstate
 Aþer elleȝ a lady of lasse aray,
 492 Bot a quene, hit is to dere a date.”

“þer is no date of hys god-nesse,”
 þen sayde to me þat worþy wyȝte,
 “For al is trawþe þat he con dresse,
 496 & he may do no þynk bot ryȝt,
 As mathew meleȝ *in* your messe,
 In sothfol gospel of god al-myȝt
 In sample he can ful grayþely gesse,
 500 & lykneȝ hit to heuen lyȝte.”
 “My regne, he saytȝ, is lyk on hyȝt,
 To a lorde þat hade a uyne I wate,
 Of tyme of ȝere þe terme watȝ tyȝt,
 504 To labor vyne watȝ dere þe date,

She was only two years old wl
 she died, and could do nothing
 please God.

She might be a countess or sor
 great lady but not a queen.

The maiden informs her father
 that there is no limit to God’s
 power.

The parable of the labourers ir
 vineyard.

ABLE OF THE LABOURERS IN THE VINEYARD.

þat date of ȝere wel knawe þys hyne;
 16 þe lorde ful erly vp he ros,
 To hyre werkmen to hys vyne,
 508 & fyndeȝ þer summe to hys porpos,
 Into acorde þay con de-clyne,
 For a pené on a day & forth þay gotȝ,

[Fol. 4

The lord of the vineyard hires
 workmen for a penny a day.

Wryþen & worchen & don gret pyne,
 512 Keruen & caggen & man hit clos;
 Aboute vnder, þe lorde to marked tot3
 & ydel men stande he fynde3 þer-ate,
 “Why stande 3e ydel” he sayde to þos,
 516 Ne knawe 3e of þis day no date?

“Er date of daye hider arn we wonne,”
 So wat3 al samen her answar so3t;
 “We haf standen her syn ros þe sunne,
 520 & no mon bydde3 *vus* do, ry3t no3t.”
 “Gos *in-to* my vyne, dot3 þat 3e conne.”
 So sayde þe lorde & made hit to3t.
 “What resonabele hyre be na3t be runne,
 524 I yow pray *in* dede & þo3te.”

þay wente *in* to þe vyne & wro3te,
 & al day þe lorde þus 3ede his gate,
 & nw men to hys vyne he bro3te;
 528 Wel ne3 wyl day wat3 passed date,

At þe day of date of euen-songe,
 On oure byfore þe sonne go doun
 He se3 þer ydel men ful stronge
 532 & sa[y]de to *hem* *with* sobre soun;
 “Wy stonde 3e ydel þise daye3 longe.”
 þay sayden her hyre wat3 nawhere boun.
 “Got3 to my vyne 3emen 3onge
 536 & wyrke3 & dot3 þat at 3e moun.”
 Sone þe worlde by-com wel broun,
 þe sunne wat3 doun & hit wex late;
 To take her hyre he mad sumoun;
 540 þe day wat3 al apassed date.

At noon the lord hires other m
 standing idle in the market pla

He commands them to go into
 vineyard, and he will give ther
 what is right.

At an hour before the sun wen
 down the lord sees other men
 standing idle.

hem] MS. *hen*.

Tells them to go into the viney

&] MS. & &.

As soon as the sun was gone
 down the “reeve” was told to t
 the workmen.

[Fol. 4

To give each a penny.

The first began to complain.

Having borne the heat of the d
 he thinks that he deserves mor

wrang] MS. *wanig*.

X.

The date of þe daye þe lorde con knaw,
 Called to þe reue “lede pay þe meyny,
 Gyf hem þe hyre þat I hem owe,
 544 & fyrre, þat non me may repreue,
 Set hem alle vpon a rawe,
 & gyf vchon *in-lyche* a peny.
 Bygyn at þe laste þat stande3 lowe,
 548 Tyl to þe fyrste þat þou atteny;”
 & þenne þe fyrst by-gonne to pleny
 & sayden þat þay hade trauayled sore,
 þese bot an [h]oure hem con streny,
 552 *Vus* þynk *vus* o3e to take more.

More haf we serued *vus* þynk so,
 þat suffred han þe daye3 hete,
 þenn þyse þat wro3t[e] not houre3 two,
 556 & þou dot3 hem *vus* to counterfete.
 þenne sayde þe lorde to on of þo,
 “Frende no *wrang* I wyl þe 3ete,
 Take þat is þyn owne & go;

17
 MENT OF THE LABOURERS.

560 & I hyred þe for a peny a grete,
 Quy bygynneþ þou now to þrete;
 Wat3 not a pené þy couenaunt þore?
 Fyrre þen couenaunde is no3t to plete,
 564 Wy schalte þou þenne ask more?

The lord tells him that he agreed only to give him a penny.

More weþer louyly is me my gyfte
 To do wyth myn quat so me lykeþ?
 Oþer elleþ þyn y3e to lyþer is lyfte,
 568 For I am goude & non by-swykeþ.”
 “Þus schal I,” *quod* kryste, “hit skyfte,
 Þe laste schal be þe fyrst þat strykeþ,
 & þe fyrst þe laste, be he neuer so swyft,
 572 For mony ben calle[d] þa3 fewe be mykeþ.”
 Þus pore men her part ay pykeþ,
 Þa3 þay com late & lyttel wore,
 18 & þa3 her sweng wyth lyttel at-slykeþ,
 576 Þe merci of god is much þe more.

The last shall be first, and the first shall be last.

The maiden applies the parable to herself.

DECLARATION OF THE PARABLE.

“More haf I of ioie & blysse here-inne,
 Of ladyschyp gret & lyueþ blom,
 Þen alle þe wy3eþ in þe worlde my3t wynne
 580 By þe way of ry3t to aske dome.
 Wheþer wel nygh[t] now I con bygynne,
 In euentyde in-to þe vyne I come,
 Fyrst of my hyre my lorde con mynne,
 584 I wat3 payed anon of al & sum;
 3et oþer þer werne þat toke more tom,
 Þat swange & swat for long 3ore,
 Þat 3et of hyre no þynk þay nom,
 588 Paraunter no3t schal to 3ere more.”

[Fol. 4

She came to the vine in eventide and yet received more than others who had lived longer.

Then more I meled & sayde apert,
 “Me þynk þy tale vnresounable,
 Goddeþ ry3t is redy & euer more rert,
 592 Oþer holy wryt is bot a fable;
 In sauter is sayd a verce ouerte
 Þat spekeþ a poynt determynable,
 ‘Þou quyteþ vchon as hys desserte,
 596 Þou hy3e kyng ay pretermynable,’
 Now he þat stod þe long day stable,
 & þou to payment com hym byfore,
 Þenne þe lasse in werke to take more able,
 600 & euer þe lenger þe lasse þe more.”

The father says that his daughter's tale is unreasonable.

*re*rt] *ert* (?).

pretermynable] MS.
pertermynable.

O NIGGARD.

XI.

“O f more & lasse in godeþ ryche,”
 Þat gentyl sayde “lys no Ioparde,
 For þer is vch mon payed inliche,
 604 Wheþer lyttel oþer much be hys rewarde,
 For þe gentyl cheuentayn is no chyche,
 Queþer-so-euer he dele nesch oþer harde,

In heaven, the maiden says, every man is paid alike.

He laue3 hys gyfte3 as water of dyche,
 608 Oþer gote3 of golf þat neuer charde;
 19 Hys fraunchyse is large þat euer dard,
 To hym þat mat3 in synne no scoghe
 No blysse bet3 fro hem reparde,
 612 For þe grace of god is gret I-noghe.
 Bot now þou mote3 me for to mate
 Þat I my peny haf wrang tan here,
 Þou say3 þat I þat com to late,
 616 Am not worþy so gret lere.
 Where wyste3 þou euer any bourne abate
 Euer so holy in hys prayere,
 Þat he ne forfeþed by sumkyn gate,
 620 Þe mede sum-tyme of heuene3 clere;
 & ay þe ofter, þe alder þay were,
 Þay laften ry3t & wro3ten woghe
 Mercy & grace moste hem þen stere,
 624 For þe grace of god is gret in-no3e.
 Bot in-noghe of grace hat3 innocent,
 As sone as þay arn borne by lyne
 In þe water of babtem þay dyssente,
 628 Þen arne þay boro3t in-to þe vyne,
 Anon þe day with derk endente,
 Þe my3t of deth dot3 to en-clyne
 Þat wro3t neuer wrang er þenne þay wente;
 632 Þe gentyle lorde þenne paye3 hys hyne,
 Þay dyden hys heste, þay wern þere-ine,
 Why schulde he not her labour alow,
 3y[rd] & pay hem at þe fyrst fyne
 636 For þe grace of god is gret in-noghe?

E WAS LOST THROUGH AN APPLE.

Ino3e is knawen þat man-kyn grete,
 Fyrste wat3 wro3t to blysse parfyt;
 Oure forme-fader hit con forfeþe,
 640 Þur3 an apple þat he vpon con byte;
 Al wer we dampned for þat mete,
 To dy3e in doel out of delyt,
 & syþen wende to helle hete,
 644 Þer-inne to won with-oute respyt;
 20 Bot þer on com a bote as-tyt.
 Ryche blod ran on rode so roghe,
 & wyne [&] water, þen at þat plyt
 648 Þe grace of god wex gret in-noghe.
 Innoghe þer wax out of þat welle,
 Blod & water of brode wounde;
 Þe blod vus bo3t fro bale of helle,
 652 & delyuered vus of þe deth secounde;
 Þe water is baptem þe soþe to telle;
 Þat fol3ed þe glayue so grymly grounde,
 Þat wasche3 away þe gylte3 felle,
 656 Þat adam wyth inne deth vus drounde.
 Now is þer no3t in þe worlde rounde
 Bytwene vus & blysse bot þat he with-dro3

gyfte3] MS. gyste3.

God is no niggard.

no scoghe] In the MS. it lool
like rescoghe.

The grace of God is sufficient
all.

[Fol. 4

Those who live long on the ea
often forfeit heaven by sinning

Innocents are saved by baptisr

Why should not God allow the
labour.

hem] MS. hym.

Our first father lost heaven by
eating an apple.

And all are damned for the sin
Adam.

But there came one who paid t
penalty of our sins.

[Fol. 4

out] MS. out out.

The water that came from the
pierced side of Christ was
baptism.

& þat is restored *in* sely stounde,
 660 & þe grace of god is gret *in-nogh*.

XII.

Grace *in-nogh* þe mon may haue,
 þat symneþ þenne new, 3if hym repente,
 Bot *with* sorþ & syt he mot hit craue,
 664 & byde þe payne þer-to is bent,
 Bot resoun of ryȝt þat con not raue,
 Saueþ euer more þe *innosent*;
 Hit is a dom þat neuer god gaue,
 668 þat euer þe gyltleȝ schulde be schente.
 þe gyltyf may contrysseyoun hente
 & be þurȝ mercy to grace þryȝt;
 Bot he to gyle þat neuer *glente*,
 672 At *in-oscente* is saf & ryȝte.

Repentance must be sought by
 prayer with sorrow and afflicti

The guilty may be saved by
 contrition.

ITS ARE SAVED BY RIGHT.

Ryȝt þus I know wel *in* þis cas,
 Two men to saue is god by skylle;
 þe ryȝt-wys man schal se hys *face*,
 676 þe harmleȝ habel schal com hym tylle,
 þe sauter hyt satȝ þus *in* a pace:
 “Lorde quo schal klymbe þy hyȝ hylleȝ
 21 Oþer rest *with-inne* þy holy place?”
 680 Hymself to on-sware he is not *dylle*;
 “Hondelyngeȝ harme þat dyt not ille,
 þat is of hert boþe clene & lyȝt,
 þer schal hys step stable style,”
 684 þe *innosent* is ay saf by ryȝt.

þus] MS. þus þus.

Two sorts of people are saved,
righteous and the *innocent*.

face] MS. fate.

The words of David.

The ryȝtwys man also sertayn
 Aproche he schal þat proper pyle,
 þat takeȝ not her lyf *in* vayne
 688 Ne glauereȝ her niezbor wyth no gyle;
 Of þys ryȝt-wys *saȝ* salamon playn,
 How kyntly *oure* con aquyle
 By wayeȝ ful streȝt he con hym strayn,
 692 & scheued hym þe rengne of god a whyle,
 As quo says “lo ȝon louely yle,
 þou may hit wynne if þou be wyȝte,”
 Bot hardyly *with-oute* peryle,
 696 þe *innosent* is ay saue by ryȝte!

The innocent is saved by right
 [Fol. 4

saȝ] satȝ (?).

The words of Solomon.

An-ende ryȝtwys men, ȝet saytȝ a gome
 Daud *in* sauter, if euer ȝe seȝ hit,
 “Lorde þy seruaunt draȝ neuer to dome,
 700 For non lyuyunde to þe is Iustyfyet.”
 For-þy to corte quen þou schal com,
 þer alle *oure* causeȝ schal be tryed,
 Alegge þe ryȝt þou may be *in-nome*,
 704 By þys ilke spech I haue asspyed;
 Bot he on rode þat bloody dyed,
 Delffully þurȝ hondeȝ þryȝt

David says no man living is
 justified.

For] MS. sor.

Gyue þe to passe when þou arte tryed
708 By innocens & not by ryzte.

BLESSED LITTLE CHILDREN.

Pray to be saved by innocence
and not by right.

Ryzt-wysly quo con rede,
He loke on bok & be awayed
How Ihesuc hym welke in are þede,
712 & burnez her barnez vnto hym brayde,
For happe & hele þat fro hym zede,
22 To touch her chylder þay fayr hym prayed.
His dessypelez *with* blame let be hym bede,
716 & wyth her resounez ful fele restayed;
Ihesuc þenne hem swetely sayde,
“Do way, let chylder vnto me tyzt.
To suche is heuen-ryche arayed,”
720 Be *innocent* is ay saf by ryzt.

When Jesus was on earth, little
children were brought unto him

touch] MS. *touth*.

The disciples rebuked the pare

Christ said, “Suffer little child
to come unto me,” etc.

XIII.

Ihesuc con calle to hym hys mylde
& sayde hys ryche no wyȝ myzt wynne.
Bot he com þyder ryzt as a chylde,
724 Oþer elleȝ neuer more com þer-inne,
Harmleȝ, trwe & vnde-fylde,
With-uten mote oþer mascle of sulpande synne;
Quen such þer cnoken on þe bylde,
728 Tyt schal hem men þe ȝate vnþynne,
þer is þe blys þat con not blynne,
þat þe Iueler soȝte þurȝ perre pres
& solde alle hys goud boþe wolen & lynne,
732 To bye hym a perle [þat] watȝ mascelleȝ.

[Fol. 4

No one can win heaven except
be meek as a child.

This makelleȝ perle þat boȝt is dere,
þe Ioueler gef fore alle hys god,
Is lyke þe reme of heuenesse clere
736 So sayde þe fader of folde & flode,
For hit is wemleȝ, clene & clere,
& endeleȝ rounde & blyþe of mode,
& *commune* to alle þat ryztwys were,
740 Lo! euen *in* mydȝeȝ my breste hit stode;
My lorde þe lombe þat schede hys blode,
He pyȝt hit þere *in* token of pes;
I rede þe forsake þe worlde wode,
744 & porchace þy perle maskelles.”

The pearl of price is like the
kingdom of heaven, pure and
clean.

ryztwys] MS. *ryȝtywys*.

Forsake the mad world and
purchase the spotless pearl.

THE MAD WORLD.

“O maskeleȝ perle *in* perleȝ pure
þat bereȝ,” *quod* I, “þe perle of prys,
Quo formed þe þy fayre fygure?
748 þat wroȝt þy wede, he watȝ ful wys;
23 þy beaute com *neuer* of nature,
Pymalyon paynted *neuer* þy vys,
Ne arystotel nawþer by hys lettrure

The father of the maiden desir
to know who formed her figur
and wrought her garments.

Her beauty, he says, is not nati

752 Of carpe þe kynde þese *propertez*.
 By colour passeþ þe flour-de-lys,
 Þyn angel *hauyng* so clene corteþ
 Breue me bryȝt, quat-kyn of *priys*
 756 Bereþ þe perle so maskelleȝ.”

“My makeleȝ lambe þat al may *bete*,”
Quod scho, “my dere destyné
 Me ches to hys make al-þaȝ vnmete,
 760 Sum tyme semed þat assemblé
 When I wente fro yor worlde wete.
 He calde me to hys bonerté,
 ‘Cum hyder to me my lemman swete,
 764 For mote ne spot is non in þe:’
 He gef me myȝt & als bewté.
 In hys blod he wesch my wede on dese,
 & coronde clene in *vergyn*té,
 768 & pyȝt me in perleȝ maskelleȝ.”

“Why maskelleȝ bryd þat bryȝt con flambe
 Þat reiateȝ hatȝ so ryche & ryf,
 Quat-kyn þyng may be þat lambe,
 772 Þat þe wolde wedde vnto hys vyf?
 Ouer alle oþer so hyȝ þou clambe,
 To lede *with hym* so ladyly lyf
 So mony a cumly on *vnder* cambe,
 776 For kryst han lyued in much stryf,
 & þou con alle þo dere out-dryf,
 & fro þat maryag al oþer depres,
 Al only þysself so stout & styf,
 780 A makeleȝ may & maskelleȝ.”

B AND HIS BRIDES.

XIV.

24 “**M**askelles,” *quod* þat myry quene,
 “Vnblemyst I am wyth-uten blot,
 & þat may I *with* mensk menteene;
 784 Bot makeleȝ quene þenne sade I not,
 Þe lambes vyueȝ in blysse we bene,
 A hondred & forty þowsande flot
 As in þe apocalyppeȝ hit is sene;
 788 Sant Iohan hem syȝ al in a knot,
 On þe hyl of syon þat semly clot.
 Þe apostel hem segh in gostly drem
 Arayed to þe weddyng in þat hyl coppe,
 792 Þe nwe cyte u *Ierusalem*.

Of *Ierusalem* I in speche spelle.
 If þou wyl know what-kyn he be,
 My lombe, my lorde, my dere luelle,
 796 My ioy, my blys, my lemman fre,
 Þe profete ysaye of *hym* con melle,
 Pitously of hys debonerté
 Þat glorious *gyltleȝ* þat mon con quelle,
 800 *With*-uten any sake of felonye,

Her colour passes the fleur-de-

priys] The MS. has *triys*.

[Fol. 4

The maiden explains to her fat
 that she is a bride of Christ.

She is without spot or blemish

Her weeds are washed in the
 blood of Christ.

The father asks the nature of th
 Lamb that has chosen his
 daughter,

and why she is selected as a br

The Lamb has one hundred an
 forty thousand brides.

St. John saw them on the hill c
 Sion in a dream, in the new cit
 Jerusalem.

[Fol. 5

Isaiah speaks of Christ or the
 Lamb.

gyltleȝ] MS. reads *gystleȝ*.

As a schep to þe slaȝt þer lad watȝ he
 & as lombe þat clypper in lande nem,
 So closed he hys mouth fro vch query,
 804 Quen Iueȝ hym iugged in Iherusalem.

In Ierusalem watȝ my lemman slayn
 & rent on rode with boyeȝ bolde;
 Al oure baleȝ to bere ful bayn,
 808 He toke on hym self oure careȝ colde,
 With boffeteȝ watȝ hys face flayn,
 Þat watȝ so fayr on to byholde;
 For synne he set hym self in vayn,
 812 Þat neuer hade non hym self to wolde,
 For *vus* he lette hym flyȝe & folde
 & brede vpon a bostwys bem,
 As meke as lomb þat no playnt tolde.
 816 For *vus* he swalt in Ierusalem:

B WAS SLAIN IN JERUSALEM.

25 Ierusalem, Iordan & galalye,
 Þer as baptysed þe goude saynt Ion,
 His wordeȝ acorded to ysaye;
 820 When Ihesuc con to hym warde gon
 He sayde of hym þys professye,
 “Lo godeȝ lombe as trwe as ston,
 Þat dotȝ away þe synneȝ dryȝe!”
 824 Þat alle þys worlde hatȝ wroȝt vpon,
 Hym self ne wroȝt neuer ȝet non,
 Wheþer on hym self he con al clem,
 Hys generacyoun quo recen con,
 828 Þat dyȝed for *vus* in Ierusalem?

In Ierusalem þus my lemman swatte,
 Twyeȝ, for lombe watȝ taken þere,
 By trw recorde of ayþer prophete,
 832 For mode so meke & al hys fare,
 Þe þryde tyme is þer-to ful mete
 In apokalypeȝ wryten ful ȝare.
 In mydeȝ þe trone þere saynteȝ sete,
 836 Þe apostel iohan hym saytȝ as bare,
 Lesande þe boke with leueȝ sware,
 Þere seuen syngnetteȝ wern sette in-seme
 & at þat syȝt vche douth con dare,
 840 In helle, in erþe & Ierusalem.

XV.

Thys Ierusalem lombe hade neuer pechche
 Of oþer huee bot quyt Iolyf
 Þat mot ne masklle moȝt on streche
 844 For wolle quyte so ronk & ryf,
 For-þy vche saule þat hade neuer *teche*,
 Is to þat lombe a worthyly wyf;
 And þaȝ vch day a store he feche,
 848 Among *vus* commeȝ non oþer strot ne stryf,

He says that He was led as a lē
 to the slaughter.

nem] MS. *men*.

In Jerusalem was Christ slain.

With buffets was His face flay

He endured all patiently as a
 lamb.

lomb] The MS. reads *lomp*.

For us He died in Jerusalem.

The declaration of St. John,
 “Behold the Lamb of God,” et

Who can reckon His generatio
 that died in Jerusalem?

[Fol. 5

In the New Jerusalem St. John
 saw the Lamb sitting upon the
 throne.

The Lamb is without blemish.

teche] MS. *tethe*.

Every spotless soul is a worthy
 bride for the Lamb.

Bot vchon enle we wolde were fyf,
 þe mo þe myryer so god me blesse.
 In compayny gret our luf con þryf
 852 In honour more & neuer þe lesse.

No strife or envy among the
 brides.

vchon enle] vch onlepi (?).

None can have less bliss than
 another.

Our death leads us to bliss.

26 Lasse of blysse may non *vus* bryng
 þat beren þys perle vpon oure bereste,
 For þay of mote coupe neuer mynge,
 856 Of spotle3 perle3 þa[y] beren þe creste,
 Al-þa3 oure corsen in clotte3 clynge,
 & 3e remen for rauþe wyth-ouen reste,
 We þur3-outly hauen enawyng;
 860 Of [o]n dethe ful oure hope is drest,
 þe lonbe *vus* glade3, oure care is kest;
 He myrþe3 *vus* alle at vch a mes,
 Vchone3 blysse is breme & beste,
 864 & neuer one3 honour 3et neuer þe les.

ON OF SAINT JOHN.

Lest les þou leue my tale farande,
 In appocalyppece is wryten in wro
 I seghe, says Iohan, þe lombe hym stande,
 868 On þe mount of syon ful þryuen & þro,
 & wyth hym maydenne3 an hundreþe þowsande
 & fowre & forty þowsande mo
 On alle her forhede3 wryten I fande,
 872 þe lombe3 nome, hys fadere3 also.
 A hue fro heuen I herde þoo,
 Lyk flode3 fele laden, runnen on resse,
 & as þunder þrowe3 in torre3 blo,
 876 þat lote I leue wat3 neuer þe les.

[Fol. 5

tale] MS. *talle*, but *tale* in th
 catchwords.

What St. John saw upon the
 Mount of Sion.

About the Lamb he saw one
 hundred and forty thousand
 maidens.

He heard a voice from heaven,
 like many floods.

Naubeles þa3 hit schowted scharpe,
 & ledden loude al-þa3 hit were.
 A note ful nwe I herde hem warpe,
 880 To lysten þat wat3 ful lufly dere,
 As harpore3 harpen in her harpe,
 þat nwe songe þay songen ful cler.
 In sounande note3 a gentyl carpe,
 884 Ful fayre þe mode3 þay fonge in fere
 Ry3t byfore gode3 chayere,
 & þe fowre beste3 þat hym obes,
 & þe alder-men so sadde of chere,
 888 Her songe þay songen neuer þe les;

He heard the maiden sing a ne
 song.

So did the four beasts and the
 elders "so sad of cheer."

27 Nowþe-lese non wat3 neuer so quoynt,
 For alle þe crafte3 þat euer þay knewe.
 þat of þat songe my3t synge a poynt,
 892 Bot þat meyny þe lombe þay swe,
 For þay arn bo3t fro þe vrþe aloynte.
 As newe fryt to god ful due
 & to þe gentyl lombe hit arn amoynt,
 896 As lyk to hym self of lote & hwe,
 For neuer lesyng ne tale vn-trwe,
 Ne towched her tonge for no dysstresse.
 þat moteles meyny may neuer remwe,
 900 Fro þat maskele3 mayster neuer þe les."

This assembly was like the La
 spotless and pure.

“Neuer þe les let be my þonc,”
 Quod I, “my perle þaȝ I appose,
 I schulde not tempte þy wyt so wlonc,
 904 To krysteȝ chambre þat art Ichose,
 I am bot mokke & mul among,
 & þou so ryche a reken rose,
 & bydeȝ here by þys blysful bonc
 908 Þer lyueȝ lyste may neuer lose,
 Now hynde þat sympelnesse coneȝ enclose,
 I wolde þe aske a þynge expresse,
 & þaȝ I be bustwys as a blose
 912 Let my bone vayl neuer þe lese.

DE OF CHRIST’S BRIDES.

XVI.

28 Neuer þe lese cler I yow by-calle
 If ȝe con se hyt be to done,
 As þou art glorious *with-ou*ten galle,
 916 *With-nay* þou neuer my ruful bone.
 Haf ȝe no woneȝ *in* castel walle,
 Ne maner þer ȝe may mete & won?
 Þou telleȝ me of Ierusalem þe ryche ryalle,
 920 Þer dauid dere watȝ dyȝt on trone,
 Bot by þyse holteȝ hit con not hone
 Bot in Iudee hit is þat noble note;
 As ȝe ar maskeleȝ vnder mone,
 924 *Your* woneȝ schulde by wyth-ouⁿten mote.
 Þys moteleȝ meyny þou coneȝ of mele,
 Of þousandeȝ þryȝt so gret a route,
 A gret cete, for ȝe arn fele,
 928 Yow by-hod haue *with-ou*ten doute;
 So cumly a pakke of Ioly luele,
 Wer euel don schulde lyȝ þer-oute;
 & by þyse bonkeȝ þer I con gele
 932 & I se no bygyng nawhere aboute,
 I trowe al-one ȝe lenge & loute,
 To loke on þe glory of þys *grac[i]*ous gote;
 If þou hatȝ oþer lygyngȝeȝ stoute,
 936 Now tech me to þat myry mote.

“That mote þou meneȝ in Iudy londe,”
 Þat specyal spyce þen to me spakk,
 “Þat is þe cyte þat þe lombe con fonde
 940 To suffer *inne* sor for maneȝ sake,
 Þe olde Ierusalem to vnder-sonde,
 For þere þe olde gulte watȝ don to slake,
 Bot þe nwe þat lyȝt of godeȝ sonde,
 944 Þe apostel in apocalyppe *in* theme con take.
 Þe *lombe* þer, *with-ou*ten spotteȝ blake,
 Hatȝ feryed þyder hys fayre flote,
 & as hys flok is *with-ou*ten flake,
 948 So is hys mote *with-ou*ten moote.

AND NEW JERUSALEM.

[Fol. 5

The father replies to the maide

He says he is but dust and ash

He wishes to ask one question

whether the brides have their
abode in castle-walls or in mai
Jerusalem, he says, in Judea.

But the dwelling of the brides
should be perfect.

For such “a comely pack” a gr
castle would be required.

[Fol. 5

The city in Judæa, answers the
maiden, is where Christ suffer
and is the Old Jerusalem.

The New Jerusalem is where t
Lamb has assembled his bride

lombe] The MS. reads *lompe*

Of motes two to carpe clene
 & Ierusalem hyȝt boþe nawþeles,
 þat nys to yow no more to mene,
 952 Bot cete of god oþer syȝt of pes.
 In þat on oure pes watȝ mad at ene,
 With payne to suffer þe lombe hit chese,
 In þat oþer is noȝt bot pes to glene,
 956 þat ay schal laste *with-ou*ten reles,
 þat is þe borȝ þat we to pres,
 Fro þat oure flesch be layd to rote;
 29 þer glory & blysse schal euer encres,
 960 To þe meyny þat is *with-ou*ten mote.

Jerusalem means the city of G

In the Old city our peace was
 made at one.

In the New city is eternal peac

flesch] MS. *fresth*.

XVII.

“Moteleȝ may so meke & mylde,”
 þen sayde I to þat lufly flor,
 “Bryng me to þat bygly bylde,
 964 & let me se þy blysfyl bor.”
 þat schene sayde, þat god wyl schylde,
 “Þou may not enter *with-in*ne hys tor,
 Bot of þe lombe I haue þe aquylde
 968 For a syȝt þer-of þurȝ gret fauor.
 Vt-wyȝh to se þat clene cloystor,
 þou may, bot *in*wyȝh not a fote,
 To strech in þe strete þou hatȝ no vygour,
 972 Bot þou wer clene *with-ou*ten mote.

The father prays his daughter t
 bring him to the blissful bowe

His daughter tells him that he
 shall see the outside,

but not a foot may he put in th
 city.

XVIII.

If I þis mote þe schal vn-hyde,
 Bow vp to-warde þys borneȝ heued,
 & I an-endeȝ þe on þis syde
 976 Schal sve, tyl þou to a hil be veued,
 þen wolde [I] no lenger byde,
 Bot lurked by launceȝ so lufly leued,
 Tyl on a hyl þat I asspyed
 980 & blusched on þe burghe, as I forth dreued,
 By-ȝonde þe brok fro me warde keued,
 þat schyrrer þen sunne *with* schafteȝ schon;
 In þe apokalypce is þe fasoun preued,
 984 As deuyseȝ hit þe apostel Ihoñ.

[Fol. 5

The maiden then tells her fath
 go along the bank till he come
 a hill.

He reaches the hill, and behol
 the heavenly city.

SECTION OF THE NEW JERUSALEM.

As Iohan þe apostel hit syȝ *with* syȝt
 I syȝe þat cyty of gret renoun,
 Ierusalem so nwe & ryally dyȝt,
 988 As hit watȝ lyȝt fro þe heuen adoun.
 þe borȝ watȝ al of brende golde bryȝt,
 As glemande glas burnist broun,
 30 *With* gentyl *gemmeȝ* an-vnder pyȝt;
 992 *With* banteleȝ twelue on basyng boun,

As St. John saw it, so he behel

The city was of burnished golc

Pitched upon gems,

þe foundementez twelue of riche tenoun;
 Vch tabelment wat3 a serlype3 ston,
 As derely deuysez þis ilk toun,
 996 In apocalyppez þe apostel Iohan.

As þise stone3 in writ con nemme
 I knew þe name after his tale;
 Iasper hyzt þe fyrst gemme,
 1000 Þat I on þe fyrst basse con wale,
 He glente grene in þe lowest hemme.
 Saffer helde þe secounde stale,
 Þe calsydoyne þenne *with-oute* wemme,
 1004 In þe þryd table con purly pale;
 Þe emerade þe furþe so grene of scale;
 Þe sardonysse þe fyfþe ston;
 Þe sexte þe rybe he con hit wale,
 1008 In þe apocalyppez þe apostel Iohan.

3et Ioyned Iohan þe crysolyt,
 Þe seuene gemme in fundament;
 Þe a3þe þe beryl cler & quyt
 1012 Þe topasye twynne how þe nente endent;
 Þe crysopase þe tenþe is tyzt;
 Þe *Iacynghe* þe enleuene gent;
 Þe twelfþe þe gentyleste in veh a plyt,
 1016 Þe amatyst purple *with* ynde blente;
 Þe wal abof þe bantels bent,
 Masporye as glas þat glysnande schon,
 I knew hit by his deuysement,
 1020 In þe apocalyppez þe apostel Iohan.

As Iohan deuysed 3et sa3 I þare.
 Þise twelue de-gres wern brode & stayre,
 Þe cyte stod abof ful sware,
 1024 As longe as brode as hy3e ful fayre;
 Þe strete3 of golde as glasse al bare,
 Þe wal of Iasper þat glent as glayre;
 31 Þe wone3 *with-inne* enurned ware
 1028 Wyth alle kynne3 perre þat mozt repayre,
 Þenne helde vch sware of þis manayre,
 Twelue forlonge space er euer hit *fon*,
 Of he3t, of brede, of lenþe to cayre,
 1032 For meten hit sy3 þe apostel Iohan.

FOR MOON IN HEAVEN.

XIX.

As Iohan hym wryte3 3et more I sy3e
 Vch pane of þat place had þre 3ate3,
 So twelue in pursent I con asspye
 1036 Þe portalez pyked of rych plate3
 & vch 3ate of a margyrye,
 A parfyt perle þat neuer fate3;
 Vchon in scrypture a name con plye,
 1040 Of israel barne3 folewande her date3,
 Þat is to say as her byrþ whate3;

the foundation composed of
 twelve stones.

The names of the precious stones

i. Jasper.

ii. Sapphire.

iii. Chalcedony.

iv. Emerald.

v. Sardonyx.

vi. Ruby.

[Fol. 5

vii. Chrysolite.

viii. Beryl.

ix. Topaz.

x. Chrysoprasus.

Iacynghe] *Iacynth* (?).

xi. Jacinth.

xii. Amethyst.

The city was square.

The wall was of jasper.

Twelve thousand furlongs in
 length and breadth.

Each "pane" had three gates.

Each gate adorned with a pearl

þe aldest ay fyrst þer-on wat3 done.
 Such ly3t þer lemed *in* alle þe strate3
 1044 Hem nedde nawþer sunne ne mone.

Of sunne ne mone had þay no nede
 þe self god wat3 her lompe ly3t,
 þe lombe her lantyrne *with*-outen drede,
 1048 þur3 hym blysned þe bor3 al bry3t.
 þur3 wo3e & won my lokyng zede,
 For sotyle cler mo3t lette no ly3t;
 þe hy3e trone þer mo3t 3e hede
 1052 *With* alle þe apparaylmente vmbe-py3te,
 As Iohan þe appostel in terme3 ty3te;
 þe hy3e gode3 self hit set vpone.
 A reuer of þe trone þer ran out-ry3te
 1056 Wat3 bry3ter þen boþe þe sunne & mone.

.CH IN HEAVEN.

32 Sunne ne mone schon neuer so swete;
 A! þat foyssoun flode out of þat flet,
 Swyþe hit swange þur3 vch a strete,
 1060 *With*-outen fylþe oþer galle oþer glet.
 Kyrk þer-inne wat3 non 3ete,
 Chapel ne temple þat euer wat3 set,
 þe al-my3ty wat3 her mynyster mete,
 1064 þe lombe þe saker-fyse þer to reget;
 þe 3ates stoken wat3 neuer 3et,
 Bot euer more vpen at vche a lone;
 þer entre3 non to take reset,
 1068 þat bere3 any spot an-vnder mone.

The mone may þer-of acroche no my3te
 To spotty, ho is of body to grym,
 & al-so þer ne is neuer ny3t.
 1072 What schulde þe mone þer compas clym
 & to euen wyth þat worþly ly3t,
 þat schyne3 vpon þe broke3 brym?
 þe planete3 arn *in* to pouer a ply3t,
 1076 & þe self sunne ful fer to dym.
 Aboute þat water arn tres ful schym,
 þat twelue fryte3 of lyf con bere ful sone;
 Twelue syþe3 on 3er þay beren ful frym
 1080 & re-nowle3 nwe *in* vche a mone.

An-vnder mone so gret merwayle
 No fleschly hert ne my3t endeure,
 As quen I blusched vpon þat baly,
 1084 So ferly þer-of wat3 þe falure.
 I stod as styлле as dased quayle,
 For ferly of þat french fygure,
 þat felde I nawþer reste ne *trau*ayle,
 1088 So wat3 I rauyste wyth glymme pure;
 For I dar say, *with* conciens sure,
 Hade bodyly burne abiden þat bone,
 þa3 alle clerke3 hym hade *in* cure,
 1092 His lyf wer loste an-vnder mone.

Such light gleamed in all the
 streets, that there was no need
 the sun or moon.

[Fol. 5

lompe] MS. *lombe*.

God was the light of those in the
 city.

mo3t] MS. *no3t*.

The high throne might be seen
 upon which the “high God” sat.

A river ran out of the throne;

it flowed through each street.

No church was seen.

God was the church; Christ the
 sacrifice.

The gates were ever open.

an-vnder] MS. *an-vnde3*.

There is no night in the city.

ly3t] Or *sy3t*.

The planets, and the sun itself,
 dim compared to the divine light.

Trees there renew their fruit every
 month.

[Fol. 5

The beholder of this fair city
 stood still as a “dased quail.”

french] *fresch* (?).

XX.

33 **R**yȝt as þe maynful mone con rys,
 Er þenne þe day-glem dryue al doun,
 So sodanly on a wonder wyse,
 109d watȝ war of a prosessyoun,
 Þis noble cite of ryche enpresse
 Watȝ sodanly ful *with-ou*ten sommoun
 Of such *vergyneȝ* in þe same gyse
 110d þat watȝ my blysfyl an-vnder croun,
 & coronde wern alle of þe same fasoun
 Depaynt in perleȝ & wedeȝ qwyte,
 In vchoneȝ breste watȝ bounden boun,
 110d þe blysfyl perle *with gret* delyt.
 With gret delyt þay glod in fere,
 On golden gateȝ þat glent as glasse;
 Hundreth þowsandeȝ I wot þer were,
 1108 & alle in sute her liureȝ wasse,
 Tor to know þe gladdest chere.
 Þe lombe byfore con proudly passe,
 Wyth horneȝ seuen of red *golde* cler,
 1112 As praysed perleȝ his wedeȝ wasse;
 Towarde þe throne þay trone a tras.
 Þaȝ þay wern fele no pres in plyt,
 Bot mylde as maydeneȝ seme at mas,
 1116 So droȝ þay forth *with gret* delyt.
 Delyt þat hys come encroched,
 To much hit were of for to melle;
 Þise alder men quen he aproched,
 1120 Grouelyng to his fete þay felle;
 Legyounes of aungeleȝ togeder uoched,
 Þer kesten ensens of swete smelle,
 Þen glory & gle watȝ nwe abroched.
 1124 Al songe to *loue* þat gay luelle,
 Þe steuen moȝt stryke þurȝ þe vrþe to helle,
 Þat þe *vertues* of heuen of loye endyte,
 To loue þe lombe his meyny in melle,
 1128 d-wysse I laȝt a gret delyt;
 Delit þe lombe forto deuise,
 With much meruayle in mynde went.
 34 Best watȝ he, blypest & moste to pryse,
 1132 þat euer I herde of speche spent,
 So worþly whyt wern wedeȝ hys;
 His lokeȝ symple, hym self so gent,
 Bot a wounde ful wyde & weete con wyse
 1136 An-ende hys hert þurȝ hyde to-rente;
 Of his quyte syde his blod out-sprent,
 A-las! þoȝt I, who did þat spyt?
 Ani breste for bale aȝt haf for-brent,
 1140 Er he þer-to hade had delyt,

As the moon began to rise he was
aware of a procession

of virgins crowned with pearls

in white robes,
with a pearl in their breast.
with gret] MS. *with outen*.

As they went along they shone
glass.

The Lamb went before them.
golde] MS. *glode*.

There was no pressing.

[Fol. 5

The "alder men" fell groveling
the feet of the Lamb.

All sang in praise of the Lamb

The Lamb wore white weeds.

A wide wound was seen near his
breast.

The lombe delyt non lyste to wene,
 þaȝ he were hurt & wounde hade,
 In his sembelaunt watȝ neuer sene,
 1144 So wern his glenteȝ glorious glade.
 I loked among his meyny schene,
 How þay wyth lyf wern laste & lade,
 Þen saȝ I þer my lyttel quene,
 1148 Þat I wende had standen by me in sclade;
 Lorde! much of mirþe watȝ þat ho made,
 Among her fereȝ þat watȝ so quyt!
 Þat syȝt me gart to þenk to wade,
 1152 For luf longyng in gret delyt.

Joy was in his looks.

The father perceives his little queen.

XXI.

Delyt me drof in yȝe & ere,
 My maneȝ mynde to maddyng malte;
 Quen I seȝ my frely I wolde be þere,
 1156 Byȝonde þe water, þaȝ ho were walte,
 I þoȝt þat no þyng myȝt me dere
 To fech me bur & take me halte;
 & to start in þe strem schulde non me stere,
 1160 To swymme þe remnaunt, þaȝ I þer swalte,
 Bot of þat munt I watȝ bi-talt;
 When I schulde start in þe strem astraye,
 Out of þat caste I watȝ by-calt;
 1164 Hit watȝ not at my prynceȝ paye,

[Fol. 5

Great delight takes possession
 his mind.

He attempts to cross the stream

It was not pleasing to the Lord

35

IER OF THE MAIDEN AWAKES.

Hit payed hym not þat I so flonc,
 Ouer meruelous mereȝ so mad arayde,
 Of raas þaȝ I were rasch & ronk,
 1168 Ȝet rapely þer-inne I watȝ restayed;
 For ryȝt as I sparred vn-to þe bonc,
 Þat brathe out of my drem me brayde;
 Þen wakned I in þat erber wlonk,
 1172 My hede vpon þat hylle watȝ layde,
 Þer as my perle to grounde strayd;
 I raxled & fel in gret affray,
 & sykyng to my self I sayd:
 1176 "Now al be to þat prynceȝ paye."

The dreamer awakes,

and is in great sorrow.

Me payed ful ille to be out-fleme,
 So sodenly of þat fayre regioun,
 Fro alle þo syȝteȝ so quykeȝ & queme.
 1180 A longeyng heuy me strok in swone,
 & rewfully þenne I con to reme;
 "O perle," quod I, "of rych renoun,
 So watȝ hit me dere þat þou con deme,
 1184 In þys veray avysyoun;
 If hit be ueray & soth sermoun,
 Þat þou so stykeȝ in garlande gay,
 So wel is me in þys doel dounoun,
 1188 Þat þou art to þat prynseȝ paye."

He addresses his pearl;

If] MS. *inf*.

laments his rash curiosity.

To þat prynce3 paye hade I ay bente,
 & 3erned no more þen wat3 me geuen,
 & halden me þer in trwe entent,
 1192As þe perle me prayed þat wat3 so þryuen,
 As helde drawen to godde3 present,
 To mo of his mysterys I hade ben dryuen.
 Bot ay wolde man of happe more hente
 1196þen mo3ten by ry3t vpon hem clyuen;
 þer-fore my ioie wat3 sone to-riuen,
 & I kaste of kythe3 þat laste3 aye.
 Lorde! mad hit arn þat agayn þe stryuen,
 1200Oþer proferen þe o3t agayn þy paye;

Men desire more than they have
 any right to expect.

36
 E US GRACE TO SERVE HIM.

To pay þe prince oþer sete sa3te,
 Hit is ful eþe to þe god krystyn;
 For I haf founden hym boþe day & na3te,
 1204A god, a lorde, a frende ful fyin.
 Ouer þis hyl þis lote I la3te,
 For pyty of my perle enclyin,
 & syþen to god I hit by-ta3te,
 1208In kryste3 dere blessing & myn,
 þat in þe forme of bred & wyn,
 þe preste *vus* schewe3 vch a daye;
 He gef *vus* to be his homly hyne,
 1212Ande precious perle3 vnto his pay. Amen. Amen.

The good Christian knows how
 make peace with God.

hyl] MS. *hyiil*.
 1864 edition had "hyiil", with
 note "*hye-hil* or *hyul*?"

God give us grace to be his
 servants!

105

NOTES TO THE PEARL.

The Notes were printed in a group, immediately before the Index. They have been distributed among the three poems for convenience.

Page 1. 1. 2, *to*, very.

8 *sengeley in synglure*, ever in singleness (uniqueness).

Now is Susan in sale *sengeliche* arayed.

Pistel of Susan, Vernon MS., fol. 317.

11 *dewyne*, pine; *for-dolked*, for-wounded (severely hurt).

16 *heuen my happe*, increase my happiness.

17 *þrych my hert þrange*, through my heart pierce.

20 *style stounde*, a secret sorrow.

23 *O moul þou marrez a myry mele*,

O mould (earth) thou spoilest a merry discourse.

P. 2. 1. 27 *Blome3 blayke & blwe & rede*,

Flowers yellow, blue, and red.

49 *spenned*, wrung.

51, 52 A secret grief in my heart dinned (resounded),

Though reason set myself at peace.

53 *spenned*, allured, enticed away.

54 *Wyth fyrte skylle3 þat faste fa3t,*
 With trembling doubts that fast fought (struggled).

P. 3. 1. 76 bolle3 = *bole3*, trunks of trees.

78 *on vch a tynde*, on each branch.

92 *reken myrþe*, pleasant, joyous mirth.

P. 4. 1. 99 *Þe derþe þer-of*, the value (preciousness) thereof.

101 *in wely wyse*, in joyful mood.

102 *dere3*, injuries, harms.

103 *fyrre*, farther.

105 *rawe3 & rande3*, borders and paths.

107 *I wan to*, I reached. *Winne* in O.E. was used much in the same way as we now employ the word *get*.

112 *Wyth a rownande rourde raykande ary3t,*

 With a murmuring (whispering) sound flowing aright.

113 *founce*, bottom; *stepe*, bright.

114 *glente*, shone; *gly3t*, glistened.

115 *A[s] stremande sterne3*, as glittering stars; *stroþe*, stout, brave.

119 *lo3e*, deep.

125 *dry3ly hale3*, strongly (or deeply) flows.

126 *bred ful* = *bred-ful* = *bretful* (?), full to the brim.

P. 5. 1. 131 *wayne3*, grants.

132 *hitte3*, seeks.

138 *gayn*, opposite.

142 *I hopede þat mote merked wore,*

 I supposed that building was devised.

149 *stote & stare*, stand (loiter) and gape.

106 150-1 *To fynde a forþe, faste con I fonde,*

Bot woþe3 mo I-wysse þer ware,

 To find a way fast did I go,

 But paths more indeed there were.

153 *wonde*, cease, abstain (from fear).

155 *nwe note*, a new matter.

163 *blysnande whyt*, glistening white. See 197.

P. 6. 1. 165 *schere*, purify, refine.

169 *Þe more I frayste hyr fayre face.*

 The more I examined her fair face.

frayst (*fraist*) usually signifies to try, tempt.

170 *fonte*, tried, examined, *found*.

176 *Such a burre my3t make myn herte blunt,*

 Such a blow might make mine heart faint.

179 *Þat stonge myn hert ful stray atount,*

Should we not read—*Þat stonge myn hert ful stray a stount* (?), “full stray a stount” = a blow full stray.

187 *chos*, was following, was seeking.

188 *Er I at steuen hir mo3t stalle,*

 Before I could place her within reach of discourse.

190 *seme* = *semely*, seemly.

- P. 7. 1. 208 *flurten*, figured. Cf. *flurt-silk*, figured-silk.
 210 *Her here heke al hyr vmbe-gon*,
 Her hair eke (also) all her about gone.
 212 *Her ble more blaȝt*, her complexion whiter.
 213 *schorne golde schyr*, refined gold pure.
 216 *porfyl*, hem of a dress, or rather an embroidered hem.
 217 *poyned*, ornamented, trimmed.
 223-4 *A mannez dom myȝt dryȝly demme*,
Er mynde moȝt malte in hit mesure,
 A man's judgment might greatly dim,
 Before (his) mind could discourse of it in sufficient terms of praise.
 226 *No = ne* (nor) would be a better reading.
 230 *wyȝer half*, opposite side.
- P. 8. 1. 243 *myn one*, myself.
 244 *layned*, kept secret, hidden.
 251 *Fro*, from the time that. *towen & twayned*, made two and separated.
- P. 9. 1. 272 *is put in pref*, has been proved.
 275 *bote of þy meschef*, the remedy of thy misfortune (misery).
 290 *Wy borde ȝe men so madde ȝe be?*
 Why should you talk, so foolish you are?
- P. 10. 1. 307 *westernays*, wrongly, in vain? It may be another form of westernways, from the A.Sax. *wéste*, barren, empty; *wéstern*, a desert place. Or is it connected with A.Sax. *winstre*, the left hand?
 320 *Þy corse in clot mot colder keue*,
 Thy body in earth (clods) must colder plunge.
 321 *for-garte* forfeited.
 322 *ȝore fader for form-fader*, first-father.
 323 *drwry = drery*, dreary (?). *boȝ (= bos = bus ?) vch ma (man ?) dreue*, behoves each man to drive (go). See B. l. 687.
 327-8 *Now haf I fonte þat I for-lete*
Schal I efte forgo hit er euer I fyne?
 Now I have found what I have lost.
 Shall I again forego it ere ever I die?
- ¹⁰⁷P. 11. 1. 336 *durande doel*, lasting grief.
 343 *For anger gaynez þe not a cresse*,
 For anger avails the not a cress, (i.e. not a mite).
 Cf. the following passage from "Piers Ploughman," p. 174, l. 5629:
 "Wisdom and wit now
 Is noght worth a *kerse*."
 353 *Stynst (stynt?) of þy strot & fyne to flyte*,
 Leave off thy complaining and cease to chide.
 354 *blyþe* is here used as a substantive in the sense of bliss, joy. *swefte* = swift.
 356 *hyr craftez kype*, manifest her powers.
 359-60 *For marre oper madde, morne & myþe*,
Al lys in him to dyȝt & deme.
 For to ruin, or make foolish, grieve or to soothe,
 All lies in him to order and doom.
 363 *If rapely raue*, etc. = *If rapely I raue*, etc. (?)

- 368 Though I go astray, my dear, adored one.
- P. 12. l. 369 *lypeȝ*, grant.
- 374 *Bot much þe bygger ȝet watȝ my mon,*
Fro þou watȝ wroken fro vch a woþe.
 But much the greater yet was my moan (sorrow),
 From (the time) thou wast banished from every path.
- 377 *now leþeȝ my loþe*, now my sorrow ceases (is softened).
- 382 *marereȝ* = *mareȝ* (?).
- 386 *mate*, dejected.
- 402 *I hete þe*, I promise the.
- P. 14. l. 446 *in hyt self beyng*, in its very being.
- 455 *gyng*, company.
- 460 *Temen*, are united, joined. *tryste*, trusty, faithful, firm.
- P. 16. l. 511 *wryþen*, toil, literally to turn, twist.
- 512 *keruen*, dig. *caggen*, draw. *man* = *maken*, make. Cf. *ma* = make, *ta* = take, *tan* = taken.
- 522 *toȝt*, binding, firm.
- 524 *pray* (so in MS.), read *pay*.
- 536 *at ȝe moun*, that ye are able.
- P. 17. l. 560 *a grete*, in the gross, a head.
- 563 *plete*, plead, ask for.
- 572 *be* = *he* (?).
- P. 18. l. 575 *Þaȝ her sweng wyth lyttel at-slykeȝ*,
 Though their labour (blow) with little falls off (fails to accomplish much).
- 605 *chyche*, niggard.
- 608 *goteȝ*, streams; *charde*, past tense of *charre*, to turn, deviate.
- P. 19. l. 617 *bourne abate* = *burne abade*, man continued.
- 626 *by lyne*, by lineage descent.
- P. 20. l. 645 *Bot þer on com a bote as-tyt*,
 But there came one as a remedy at once.
- 659 *in sely stounde*, in a happy moment.
- 671 *glente*, fell, slid.
- P. 21. l. 680 *dylle*, slow, sluggish.
- 681 *dȝt* = *dyde*, did (?), or *dotȝ*, does (?).
- 690 *oure*, prayer.
- P. 22. l. 726 *sulpande synne*, defiling, polluting, sin.
- 727 *bylde*, building.
- 735 *reme*, realm.
- P. 23. l. 752 *Of carpe*, discourse of.
- 754 *hauyng*, condition, behaviour.
- 757 *bete*, save, ransom.
- 759 *make*, wife.
- 775 *vnder cambe* = *under-cam*, came under, took an inferior position (?).
- P. 24. l. 802 *& as a lombe þat clypper in lande nem*,
 And as a lamb that a *shearer* has taken, etc.

- 813-4 For us he let himself be scourged and buffeted, and stretched upon a rough tree (*i.e.* nailed to the cross).
- P. 25. I. 836 *as bare*, (?) *al bare*, openly. See 1025.
 837 *Lesande þe boke with leuez sware*,
 Opening the book with leaves square.
 839 *& at þat syȝt vche douth con dare*,
 And at that sight each doughty (one) did tremble (with fear).
 849 *enle* = *eneli* = onely or *onlepi* (?) = singly, alone.
- P. 26. I. 865 *talle farande* = *tale farande*, pleasing story.
 873 *hue*, cry, voice.
 876 *lote*, sound.
- P. 27. I. 896 *lote*, features.
 909 *hynde* = *hende*, gentle, courteous (one).
 911 *bustwys as a blose*, boisterous (wild) as a blaze (flame).
 916 *With nay þou neuer my ruful bone*,
 Do thou never refuse my mournful request.
- P. 28. I. 948 *So is hys mote with-uten moote*,
 So is his building without mote (blemish).
- P. 29. II. 975-6 *& I an-endeȝ þe on his syde*
Schal sve, tyl þou to a hil be veued,
 And I opposite thee on this side
 Shall go, till thou to a hill be passed.
 980-81 *& blusched on þe burghe, as I forth dreued*,
Byȝonde þe brok fro me warde keued,
 And looked on the city, as I forth drove (urged),
 Beyond the brook that cut me off from (the object of my desire).
- P. 30. I. 1018 *Masporye* = *was pure* (?).
 1022 *brode & stayre*, broad and steep (high).
 1026 *þat glent as glayre*, that shone as amber.
- P. 31. I. 1030 *fon*, ceased, the preterite of *fine*.
 1038 *fateȝ* = *fadeȝ*, fades.
 1041 *whateȝ* = *watȝ*, was.
- P. 32. II. 1065-66 *Þe ȝates stoken watȝ neuer ȝet*,
Bot euer more vpen at vche a lone.
 The gates shut were never yet,
 But ever more open at every lane.
 1073 *to euen with*, to equal with, to match with.
 1084 *falure* = *fasure*, form (?).
- P. 33. I. 1124 *to loue*, to praise.
 1127 *in melle* = *in-melle* = *i-melle*, among. Cf. *in-lyche* and *i-lyche*, etc.
- P. 34. I. 1141 *Þe lombe delyt non lyste to wene*,
 The lamb's delight none desired to doubt.
 1146 *laste and lade*, followed and preceded (?).
 1161 *Bot of þat munt I watȝ bi-talt*,
 But from that purpose I was aroused (shaken).
 1163 *bi-calt* = *bi-called* (?), called away.

- P. 35. l. 1165 *flonc* = *flong* (?), flung.
 1193 *helde*, willingly (inclined).

37

CLEANNES.

I.

- C**lannesse who-so kyndly cowþe comende, [Fol. 5
 & rekken vp alle þe resounþ þat ho by riȝt askeþ,
 Fayre formeþ myȝt he fynde in forering his speche,
 4 & in þe contraré, kark & combraunce huge;
 For wonder wroth is þe wyȝ þat wroȝt alle þinges,
 Wyth þe freke þat in fylþe folȝes hym after,
 As renkeþ of relygioun þat reden & syngen,
 8 & aprochen to hys presens, & presteþ arn called;
 Thay teen vnto his temple & temen to hym seluen,
 Reken with reuerence þay r[ec]hen his auter,
 Þay hondel þer his aune body & vsen hit boþe.
 12 If þay in clannes be clos þay cleche gret mede,
 Bot if þay conterfete crafte, & cortaysye wont,
 As be honest vtwyth, & in-with alle fylþeþ,
 Þen ar þay synful hemself & sulped altogeder,
 16 Boþe god & his gere, & hym to greme cachen.
 He is so clene in his courte, þe kyng þat al weldeþ,
 & honeste in his hous-holde & hagherlych serued,
 With angeleþ enourled in alle þat is clene,
 20 Boþe with-inne & with-uten, in wedeþ ful bryȝt.
 Nif he nere scoymus & skyg & non scape louied,
 Hit were a meruayl to much, hit moȝt not falle;
 Kryst kydde hit hym self in a carp oneȝ,
 24 Þer as he heuened aȝt happeþ & hyȝt hem her medeȝ;
 Me myneþ on one amonge oþer, as mapew recordeþ,
 Þat þus of clannesse vn-closeþ a ful cler speche.
 38 Þe habel clene of his hert hapeneþ ful fayre,
 28 For he schal loken on oure lorde with a bone chere,
 As so saytȝ, to þat syȝt seche schal he neuer,
 Þat any vnclannesse hatȝ on, anwhere abowte:
 For he þat flemus vch fylþe fer fro his hert,
 32 May not byde þat burne þat hit his body neȝen;
 For-þy hyȝ not to heuen in hatereȝ to-torne,
 Ne in þe harloteȝ hod & handeȝ vnwaschen;
 For what vrpþy habel þat hyȝ honour haldeȝ
 36 Wolde lyke, if a ladde com lyþerly attyred,
 When he were sette solempnely in a sete ryche,
 Abouf dukes on dece, with dayntys serued,
 Þen þe harlot with haste helded to þe table
 40 With rent cokreȝ at þe kne & his clutte trasches,
 & his tabarde to-torne & his toteȝ oute;
 Oþer ani on of alle þyse he schulde be halden vtter,
- Cleanness discloses fair forms
 God is angry with the unclean worshipper,
 and with false priests.
 The pure worshipper receives great reward.
 The impure will bring upon th the anger of God, Who is pure and holy.
 It would be a marvel if God di not hate evil.
 Christ showed us that himself.
 St. Matthew records the discourse.
 The clean of heart shall look o our Lord.
anwhere] *aywhere* (?).
burne] Looks like *burre* in N
 What earthly noble, when seat at table
 [Fol. 5
 above dukes, would like to see lad badly attired approach the table
 with "rent cockers," his coat to and his toes out?

With mony blame ful bygge, a boffet, *peraunter*,
 44 Hurlled to þe halle dore & harde *per*-oute schowued,
 & be forboden þat borȝe to bowe þider neuer,
 On payne of enprysonment & puttyng in stokkeȝ;
 & þus schal he be schent for his schrowde feble,
 48 Þaȝ neuer in talle ne in tuch he trespass more.
 & if vnwelcum he were to a worþlych pryncce
 Ȝet hym is þe hyȝe kyng harder in her euen,

ABLE OF THE MARRIAGE FEAST.

As mapew meleȝ in his masse of þat man ryche,
 52 Þat made þe mukel mangerye to marie his here dere,
 & sende his sonde þen to say þat þay samne schulde,
 & in comly quoyntis to com to his feste;
 “For my boles & my boreȝ arn bayted & slayne,
 56 & my fedde fouleȝ fatted *with* sclazȝ,
 My polyle þat is penne-fed & partrykes boþe,
 Wyth scheldeȝ of wylde swyn, swaneȝ & croneȝ;
 Al is roþeled & rosted ryȝt to þe sete,
 60 Comeȝ cof to my corte, er hit colde worþe.”

IVITED TO THE FEAST REFUSE TO COME.

When þay knewen his cal þat þider com schulde,
 Alle ex-cused hem by þe skyly he scape by moȝt:
 39 On hade boȝt hym a borȝ he sayde by hys trawþe,
 64 Now t[ur]ne I þeder als tyd, þe toun to by-holde;
 An oþer nayed also & nurned þis cawse:
 I haf ȝerned & ȝat ȝokkeȝ of oxen,
 & for my hyȝeȝ hem boȝt, to bowe haf I mester,
 68 To see hem pulle in þe plow aproche me byhoueȝ;
 & I haf wedded a wyf, *sower* hym þe þryd,
 Excuse me at þe court, I may not com þere;
 Þus þay droȝ hem adreȝ *with* daunger vchone,
 72 Þat non passed to þe place þaȝ he prayed were.
 Thenne þe ludyh lorde lyked ful ille
 & hade dedayn of þat dede, ful dryȝly he carpeȝ:
 He saytȝ “now for her owne sorȝe þay for-saken habbeȝ,
 76 More to wyte is her wrange, þen any wylle gentyl;
 Þenne gotȝ forth my gomeȝ to þe grete streeteȝ,
 & forsetteȝ on vche a syde þe cete aboute;
 Þe wayferande frekeȝ, on fote & on hors,
 80 Boþe burneȝ & burdeȝ, þe better & þe wers,
 Lapeȝ hem alle luflyly to lenge at my fest,
 & bryngeȝ hem blyþly to borȝe as barouneȝ þay were,
 So þat my palays plat-ful be pyȝt al aboute,
 84 Þise oþer wrecheȝ I-wysse worþy noȝt wern.”
 Þen þay cayred & com þat þe cost waked,
 Broȝten bachlereȝ hem wyth þat þay by bonkeȝ metten,
 Swyereȝ þat swyftly swyed on blonkeȝ,
 88 & also fele vpon fote, of fre & of bonde.
 When þay com to þe courte keppte wern þay fayre,
 Styȝtled *with* þe stewarde, stad in þe halle,
 Ful manerly *with* marchal mad forto sitte,
 92 As he watȝ dere of de-gre dressed his seete.
 Þenne seggeȝ to þe souerayn sayden þer-after,

For any one of these he would
 turned out with a “big buffet,”
 and be forbidden to re-enter,

 and thus be ruined through his
 vile clothes.

The parable of the “Marriage of
 the King’s Son.”

The king’s invitation.

Those invited begin to make
 excuses.

One had bought an estate and
 must go to see it.

Another had purchased some
 oxen and wished to see them “
 in the plough.”

A third had married a wife and
 could not come.

sower] *swer* (?).

place] MS. *plate*.

[Fol. 5

The Lord was greatly displeas

and commanded his servants to
 invite the wayfaring,

both men and women, the bett
 and the worse,

that his palace might be full.

The servants brought in bache
 and squires.

When they came to the court t
 were well entertained.

“Lo! lorde *with your* leue at *your* lege heste,
& at þi banne we haf broȝt, as þou beden habbeȝ,

THE BLIND ARE INVITED.

The servants tell their lord that
they have done his behest, and
there is still room for more guests.

The Lord commands them to go
out into the fields,

- 96 Mony renischche renkeȝ & ȝet is roum more.”
Sayde þe lorde to þo ledeȝ, “layteȝ ȝet ferre,
Ferre out *in* þe felde, & fecheȝ mo gesteȝ,
40 Wayteȝ gorsteȝ & greueȝ, if ani gomeȝ lyggeȝ,
100 What-kyn folk so þer fare, fecheȝ hem hider,
Be þay fers, be þay feble for-loteȝ none,
Be þay hol, be þay halt, be þay onȝed,
& þaȝ þay ben boþe blynde & balterande cruppeleȝ,
104 Þat my hous may holly by halkes by fylled;
For certeȝ þyse ilk renkeȝ þat me renayed habbe
& de-nounced me, noȝt now at þis tyme,
Schul neuer sitte in my sale my soper to fele,
108 Ne suppe on sope of my seve, þaȝ þay swelt schulde.”
Thenne þe sergaunteȝ, at þat sawe, swengen þer-oute,
& diden þe dede þat [is] demed, as he deuised hade,
& *with* peple of alle plyteȝ þe palays þay fyllen;
112 Hit weren not alle on wyueȝ suneȝ, wonen *with* on fader;
Wheþer þay wern worþy, oþer wers, wel wern þay stowed,
Ay þe best byfore & bryȝtest atyred,
Be derrest at þe hyȝe dese þat dubbed wer fayrest;
116 & syþen on lenþe bilooȝhe ledeȝ inoȝh,
& ay a segge soerly semed by her wedeȝ;
So with marschal at her mete mensked þay were,
Clene men *in* compaynye for-knowen wern lyte,
120 & ȝet þe symplest in þat sale watȝ serued to þe fulle,
Boþe with menske, & *with* mete & mynstrasy noble,
& alle þe laykeȝ þat a lorde aȝt *in* londe schewe.
& þay bigonne to be glad þat god drink haden,
124 & vch mon *with* his mach made hym at ese.

for-loteȝ] forleteȝ (?).

and bring in the halt, blind, and
“one-eyed.”

For those who denied shall not
taste “one sup” to save them from
death.

þaȝ] MS. þaȝ þaȝ.

[Fol. 5

The palace soon became full of
“people of all plights.”

They were not all one wife’s son
nor had they all one father.

The “brightest attired” had the
best place.

Below sat those with “poor
weeds.”

soerly] soberly (?).

All are well entertained “with
meat and minstrelsy.”

Each with his “mate” made his
ease.

II.

- Now *in-myddes* þe mete þe mayster hym biȝoȝt,
þat he wolde se þe semblé þat samned was þere,
& re-hayte rekenly þe riche & þe poueren,
128 & cherisch hem alle *with* his cher, & chaufen her loye,
þen he boweȝ fro his bour *in* to þe brode halle,
& to þe best on þe bench, & bede hym be myry,
Solased hem *with* semblaunt & syled fyrr;
132 Tron fro table to table & talkede ay myrþe,

The lord of the feast goes among
his guests.

poueren] MS. poueuer.

Bids them be merry.

On the floor he finds one not
arrayed for a holyday.

WITHOUT A WEDDING GARMENT.

- Bot as he ferked ouer þe flor he fand *with* his yȝe,
Hit watȝ not for a haly day honestly arayed,
A þral þryȝt in þe þrong vnþryuandely cloped,
136 Ne no festiual frok, bot fyled *with* werkkeȝ.
þe gome watȝ vn-garnyst *with* god men to dele,
& gremed þer-*with* þe grete lord & greue hym he þoȝt;
“Say me, frende,” *quod* þe freke *with* a felle chere,

- 140 "Hov wan þou into þis won *in* wede3 so fowle?
 Þe abytt þat þou hat3 vpon, no haly day hit menske3;
 Þou burne for no brydale art busked *in* wede3!
 How wat3 þou hardy þis hous for þyn vnhap [to] ne3e,
 144 *In* on so ratted a robe & rent at þe syde3?
 Þow art a gome vn-goderly *in* þat gown febele;
 Þou praysed me & my place ful pouer & ful [g]nede,
 Þat wat3 so prest to aproche my presens here-inne;
 148 Hope3 þou I be a harlot þi erigant to prayse?"
 Þat oþer burne wat3 abayst of his broþe worde3,
 & hurkele3 down with his hede, þe vrþe he bi-holde3;
 He wat3 so scoumfit of his scylle, lest he skaþe hent,
 152 Þat he ne wyst on worde what he warp schulde.
 Þen þe lorde wonder loude laled & cryed,
 & talke3 to his tormenttoure3: "take3 hym," he bidde3,
 "Bynde3 byhynde, at his bak, boþe two his hande3,
 156 & felle fettere3 to his fete festene3 bylyue;
 Stik hym stifly *in* stoke3, & steke3 hym þer-after
 Depe *in* my doungeoun þer doel euer dwelle3,
 Greuing, & gretying, & gryspyng harde
 160 Of teþe tenfully to-geder, to teche hym be quoynt."
 Thus comparisune3 kryst þe kyndom of heuen,
 To þis frelych feste þat fele arn to called,
 For alle arn laped luflyly, þe luþer & þe better,
 164 Þat euer wern ful3ed *in* font þat fest to haue.
 Bot war þe wel, if þou wylt, þy wede3 ben clene,
 & honest for þe haly day, lest þou harme lache,
 For aproch þou to þat prynce of parag noble.
 168 He hates helle no more þen hem þat ar sowle.
 42 Wich arn þenne þy wede3 þou wrappe3 þe inne,
 Þat schal schewe hem so schene schrowde of þe best?
 Hit arn þy werke3 wyterly, þat þou wro3t haue3,
 172 & lyued *with* þe lykyng þat ly3e *in* þyn hert,
 Þat þo be frely & fresch fonde *in* þy lyue,
 & fetyse of a fayr forme, to fote & to honde,
 & syþen alle þyn oþer lyme3 lapped ful clene,
 176 Þenne may þou se þy sauior & his sete ryche.
 For fele faute3 may a freke forfeite his blysse,
 Þat he þe souerayn ne se þen, for slaue one,
 As for bobaunce & bost & bolnande priyde,
 180 Proly *in-to* þe deuele3 þrote man þrynge3 bylyue,
 For couetyse, & colwarde & croked dede3,
 For mon-sworne, & men-sclazt, & to much drynk,
 For þefte, & for þrepyng, vn-þonk may mon haue;
 184 For roborrye, & riboudrye & resoune3 vntrwe,
 & dysheriete & depryue dowrie of wydoe3,
 For marryng of maryage3 & mayntnaunce of schrewe3,
 For traysoun, & trichcherye, & tyrauntyré boþe,
 188 & for fals famacions & fayned lawe3;
 Man may mysse þe myrþe, þat much is to prayse,
 For such vnpewe3 as þise & þole much payne,
 & *in* þe creatores cort com neuer more,
 192 Ne neuer see hym with sy3t for such sour tourne3.

Asks him how he obtained
 entrance, and how he was so b
 as to appear in such rags.

[Fol. 5

Does he take him to be a harlo

The man becomes discomfited

He is unable to reply.

The lord commands him to be
 bound,

and cast into a deep dungeon.

This feast is likened to the
 kingdom of heaven, to which
 are invited.

See that thy weeds are clean.

sowle] *fowle* (?)...

Thy weeds are thy works that
 thou hast wrought.

For many faults may a man fo
 bliss.

For sloth and pride he is thrust
 into the devil's throat.

[Fol. 5

He is ruined by covetousness,
 perjury, murder, theft, and stri

For robbery and ribaldry, for
 preventing marriages, and
 supporting the wicked,

boþe] *loþe* (?)

for treason, treachery, and
 tyranny, man may lose eternal
 bliss.

III.

Bot I haue herkned & herde of mony hyze clerkez,
 & als in resounes of ryzt red hit my seluen,
 þat þat ilk proper prynce þat paradys weldeþ
 196 Is displeased at vch a poynt þat plyes to scape.
 Bot neuer zet in no boke breued I herde
 þat euer he wreck so wyþerly on werk þat he made,
 Ne venged for no vilté of vice ne synne,
 200 Ne so hastyfly wat3 hot for hatel of his wylle,
 Ne neuer so sodenly sozt vn-soundely to weng,
 As for fylþe of þe flesch þat foles han vsed;
 43 For as I fynde þer he forzet alle his fre þewes,
 204 & wex wod to þe wrache, for wrath at his hert,
 For þe fyrste felonye þe falce fende wrozt.
 Why! he wat3 hyze in þe heuen houen vpon lofte,
 Of alle þyse aþel aungeleþ attled þe fayrest,
 208 & he vnkyndely as a karle kydde areward,
 He seþ nozt bot hym self how semly he were,
 Bot his souerayn he forsoke & sade þyse wordeþ:
 "I schal telde vp my trone in þe tra mountayne
 212 & by lyke to þat lorde þat þe lyft made.
 With þis worde þat he warp, þe wrake on hym lyzt,
 Drytyn with his dere dom hym drof to þe abyne,
 In þe mesure of his mode, his met3 neuer þe lasse,
 216 Bot þer he tynt þe tye dool of his tour ryche,
 Þa3 þe feloun were so fers for his fayre wedeþ
 & his glorious glem þat glent so bryzt;
 As sone as dryztyneþ dome drof to hym seluen,
 220 [Þi]kke þowsandeþ þro þrwen þer-oute

OF THE ANGELS.

Fellen fro þe fyrmament, fendeþ ful blake
 Weued at þe fyrst swap as þe snaw þikke,
 Hurléd in-to helle-hole as þe hyue swarmeþ;
 224 Fyltyr fenden folk forty dayeþ lenþe,
 Er þat styngande storme stynt ne myzt;
 Bot as smylt mele vnder smal siue smokes for-þikke,
 So fro heuen to helle þat hatel schor laste,
 228 On vche syde of þe worlde aywhere ilyche.
 Þis hit wat3 a brem brest & a byge wrache,
 & zet wrathed not þe wy3, ne þe wrech saztled,
 Ne neuer wolde, for wylnesful, his worþy god knawe,
 232 Ne pray hym for no pité, so proud wat3 his wylle,
 For-þy þa3 þe rape were rank, þe rawþe wat3 lyttel;
 Þa3 he be kest into kare he kepes no better.
 Bot þat oþer wrake þat wex on wyzeþ, hit lyzt
 236 Þur3 þe faut of a freke þat fayled in trawþe.
 Adam in obedyent ordaynt to blysse,
 Þer pryuely in paradys his place wat3 de-vised,
 44 To lyue þer in lykyng þe lenþe of a terme,
 240 & þenne en-herite þat home þat aungeleþ for-gart,
 Bot þur3 þe eggyng of eue he ete of an apple
 þat en-poysened alle pepleþ þat parted fro hem boþe,
 For a defence þat wat3 dyzt of dryztyn seluen,

The high Prince of all is displeased with those who would wickedly.

For the first fault the devil committed, he felt God's vengeance.

He, the fairest of all angels, forsook his sovereign,

and boasted that his throne should be as high as God's.

For these words he was cast down to hell.

[Fol. 6

The fiends fell from heaven,
Weued] *wened* (?).
 like the thick snow, for forty days

From heaven to hell the show lasted.

Þis] *zis* (?).

The devil would not make peace with God.

lyttel] MS. *lyttel*.

Affliction makes him none the better.

For the fault of one, vengeance alighted upon all men.

obedyent] *obedience* (?).

Adam was ordained to live in bliss.

Through Eve he ate an apple.

244 & a payne þer-on put & pertly halden;
 þe defence wat3 þe fryt þat þe freke towched,
 & þe dom is þe deþe þat drepe3 *vus* alle.
 Al *in* mesure & meþe wat3 mad þe vengiaunce,
 248 & efte amended *with* a mayden þat make hade neuer.

KEDNESS OF THE ANTEDILUVIAN WORLD.

IV.

Bot in þe þryd wat3 forþrast al þat þryue schuld,
 þer wat3 malys mercyles & mawgre much scheued,
 þat wat3 for fylþe vpon folde þat þe folk vsed,
 252 [þ]at þen wonyed *in* þe worlde *with*-outen any mayster3;
 Hit wern þe fayrest of forme & of face als,
 þe most & þe myriest þat maked wern euer,
 þe styfest, þe stalworþest þat stod euer on fete;
 256 & lengest lyf *in* hem lent of lede3 alle oþer,
 For hit was þe forme-foster þat þe folde bred,
 þe aþel auncetere3 sune3 þat adam wat3 called,
 To wham god hade geuen alle þat gayn were,
 260 Alle þe blysse boutte blame þat bodi my3t haue,
 & þose lykkest to þe lede þat lyued next after,
 For-þy so semly to see syþen wern none.
 þer wat3 no law to hem layd bot loke to kynde,
 264 & kepe to hit, & alle hit cors clanly ful-fylle;
 & þenne founden þay fylþe *in* fleschlych dede3
 & controeued agayn kynde contraré werke3,
 & vsed hem vn-þryftyly vchon on oþer,
 268 & als with oþer, wylsfully, vpon a wrange wyse.
 So ferly fowled her flesch þat þe fende loked,
 How þe de3ter of þe douþe wern dere-lych fayre,
 & fallen *in* fela3schyp *with* hem on folken wyse
 272 & en-gendered on hem icaunte3 *with* her lape3 ille.
 45 þose wern men meþele3 & ma3ty on vrþe,
 þat for her lodlych layke3 alosed þay were.
 He wat3 famed for fre þat fe3t loued best,
 276 & ay þe bigest *in* bale þe best wat3 halden;
 & þenne euele3 on erþe earnestly grewen
 & multiplyed mony-folde *in*-monge3 mankynde,
 For þat þe ma3ty on molde so marre þise oþer.
 280 þat þe wy3e þat al wro3t ful wroþly bygynne3.
 When he knew vche contre corrupte *in* hit seluen,
 & vch freke forloyned fro þe ry3t waye3,
 Felle temptande tene towched his hert;
 284 As wy3e, wo hym *with*-inne werp to hym seluen:
 “Me for-þynke3 ful much þat euer I mon made,
 Bot I schal delyuer & do away þat doten on þis molde,

ERMINES TO DESTROY ALL FLESH.

& fleme out of þe folde al þat flesch were3,
 288 Fro þe burne to þe best, fro brydde3 to fysche3;
 Al schal doun & be ded & dryuen out of erþe,
 þat euer I sette saule *inne*; & sore hit me rwe3
 þat euer I made hem my self; bot if I may her-after,

Thus all his descendants becar
 poisoned.

A maiden brought a remedy fo
 mankind.

Malice was merciless.

A race of men came into the
 world,

[Fol. 6

the fairest, the merriest, and th
 strongest that ever were create

They were sons of Adam.

No law was laid upon them.

Nevertheless they acted
 unnaturally.

The “*fiends*” beheld how fair v
 the daughters of these mighty
 men,

and made fellowship with ther
 and begat a race of giants.

famed] *fained* (?).

The greatest fighter was recko
 the most famous.

The Creator of all becomes
 exceedingly wroth.

Fell anger touches His heart.

It repents Him that He has ma
 man.

He declares that all flesh shall
 destroyed, both man and beast

[Fol. 6

292 I schal wayte to be war her wrenche3 to kepe.”
Benne in worlde wat3 a wy3e wonyande on lyue,
Ful redy & ful ry3twys, & rewled hym fayre;
In þe drede of dry3tyn his daye3 he vse3,
 296 & ay glydande wyth his god his *grace* wat3 þe more.
Hym wat3 þe nome Noe, as is innoghe knawen,
He had þre þryuen sune3 & þay þre wyue3;
Sem soþly þat on, þat oþer hy3t cam
 300 & þe Iolef Iapheth wat3 gendered þe þryd.
Now god in nwy to Noe con speke,
Wylde wrakful worde3 in his wylle greued:
“Þe ende of alle-kyne3 flesch þat on vrþe meue3,
 304 Is fallen forþ wyth my face & forþer hit I þenk,
With her vn-worþelych werk me wlate3 with-inne,
þe gore þer-of me hat3 greued & þe glette nwyed;
I schal strenkle my distresse & strye al to-geder,
 308 Boþe lede3 & londe & alle þat lyf habbe3.

There was at this time living o
 the earth a very righteous man

Noah was his name.

Three bold sons he had.

God in great anger speaks to
 Noah.

Declares that He will destroy a
 “that life has.”

Commands him to make “a
 mansion” with dwellings for w
 and tame.

with-inne] MS. *withinne*

To let the ark be three hundred
 cubits in length,

and fifty in breadth, and thirty
 height, and a window in it a cu
 square.

Also a good shutting door in tl
 side.

together with halls, recesses,
 bushes, and bowers, and well-
 formed pens.

[Fol. 6

For all flesh shall be destroyec

except Noah and his family.

Noah is told to take into the ar
 seven pairs of every clean bea
 and one of unclean kind,

and to furnish the ark with pro
 food.

Noah fills the ark.

46

COMMANDED TO BUILD AN ARK.

Bot make to þe a mancioun & þat is my wylle,
 A cofer closed of tres, clanlych planed;
 Wyrk wone3 *þerinne* for wylde & for tame,
 312 & *þenne* cleme hit *with* clay comly *with-inne*
 & alle þe endentur dryuen daube *with-outen*.
 & þus of lenþe & of large þat lome þou make,
 þre hundred of cupyde3 þou holde to þe lenþe,
 316 Of fyfty fayre ouer-þwert forme þe brede;
 & loke euen þat þyn ark haue of he3þe þretté,
 & a wyndow wyd vpon, wro3t vpon lofte,
 In þe compas of a cubit kyndely sware,
 320 A wel *dutande* dor, don on þe syde;
 Haf halle3 *þer-inne* & *halke3* ful mony,
 Boþe boske3 & boure3 & wel bounden pene3;
 For I schal waken vp a *water* to wasch alle þe worlde,
 324 & quelle alle þat is quik *with* quauende flode3.
 Alle þat glyde3 & got3, & gost of lyf habbe3,
 I schal wast with my wrath þat wons vpon vrþe;
 Bot my forwarde *with* þe I festen on þis wyse,
 328 For þou in reysoun hat3 rengned & ry3twys ben euer;
 þou schal enter þis ark *with* þyn apel barne3
 & þy wedded wyf; with þe þou take
 þe make3 of þy myry sune3; þis meyny of a3te
 332 I schal saue of monne3 saule3, & swelt þose oþer.
 Of vche best þat bere3 lyf busk þe a cupple,
 Of vche clene comly kynde enclose seuen make3,
 Of vche horwed, *in* ark halde bot a payre,
 336 For to saue me þe sede of alle ser kynde3;
 & ay þou meng *with* þe male3 þe mete ho-beste3,
 Vche payre by payre to plese ayþer oþer;
With alle þe fode þat may be founde frette þy cofer,
 340 For sustnaunce to yow self & also þose oþer.”
 Ful grayþely got3 þis god man & dos gode3 hestes,
 In dry3 dred & daunger, þat durst do non oþer.
 Wen hit wat3 fettled & forged & to þe fulle grayþed,
 344 Þenn con dry3ttyn hym dele dry3ly þyse worde3:

“Now Noe,” *quod* oure lorde, “art þou al redy?
 Hat3 þou closed þy kyst *with* clay alle aboute?”
 “3e lorde *with* þy leue,” sayde þe lede þenne,
 348 “Al is wro3t at þi worde, as þou me wyt lante3.”
 “Enter in þenn,” *quod* he, “& haf þi wyf *with* þe,
 þy þre sune3 *with-outen* þrep & her þre wyue3;
 Beste3, as I bedene haue, bosk þer-inne als,
 352 & when 3e arn staued, styfly steke3 yow þerinne;
 Fro seuen daye3 ben seyed I sende out by-lyue,
 Such a rowtande ryge þat rayne schal swyþe,
 þat schal wasch alle þe worlde of werke3 of fylþe;
 356 Schal no flesch vpon folde by fonden onlyue;
 Out-taken yow a3t in þis ark staued,
 & sed þat I wyl saue of þyse ser beste3.”
 Now Noe neuer *styste3* (þat niy3[t] he bygynne3),
 360 Er al wer stawed & stoken, as þe steuen wolde.

↓ DESCENDS.

Thenne sone com þe seuenþe day, when samned wern alle,
 & alle woned in þe *whichche* þe wylde & þe tame.
 Þen bolned þe abyme & bonke3 con ryse,
 364 *Walted* out vch walle-heued, in ful wode streme3,
 Wat3 no *brymme* þat abod vnbrosten bylyue,
 þe mukel lauande loghe to þe lyfte rered.
 Mony clustered clowde clef alle in clowte3,
 368 To-rent vch a rayn-ryfte & rusched to þe vrþe;
 Fon neuer in forty daye3, & þen þe flod ryse3,
 Ouer-walte3 vche a wod & þe wyde felde3;
 For when þe water of þe welkyn *with* þe worlde mette,
 372 Alle þat deth mo3t dry3e drowned þer-inne;
 Þer wat3 moon forto make when meschef was cnowen,
 þat no3t dowed bot þe deth in þe depe streme3.
 Water *wylger* ay wax, wone3 þat stryede,
 376 Hurlled in-to vch hous, hent þat þer *dowelled*.
 Fyrst *feng* to þe fly3t alle þat fle my3t,
 Vuche burde *with* her barne þe byggyng þay leue3,
 48 & bowed to þe hy3 bonk þer *brentest* hit wern,
 380 & *heterly* to þe hy3e hylle3 þay [h]aled on faste;
 Bot al wat3 nedle3 her note, for neuer cowþe stynt
 þe ro3e raynande ryg [&] þe raykande wawe3,
 Er vch *boþom* wat3 brurd-ful to þe bonke3 egge3,
 384 & vche a dale so depe þat *demmed* at þe brynke3.
 þe moste mountayne3 on mor þenne wat3 no more dry3e,
 & þer-on flokked þe folke, for ferde of þe wrake,
 Syþen þe wylde of þe wode on þe water flette;
 388 Summe swymmed þer-on þat saue hemself trawed,
 Summe sty3e to a stud & stared to þe heuen,
 Rwly wyth a loud rurd rored for drede.
 Hare3, hertte3 also, to þe hy3e runnen,
 392 Bukke3, *bausene3* & bule3 to þe bonkke3 hyzed,
 & alle cryed for care to þe kyng of heuen,
 Re-couerer of þe creator, þay cryed vchone,
 þat amounted þe masse, þe mase his mercy wat3 passed,

God asks Noah whether all is ready.

Noah replies that all is fully prepared.

He is commanded to enter the

for God tells him that he will send a rain to destroy all flesh.

Noah stows all safely in the ark

styste3] *stynte3* (?).

[Fol. 6

Seven days are passed.

The deep begins to swell, banks are broken down,

and the clouds burst.

It rains for forty days, and the flood rises,

and flows over the woods and fields.

All must drown.

The water enters the houses.

Each woman with her bairns flees to the hills.

The rain never ceases.

The valleys are filled.

People flock to the mountains.

Some swim for their lives.

Others roar for fear.

Animals of all kinds run to the hills.

All pray for mercy.

396 & alle his pyte departed fro peple þat he hated.
 Bi þat þe flod to her fete floȝed & waxed,
 Þen vche a segge seȝ wel þat synk hym byhoued;
 Frendeȝ fellen in fere & faþmed togeder
 400 To dryȝ her delful deystyné & dyȝen alle samen;
 Luf lokeȝ to luf & his leue takeȝ,
 For to ende alle at oneȝ & for euer twynne.
 By forty dayeȝ wern faren, on folde no flesch styryed,
 404 þat þe flod nade al freten *with* feȝtande wazeȝ,
 For hit clam vche a clyffe cubites fyftene,
 Ouer þe hyȝest hylle þat hurkled on erpe.

IN THE MUD.

Þenne mourkne in þe mudde most ful nede
 408 Alle þat spyrakle *in-spranc*, no sprawlyng awayled,
 Saue þe hapel vnder hach & his here straunge,
 Noe þat ofte neuened þe name of oure lorde,
 Hym aȝt-sum in þat ark as apēl god lyked,
 412 Þer alle ledeȝ in lome lenged druye,
 Þe arc houen watȝ on hyȝe *with* hurlande goteȝ,
 Kest to kytheȝ vncoupe þe clowdeȝ ful nere.
 49 Hit waltered on þe wylde flod, went as hit lyste,
 416 Drof vpon þe depe dam, *in* daunger hit semed,
 With-uten mast, oþer myke, oþer myry bawelyne,
 Kable, oþer capstan to clyppe to her ankereȝ,
 Hurrok, oþer hande-helme hasped on roper,
 420 Oþer any sweande sayl to seche after hauen,
 Bot flote forthe *with* þe flyt of þe felle wyndeȝ;
 Wheder-warde so þe water wafte, hit rebounde.
 Ofte hit roled on-rounde & rered on ende,
 424 Nyf oure lorde hade ben her lodeȝ-mon hem had lumpen harde.
 Of þe lenþe of noe lyf to lay a lel date,
 Þe sex hundreth of his age & none odde ȝereȝ,
 Of seconde monyth, þe seueneþe day ryȝteȝ,
 428 To-walten alle þyse welle-hedeȝ & þe water flowed,
 & þryeȝ fyfty þe flod of folwande dayeȝ,
 Vche hille watȝ þer hidde *with* yreȝ ful graye;
 Al watȝ wasted þat þer wonyed þe worlde *with-inne*,
 432 Þer euer flote, oþer flwe, oþer on fote ȝede,
 That roȝly watȝ þe remnaunt þat þe rac dryueȝ,
 þat alle gendreȝ so ioyst wern ioyned wyth-inne.
 Bot quen þe lorde of þe lyfte lyked hymselfen
 436 For to mynne on his mon his meth þat abydeȝ,
 Þen he wakened a wynde on wattereȝ to blowe;
 Þenne lasned þe llak þat large watȝ are,
 Þen he stac vp þe stangeȝ, stoped þo welleȝ,
 440 Bed blynne of þe rayn, hit batede as fast,
 Þenne lasned þe loȝ lowkande to-geder.
 After harde dayeȝ wern out an hundreth & fyfté,
 As þat lyftande lome lugged aboute,
 444 Where þe wynde & þe weder warpen hit wolde,

RESTS ON MOUNT ARARAT.

Hit saȝtled on a softe day synkande to grounde.
 On a rasse of a rok, hit rest at þe laste,

God's mercy is passed from th
 [Fol. 6
 Each sees that he must sink.

Friends take leave of one anot
 Forty days have gone by, and t
 are destroyed.
wazeȝ] *waweȝ* (?).

All rot in the mud,
in-spranc] *in-sprang* (?).
 except Noah and his family,
 who are safe in the ark.

The ark is lifted as high as the
 clouds,
 and is driven about,
 without mast, bowline, cables,
 anchors, or sail to guide its
 course.

At the mercy of the winds.

Oft it rolled around and reared
 end.
 The age of the patriarch Noah.

Duration of the flood.

yreȝ] *yþeȝ* (?).
 The completeness of the
 destruction.
 [Fol. 6

God remembers those in the ar

He causes a wind to blow,
llak] So in MS.
 and closes the lakes and wells,
 and the great deep.

The ark settles on Mount Arar

On þe mounþe of mararach of armene hilles,
 448 þat oþer-waye3 on ebrv hit hat þe thanes.
 Bot þa3 þe kyste in þe crage3 wern closed to byde,
 50 3et fyned not þe flod ne fel to þe boþeme3,
 Bot þe hy3est of þe egge3 vnhuled wern a lyttel,
 452 þat þe burne bynne borde byhelde þe bare erþe;
 Þenne wafte he vpon his wyndowe, & wysed þer-oute
 A message fro þat meyny hem molde3 to seche,
 þat wat3 þe rauē so ronk þat rebel wat3 euer;
 456 He wat3 colored as þe cole, corbyal vn-trwe.
 & he fonge3 to þe fly3t, & fanne3 on þe wynde3,
 Houe3 hy3e upon hy3t to herken tyþynges.
 He crouke3 for comfort when carayne he fynde3;
 460 Kast vp on a clyffe þer costese lay drye,
 He hade þe smelle of þe smach & smoltes þeder sone,
 Falle3 on þe foule flesch & fylle3 his wombe,
 & sone 3ederly for-3ete 3ister-day steuen,
 464 How þe cheuetayn hym charged þat þe kyst 3emed.
 Þe rauē rayke3 hym forth þat reches ful lyttel
 How alle fode3 þer fare, elle3 he fynde mete;

NDS FORTH A DOVE.

Noah beholds the bare earth.

He opens his window and send
out the raven to seek dry land.

The raven “croaks for comfort
on finding carrion.

He fills his belly with the foul
flesh.

Bot þe burne bynne borde þat bod to hys come,
 468 Banned hym ful bytterly *with* bestes alle samen,
 He seche3 an oþer sonde3mon & sette3 on þe doune;
 Brynge3 þat bry3t vpon borde blessed & sayde,
 “Wende worþelych wy3t *vis* wone3 to seche,
 472 Dryf ouer þis dymme water; if þou druye fynde3
 Bryng bodworde to bot blysse to *vis* alle;
 Þa3 þat fowle be false, fre be þou euer.”
 Ho wyrle out on þe weder on wynges ful scharpe,
 476 Dre3ly alle a longe day þat dorst neuer ly3t;
 & when ho fynde3 no folde her fote on to pyche,
 Ho vmbe-keste3 þe coste & þe kyst seche3,
 Ho hitte3 on þe euentyde & on þe ark sitte3;
 480 Noe nymmes hir anon & naytly hir stauē.
 Noe on anoþer day nymme3 efte þe dovene,
 & bydde3 hir bowe ouer þe borne efte bonke3 to seche;
 & ho skyrme3 vnder skwe & skowte3 aboute,
 484 Tyl hit wat3 ny3e at þe na3t & noe þen seche3.

borde] MS. *lorde*.

The lord of the ark curses the
raven,

[Fol. 6

doune] *douue* or *douene* (?).

and sends out the dove.

The bird wanders about the wl
day.

Finding no rest, she returns ab
eventide to Noah.

Noah again sends out the dove

VI.

On ark on an euentyde houē3 þe downe,
 On stamyn ho stod & styllē hym abyde3;
 What! ho bro3t in hir beke a bronch of olyue,
 488 Gracyously vmbe-grouen al *with* grene leue3;
 þat wat3 þe syngne of sauýtē þat sende hem oure lorde,
 & þe sa3tlyng of hym-self *with* þo sely beste3.
 Þen wat3 þer ioý in pat gyn where Iumpred er dry3ed,
 492 & much comfort in þat cofer þat wat3 clay-daubed.
 Myrly on a fayr morn, monyth þe fyrst,
 þat falle3 formast in þe 3er, & þe fyrst day,
 Ledē3 lo3en in þat lome & lokēd þer-oute,

The dove returns with an olive
branch in her beak.

This was a token of peace and
reconciliation.

Joy reigns in the ark.

The people therein laugh and l
thereout.

496 How þat wattere3 wern woned & þe worlde dried.
 Vchon loued oure lorde, bot lenged ay styllē,
 Tyl þay had tyþyng fro þe tolke þat tyned hem þer-inne;

AVES THE ARK.

þen gode3 glam to hem glod þat gladed hem alle,
 500 Bede hem drawe to þe dor, delyuer hem he wolde;
 þen went þay to þe wykket, hit walt vpon sone,
 Boþe þe burne & his barne3 bowed þer-outē;
 Her wyue3 walke3 hem wyth & þe wylde after,
 504 Þroly þrublande in þronge, þrowen ful þykke;
 Bot Noe of vche honest kynde nem out an odde
 & heuened vp an auter & hal3ed hit fayre,
 & sette a sakerfyse þer-on of vch a ser kynde,
 508 þat wat3 comly & clene, god kepe3 non oþer.
 When bremly breneþ þose beste3, & þe breþe rysed,
 þe sauour of his sacrafyse so3t to hym euen
 þat al spede3 & spylle3; he spekes with þat ilke
 512 In comly comfort ful clos & cortays worde3:
 “Now noe no more nel I neuer wary,
 Alle þe mukel mayny [on] molde for no manne3 synne3,
 For I se wel þat hit is sothe, þat alle manne3 wytte3
 516 To vn-þryfte arn alle þrawn with þo3t of her hertte3,
 & ay hat3 ben & wyl be 3et fro her barnage;
 Al is þe mynde of þe man to malyce enclyned,
 52 For-þy schal I neuer schende so schortly at ones,
 520 As dysstrye al for mane3 synne [in] daye3 of þis erþe.
 Bot waxe3 now & wende3 forth & worþe3 to monye,
 Multyplye3 on þis molde & menske yow by-tyde.
 Sesoune3 schal yow neuer sese of sede ne of heruest,
 524 Ne hete, ne no harde forst, vmbre ne dro3þe,
 Ne þe swetnesse of somer, ne þe sadde wynter,
 Ne þe ny3t, ne þe day, ne þe newe 3ere3,
 Bot euer renne restle3 rengne3 3e þer-inne.”
 528 þerwyth he blesse3 vch a best, & byta3t hem þis erþe.
 þen wat3 a skylly skyualde, quen scaped alle þe wylde;

God permits Noah and his son
 leave the ark.

[Fol. 6

Noah offers sacrifice to God.

It is pleasing to Him that “all
 speeds or spoils.”

God declares that He will neve
 destroy the world for the sin o
 man.

That summer and winter shall
 never cease.

Nor night nor day, nor the new
 years.

God blesses every beast.

STS ARE DISPERSED.

Vche fowle to þe fly3t þat fyþere3 my3t serue,
 Vche fysch to þe flod þat fynne couþe nayte,
 532 Vche beste to þe bent þat bytes on erbe3;
 Wylde worme3 to her won wryþe3 in þe erþe,
 þe fox & þe folmarde to þe fryth wynde3,
 Herttes to hy3e heþe, hare3 to gorste3,
 536 & lyoune3 & lebarde3 to þe lake ryftes,
 Herne3 & haueke3 to þe hy3e roche3;
 þe hole-foted fowle to þe flod hy3e3,
 & vche best at a brayde þer hym best lyke3;
 540 þe fowre freke3 of þe folde fonge3 þe empyre.

Each fowl takes its flight. Eac
 fish goes to the flood.

þat] MS. þat þat.

Each beast makes for the plain
 Wild worms wriggle to their
 abodes in the earth.

The fox goes to the woods. Ha
 to the heath, and hares to the
 gorse.

Lions and leopards go to the
 lakes. Eagles and hawks to the
 high rocks.

The four ‘frekes’ take the emp

ATRED OF WICKEDNESS.

Lo! suche a wrakful wo for wlatsum dede3

[Fol. 6

Parformed þe hyȝe fader on folke þat he made;
 þat he chysly hade cherished he chastysed ful hardee,
 544 In de-voydyng þe vylanye þat venkquyst his þeweȝ.
 For-þy war þe now, wyȝe, þat worschyp desyres,
 In his comlych *courte* þat kyng is of blysse,
 In þe fylþe of þe flesch þat þou be founden neuer,
 548 Tyl any water in þe worlde to wasche þe fayly,
 For is no segge vnder sunne so seme of his crafteȝ,
 If he be sulped in synne, þat [ne] sytteȝ vnclene.
 On spec of a spote may spede to mysse
 552 Of þe syȝte of þe souerayn þat sytteȝ so hyȝe,
 For þat schewe me schale in þo schyre howseȝ,
 As þe beryl bornyst byhoueȝ be clene,
 53 þat is sounde on vche a syde & no sem habes,
 556 *With*-outen maskle oþer mote as margerye perle.

VII.

Syþen þe souerayn in sete so sore for-þoȝt
 þat euer he man vpon molde merked to lyuy,
 For he in fylþe watȝ fallen, felly he uenged,
 560 Quen fourferde alle þe flesch þat he formed hade,
 Hym rweð þat he hem vp-rerde & raȝt hem lyflode,
 & efte þat he hem vndyd, hard hit hym þoȝt;
 For quen þe swemande sorȝe soȝt to his hert,
 564 He knyȝt a couenaunde cortaysly *with* monkynde þere,
 In þe mesure of his mode & meþe of his wylle,
 þat he schulde neuer for no syȝt smyte al at oneȝ,
 As to quelle alle quykeȝ for qued þat myȝt falle,
 568 Whyl of þe lenþe of þe londe lasteȝ þe *terme*.
 þat ilke skyl for no scape ascaped hym neuer,
 Wheder wonderly he wrak on wykked men after;
 Ful felly for þat ilk faute forferde a kyth ryche,
 572 In þe anger of his ire þat arȝed mony;
 & al watȝ for þis ilk euel, þat vn-happen glette,
 þe venym & þe vylanye & þe vycios fylþe,
 þat by-sulpeȝ manneȝ saule in vnsounde hert,
 576 þat he his saueour ne see *with* syȝt of his yȝen,
 þat alle illeȝ he hates as helle þat stynkkeȝ;
 Bot non nuyeȝ hym, on naȝt ne neuer vpon dayeȝ,
 As harlottrye vn-honest, heþyng of seluen;
 580 þat schameȝ for no schrewedschyp schent mot he worþe!
 Bot sauyour mon in þy self, þaȝ þou a sotte lyuie,
 þaȝ þou bere þy self babel, by-þenk þe sum-tyme,
 Wheþer he þat stykked vche a stare in vche steppe yȝe,
 584 ȝif hym self be bore blynde hit is a broð wonder;
 & he þat fetly in face fettled alle eres
 If he hatȝ losed þe lysten hit lyfteȝ meruayle;
 Trave þou neuer þat tale, vn-trwe þou hit fyndeȝ,
 588 þer is no dede so derne þat ditteȝ his yȝen;
 54 þer is no wyȝe in his werk so war ne so stylle
 þat hit ne þraweȝ to hym þre er he hit þoȝt haue;
 For he is þe gropande god, þe grounde of alle dedeȝ,
 592 Rypande of vche a ring þe reynyeȝ & hert;

Behold what woe God brough
 mankind for their hateful deed

Beware of the filth of the flesh

“One speck of a spot” will ruin
 in the sight of God.

The beryl is clean and sound,–
 has no seam.

When God repented that he ha
 made man, he destroyed all fle

fourferde] *for-ferde* (?).
 But afterwards He was sorry,

and made a covenant with
 mankind
 that He would not again destr
 all the living.

For the filth of the flesh God
 destroyed a rich city.

God hates the wicked as “hell
 stinks.”

[Fol. 65

Especially harlotry and
 blasphemy.

self] MS. *sele*.

he] MS. *he he*.

Nothing is hidden from God.

pre] *per* (?).

God is the ground of all deeds
ring] *rink* or *renk* (?).

& þere he fynde3 al fayre a freke wyth-inne
 þat hert honest & hol, þat hapel he honoure3,
 Sende3 hym a sad sy3t to se his auen face,
 596 & harde honyse3 þise oþer & of his erde fleme3.
 Bot of þe dome of þe douþe for dede3 of schame
 He is so skoymos of þat skaþe, he scarre3 bylyue,
 He may not dry3e to draw allyt, bot drepe3 in hast
 600 & þat wat3 schewed schortly by a scape one3.

He honours the man that is ho
 and whole.

But for deeds of shame He
 destroys the mighty ones.

M RECEIVES THREE GUESTS, AND ENTERTAINS THEM.

VIII.

O lde Abraham in erde one3 he sytte3
 Euen byfore his hous-dore vnder an oke grene;
 Bry3t blykked þe bem of þe brode heuen,
 604 In þe hy3e hete þer-of Abraham bide3,
 He wat3 schunt to þe schadow vnder schyre leue3;
 Þenne wat3 he war on þe waye of wlonk wy3e3 þryne.
 If þay wer farande & fre & fayre to beholde,
 608 Hit is eþe to leue by þe last ende;
 For þe lede þat þer laye þe leue3 an-vnder,
 When he hade of hem sy3t he hy3e3 bylyue,
 & as to god þe good mon gos hem agayne3
 612 & haylsed hem in onhede & sayde, “hende lorde
 3if euer þy mon vpon molde merit disserued,
 Lenge a lyttel with þy lede I lo3ly bi-seche;
 Passe neuer fro þi pouere, 3if I hit pray durst,
 616 Er þou haf biden with þi burne & vnder bo3e restted;
 & I schal wynne yow wy3t of water a lyttel,
 & fast aboute schal I fare *your* fette wer waschene;
 Restte3 here on þis rote & I schal rachche after
 620 & brynge a morsel of bred to banne *your* hertte.”
 “Fare forthe,” *quod* þe freke3, “& fech as þou segge3;
 By bole of þis brode tre we byde þe here.”
 55 Þenne orppedly in-to his hous he hy3ed to Saré
 624 Comaunded hir to be cof & quyk at þis one3;
 “Pre mette3 of mele menge & ma kake3,
 Vnder aske3 ful hote happe hem byliue;
 Quyl I fete sumquat fat þou þe fyr bete,
 628 Prestly at þis ilke poynte *sum* polment to make.”
 He cached to his cobhous & a calf brynge3
 þat wat3 tender & not to3e; bed tyrne of þe hyde,
 & sayde to his seruauant þat he hit seþe faste
 632 & he deruely at his dome dy3t hit bylyue.
 Þe burne to be bare-heued buske3 hym þenne,
 Cleche3 to a clene cloþe & keste3 on þe grene,
 Þrwe þryftyly þer-on þo þre þerue kake3,
 636 & brynge3 butter wyth-al, & by þe bred sette3
 Mete; messe3 of mylke he merkke3 bytwene,
 Syþen potage & polment in plater honest;
 As sewer in a god assyse he serued hem fayre,
 640 Wyth sadde semblaunt & swete of such as he hade,

Abraham is sitting before his
 house-door under a green oak.

He sees three men coming alo

and goes toward them.

[Fol. 6

He entreats them to rest awhile

that he may wash their feet,

and bring them a morsel of bre

Abraham commands Sarah to
 make some cakes quickly,

cobhous] *cov-hous* = cow-hc
 (?).

and tells his servant to seethe a
 tender kid.

Abraham appears bare-headed
 before his guests.

He casts a clean cloth on the
 green,

and sets before them cakes, bu
 milk, and pottage.

CLOSES HIS PURPOSE TO ABRAHAM.

& god as a glad gest mad god chere,
 þat wat3 fayn of his frende & his fest praysed.
 Abraham, al hodel3 *with* arme3 vp-folden,
 644 Mynystred mete byfore þo men þat my3tes al welde3;
 Þenne þay sayden, as þay sete samen alle þryne,
 When þe mete wat3 remued & þay of mensk speken,
 "I schal efte here away abram," þay sayden,
 648 "3et er þy lyue3 ly3t leþe vpon erþe,
 & þenne schal saré consayue & a sun bere,
 þat schal be abrahame3 ayre, & after hym wyne
 With wele & wyth worschyp þe worþely peple
 652 þat schal halde *in* heritage, þat I haf men 3ark."
 Þenne þe burde byhynde þe dor for busmar la3ed;
 & sayde sothly to hir-self saré þe madde:
 "May þou traw for tykle þat þou tonne mo3te3,
 656 & I so hy3e out of age & also my lorde,"
 For soþely, as says þe wryt, he wern of sadde elde,
 Boþe þe wy3e & his wyf, such werk wat3 hem fayled,
 56 Fro mony a brod day by-fore ho barayn ay byene,
 660 þat selue saré *with*-outen sede *in*-to þat same tyme.
 Þenne sayde oure syre þer he sete "se! so saré la3es,
 Not trawande þe tale þat I þe to schewed;
 Hope3 ho o3t may be harde my honde3 to work?
 664 & 3et I a-vow verayly þe avaunt þat I made,
 I schal 3eþly a3ayn & 3elde þat I hy3t,
 & sothely sende to saré a soñ & an hayre."
 Þenne swenged forth saré & swer by hir trawþe,
 668 þat for lot þat þay lanced ho la3ed neuer.
 "Now *innoghe* hit is not so" þenne nurned þe dry3tyn,
 "For þou la3ed alo3, bot let we hit one."
 With þat þay ros vp radly as þay rayke schulde,
 672 & setten toward sodamas her sy3t alle at-one3;
 For þat Cite þer bysyde wat3 sette *in* a vale,
 No myle3 fro mambre mo þen tweyne,
 Where-so wonyed þis ilke wy3 þat wende3 *with* oure lorde,
 676 For to tent hym *with* tale & teche hym þe gate,
 Þen glyde3 forth god, þe godmon hym fol3e3.
 Abraham helde3 hem wyth, hem to conueye,
 In towarde þe Cety of sodamas þat synned had þenne
 680 In þe faute of þis fylþe; þe fader hem þretes,
 & sayde þus to þe segg þat sued hym after:
 "How my3t I hyde myn hert fro habraham þe trwe,
 þat I ne dyscouered to his corse my counsayl so dere.
 684 Syþen he is chosen to be chef chyldryn fader,
 þat so folk schal falle fro, to flete alle þe worlde,
 & vche blod *in* þat burne blessed schal worþe.
 Me bos telle to þat tolk þe tene of my wyllle
 688 & alle myn atlyng to abraham vn-haspe bilyue.

God praises his friend's feast,

and after the meat is removed,

[Fol. 6

He tells Abraham that Sarah sh
bear him a son.

Sarah, who is behind the door,
laughs in unbelief.

sothly] ? *softly* or *sotly* =
foolishly

byene] ? *bycame*.

God tells Abraham that Sarah
laughs at His words.

Sarah denies that she laughed.
lanced] *laused* (?).

Abraham's guests set out towa
Sodom,

two miles from Mamre.

The patriarch accompanies the

God determines to reveal to
Abraham his secret purposes.

[Fol. 6

HINESS OF SODOM AND GOMORRAH.

IX.

"The grete soun of sodamas synkke3 *in* myn ere3,
 & þe gult of gomorre gare3 me to wrath;

I schal lyzt *in-to* þat led & loke my seluen,
 692 If þay haf don as þe dyne dryueȝ on-lofte,
 57 Þay han lerned a lyst þat lykeȝ me ille,
 Þat þay han founden *in* her flesch of fauteȝ þe werst,
 Vch male matȝ his mach a man as hym seluen,
 696 & fylter folylly *in* fere, on femmaleȝ wyse.
 I compast hem a kynde crafte & kende hit hem derne,
 & amed hit *in* myn ordenaunce oddely dere,
 & dyȝt drwry þer-inne, doole alþer-swettest,
 700 & þe play of paramoreȝ I portrayed my seluen;
 & made þer-to a maner myriest of oþer,
 When two true togeder had tyȝed hem seluen,
 By-twene a male & his make such merþe schulde conne;
 704 Wel nyȝe pure paradys moȝt preue no better,
 Elleȝ þay moȝt honestly ayþer oþer welde.
 At a styлле stollen steuen, vnstereȝ wyth syȝt,
 Luf lowe hem bytwene lasched so hote,
 708 Þat alle þe meschefeȝ on mold moȝt hit not sleke;
 Now haf þay skyfted my skyl & scorned natwre,
 & hentteȝ hem *in* heþyng an vsage vn-clene;
 Hem to smyte for þat smod smartly I þenk
 712 Þat wyȝeȝ schal be by hem war, worlde *with-oute*n ende.”

M PLEADS FOR THE CITIES.

Þenne arȝed abraham & alle his mod chaunge[d],
 For hope of þe harde hate þat hyȝt hatȝ oure lorde;
 Al sykande he sayde “*sir with* yor leue,
 716 Schal synful & sakleȝ suffer al on payne;
 Weþer euer hit lyke my lorde to lyfte such domeȝ,
 Þat þe wykked & þe worpy schal on wrake suffer,
 & weye vpon þe worre half þat wrathed þe neuer?
 720 Þat watȝ neuer þy won þat wroȝteȝ *vus* alle.
 Now fyfty fyn frendeȝ wer founde *in* ȝonde toun
 In þe Cety of Sodamas & also gomorrē
 Þat neuer lakked þy laue, bot loued ay traupe,
 724 & reȝt-ful wern & resounable & redy þe to serue,
 Schal þay falle *in* þe faute þat oþer frekeȝ wroȝt
 & ioyne to her iuggement her iuise to haue?
 Þat nas neuer þyn note, vnneued hit worþe,
 728 Þat art so gaynly a god & of goste mylde!”
 58 “Nay for fyfty,” *quod* þe fader, “& þy fayre speche,
 & þay be founden *in* þat folk of her fylþe clene,
 I schal for-gyue alle þe gylt þurȝ my *grace* one,
 732 & let hem smolt al unsmyten smopely atoneȝ.”
 “AA! blessed be þow,” *quod* þe burne, “so boner & þewed,
 & al haldeȝ *in* þy honde, þe heuen & þe erþe,
 Bot for I haf þis talke tatȝ to non ille,
 736 ȝif I mele a lyttel more þat mul am & askeȝ;
 What if fyue faylen of fyfty þe noumbre,
 & þe remnaunt be reken, how restes þy wylle?”
 “And fyue wont of fyfty,” *quod* god, “I schal forȝete alle
 740 & wyth-halde my honde for horthyng on lede.”
 “& quat if faurty be fre & fauty þyse oþer
 Schalt þow schortly al schende & schape non oþer.”
 “Nay þaȝ faurty forfete ȝet fryst I a whyle,

He informs him of the destruction
about to fall upon the cities of
plain,

If] MS. inf.

for their great wickedness,

in abusing the gifts bestowed
upon them.

The ordinance of marriage had
been made for them,

conne] come (?).

but they foully set it at naught
The flame of love.

Therefore shall they be destroyed
as an example to all men for ever

Abraham is full of fear,

and asks God whether the “sin
and the sinless” are to suffer
together.

[Fol. 6

Whether he will spare the cities
provided fifty righteous are found
in them?

&] *An (?)*.

For the sake of fifty the cities
shall be spared.

The patriarch beseeches God to
spare the city for the sake of
forty-five righteous.

For the lack of five the cities shall
not be destroyed.

744 & voyde away my vengau^{nce}, þa³ me vyl þynk.”
 Þen abraham obeched hym & lozly him þonkke³,
 “Now sayned be þou sauio^{ur}, so symple in þy wrath!
 I am bot erþe ful euel & vsle so blake,
 748 Forto mele wyth such a mayster as my³te³ hat³ alle,
 Bot I haue by-gonnen wyth my god, & he hit gayn þynke³,
 3if I for-loyne as a fol þy fraunchyse may serue;
 What if þretty pryua^{nde} be þrad in 3on toune³,
 752 What schal I leue if my lorde, if he hem leþe wolde?”
 Þenne þe godlych god gef hym onsware,
 “3et for þretty in þrong I schal my þro steke,
 & spare spakly of spyt in space of my þewe³,
 756 & my rankor refrayne four þy reken worde³.”
 “What for twenty,” quod þe tolke, “vntwyne³ þou hem þenne?”
 “Nay, 3if þou 3erne³ hit, 3et 3ark I hem grace;
 If þat twenty be trwe I tene hem no more,
 760 Bot relece alle þat regioun of her ronk werkke³.”
 “Now apel lorde,” quod Abraham, “one³ a speche
 & I schal schape no more þo schalkke³ to helpe;
 59 If ten trysty in toune be tan in þi werkke³
 764 Wylt þou mese þy mode & menddyng abyde?”
 “I graunt,” quod þe grete god, “graunt mercy,” þat oþer.
 & þenne arest þe renk & razt no fyrre;
 & godde glyde³ his gate by þose grene waye³
 768 & he conueyen hym con with cast of his y³e,

ÞERS ARE SENT TO LOT.

& als he loked along pere as oure lorde passed,
 3et he cryed hym after with careful steuen:
 “Meke mayster on þy mon to mynne if þe lyked,
 772 Loth lenge³ in 3on leede þat is my lef broþer,
 He sytte³ þer in sodomis, þy seruau^{nt} so pouere
 Among þo mansed men þat han þe much greued;
 3if þou tyne³ þat toun, tempre þyn yre
 776 As þy mersy may malte þy meke to spare.”
 Þen he wende³, wende³ his way wepande for care
 To-warde þe mere of mambre wepande for so[r³e,]
 & þere in longyng al nyzt he lenge³ in wones,
 780 Why! þe souerayn to sodamas sende to spyre.

X.

His sondes in-to sodamas wat³ sende in þat tyme,
 In þat ilk euentyde, by aungels tweyne,
 Meuand meuande mekely togeder as myry men 3onge,
 784 As loot in a loge dor lened hym alone,
 In a porche of þat place pyzt to þe 3ates,
 Þat wat³ ryal & ryche, so wat³ þe renkes seluen.
 As he stared in-to þe strete þer stout men played
 788 He syze þer swey in asent swete men tweyne;
 Bolde burne³ wer þay boþe with berdles chymne³,
 Royl rollande fax to raw sylk lyke,
 Of ble as þe brere flour where-so þe bare schewe^{ed},
 792 Ful clene wat³ þe countenaunce of her cler y³en;

For forty the cities shall be spared.

Abraham entreats God's forbearance for his speech.

Thirty righteous, found in the cities, shall save them from destruction.

[Fol. 6

For the sake of twenty guiltles ones God will release the rest.

Or if ten only should be found pure.

The patriarch intercedes for Lot

Beseeches Him to “temper His ire,”

and then departs weeping for sorrow.

so[r³e]] sorewe is written by late hand over the original word.

God's messengers go to Sodor

Meuand meuande] So in MS Lot is sitting alone at the “doo his lodge.”

Staring into the street he sees t men.

Beardless chins they had, and hair like raw silk.

Wlonk whit wat3 her wede & wel hit hem semed.

Of alle feture3 ful fyn & fautle3 bope;

Wat3 non autly *in ouper*, for aungels hit wern,

60 796 & þat þe 3ep *vnder-3ede* þat *in* þe 3ate sytte3.

ERTAINS THE MESSENGERS.

He ros vp ful radly & ran hem to mete

& lo3e he loute3 hem to, loth, to þe grounde,

& syþen soberly [sat3] “syre3 I yow by-seche,

800 þat 3e wolde ly3t at my loge & lenge *per-inne*,

Come3 to *your knaues kote* I craue at þis one3;

I schal fette yow a *fatte your fette* forto wasche;

I *norne* yow bot for on ny3t ne3e me to lenge,

804 & *in* þe myry mornyn3 3e may *your* waye take.”

& þay nay þat þay nolde ne3 no howse3,

Bot stylly *per in* þe strete as þay stadde wern,

þay wolde lenge þe long na3t & logge *per-oute*;

808 Hit wat3 *hous inno3e* to hem þe heuen vpon lofte.

Loth laþed so longe wyth luflych worde3,

þat þay hym graunted to go & *gru3t* no lenger.

þe bolde to his byggyng brynge3 hem bylyue,

812 þat ryally [wat3] arayed, for he wat3 ryche euer.

þe wy3e3 wern welcom as þe wyf *coupe*,

His two dere do3tere3 deuoutly hem haylsed,

þat wer maydene3 ful meke, maryed not 3et,

816 & þay wer semly & swete, & swyþe wel arayed.

Loth þenne ful ly3tly loke3 hym aboute,

& his men amonestes mete forto dy3t,

Bot þenkke3 on hit be þrefte what þynk so 3e make,

820 For wyth no *sour* ne no salt serue3 hym neuer.

Bot 3et I wene þat þe wyf hit *wroth* to dyspyt,

& sayde softely to hir self “þis *vn-sauere* hyne

Loue3 no salt *in* her sauce 3et hit no skyl were

824 þat *oper* burne be boutte þa3 bope be nyse.”

þenne ho *sauere3 with* salt her seue3 vchone

Agayne þe bone of þe burne þat hit forboden hade,

& als ho scelt hem *in* scorne þat wel her skyl knewen.

828 Why wat3 ho wrech so wod, ho wrathed oure lorde!

þenne seten þay at þe soper, wern serued by-lyue,

þe gestes gay & ful glad, of *glam* debonere,

Welawynnely wlonk tyl þay waschen hade,

61 832 þe trestes tylt to þe *wowe* & þe table bope.

Fro þe segge3 haden souped & seten bot a whyle,

Er euer þay bosked to bedde þe bor3 wat3 al vp;

Alle þat weppen my3t welde, þe *wakker* & þe stronger,

836 To *vmbe-ly3e* lothe3 *hous* þe lede3 to take,

In grete flokke3 of folk, þay fallen to his 3ate3,

As a *scowte-wach* scarred, so þe *asscry* rysed;

USE IS BESET.

With kene clobbe3 of þat clos þay clat3 on þe wowe3,

840 & wyth a schrylle scharp schout þay schewe þyse worde:

“If þou louye3 þy lyf loth *in* þyse wone3

3ete *vus* out þose 3ong men þat 3ore-whyte here entred,

þat we may lere *hym* of lof, as oure lyst bidde3,

[Fol. 6

Beautifully white were their weeds.

Lot runs to meet them.

Invites them to remain awhile his house,

and in the morning they may t their way.

Lot invites them so long that a last they comply.

The wife and daughters of Lot welcome their visitors.

Lot admonishes his men to prepare the meat,

þynk] *þyng* (?).

sour] *savour* (?).

and to serve no salt with it.

wroth] *wro3t* (?).

vn-sauere] MS. *vnfauere*.

Lot's wife disregards the injunction.

[Fol. 6

The guests are well entertained

But before they go to rest the c is up in arms.

With “keen clubs” the folk cla on the walls,

and demand that Lot should deliver up his guests.

844 As is þe asyse of Sodomas to seggeþ þat passen.”
 Whatt! þay sputen & speken of so spitous fylþe,
 What! þay ȝeȝed & ȝolped of ȝestande sorȝe,
 Þat ȝet þe wynd, & þe weder, & þe worlde stynkes
 848 Of þe brych þat vp-braydeþ þose broþelych wordeþ.
 Þe god man glyfte *with þat glam* & glosed for noyse,
 So scharpe schame to hym schot, he schrank at þe hert,
 For he knew þe costoum þat kyþed þose wrecheþ,
 852 He doted neuer for no doel so depe *in* his mynde.
 Allas! sayd hym þenne loth, & lyȝtly he ryseþ
 & boweþ forth fro þe bench *in-to* þe brode ȝates.
 What! he wonded no woþe of wekked knaueþ,
 856 Þat he ne passed þe port þe *peril* to abide.
 He went forthe at þe wyket & waft hit hym after,
 Þat a clyket hit cleȝt clos hym byhynde.
 Þenne he *meled* to þo men mesurable wordeþ,
 860 For harloteþ *with* his hendelayk he hoped to chast;
 “Oo! my frendeþ so fre, *your* fare is to strange,
 Dotȝ away *your* derf dyn & dereþ neuer my gestes,
 Avoy! hit is *your* vylayne, ȝe vylen *your* seluen;
 864 & ȝe ar iolyf gentylmen *your* iapes ar ille.
 Bot I schal *kenne* yow by kynde a crafte þat is better;
 I haf a tresor *in* my telde of tow my fayre deȝter,
 Þat ar maydeneþ vnmard for alle men ȝette;
 62 868 In sodamas, þaȝ I hit say, non semloker burdes,
 Hit arn ronk, hit arn rype & redy to manne;
 To samen wyth þo semly þe solace is better,
 I schal biteche yow þo two þat *tayt* arn & quoynt,
 872 & laykeþ wyth hem as yow lyst & leteþ my gestes one.”
 Þenne þe rebaudeþ so ronk rerd such a noyse,
 Þat aȝly hurled *in* his ereþ her harloteþ speche;
 “Wost þou not wel þat þou woneþ here a wyȝe strange,
 876 An out-comlyng, a carle, we kyllen of þyn heued.
 Who Ioyned þe be iostyse oure iapeþ to blame,
 Þat com a boy to þis borȝ, þaȝ þou be burne ryche?”
 Þus þay þrobled & þrong & þrwe vmbe his ereþ,
 880 & distresed hym wonder strayt, *with* strenkþe *in* þe prece,

OF SODOM SMITTEN WITH BLINDNESS.

Bot þat þe ȝonge men, so ȝepe, ȝornen þer-oute,
 Wapped vpon þe wyket & wonnen hem tylle,
 & by þe hondeþ hym hent & horyed hym *with-inne*,
 884 & steken þe ȝates ston-harde wyth stalworth barreþ.
 Þay blwe a boffet *in* blande þat banned peple,
 Þat þay blustered as blynde as bayard watȝ euer;
 Þay lest of loteþ logging any lysoun to fynde,
 888 Bot nyteled þer alle þe nyȝt for noȝt at þe last;
 Þenne vch tolke tyȝt hem þat hade *of* *tayt* fayled,
 & vchon roþeled to þe rest þat he reche moȝt;
 Bot þay wern wakned al wrank þat þer *in* won lended,
 892 Of on þe vglokest vnhap þat euer on erd suffred.

INT OUT OF THE CITY.

hym] hem (?).

The wind yet stinks with their filthy speech.

Lot is in great trouble.

peril] MS. pil.

He leaves his guests

and addresses the Sodomites.

&] And = An (?).

[Fol. 6

He offers to give up to them his two daughters.

The rebels raise a great noise,

and ask who made him a justic judge their deeds,

who was but a boy when he came to Sodom.

The young men bring Lot with doors,

and smite those outside with blindness.

In vain they try to find the door Lot's house.

wrank] wrang (?).

	<u>R</u> uaddon of þe day-rawe ros vpon vʒten, When merk of þe mydnyʒt moʒt no more last, Ful erly þose aungeleʒ þis haþel þay ruþen	Early in the morning the angel command Lot to depart from Sodom,
896	& glopnedly on godeʒ halue gart hym vpryse, Fast þe freke ferkeʒ vp ful ferd at his hert; þay comaunded hym cof to cach þat he hade, “Wyth þy wyf & þy wyʒeʒ & þy wlonc deʒtters,	with his wife and two daughte
900	For we laþe þe, <i>sir</i> loth, þat þou þy lyf haue; Cayre tid of þis kythe er combred þou worþe,	[Fol. 6
63	With alle þi here vpon haste, tyl þou a hil fynde; Foundeʒ faste on <i>your</i> fete, bifore <i>your</i> face lokes,	and to look straight before him
904	Bot bes neuer so bolde to blusch yow bihynde, & loke ʒe <u>stemme</u> no stepe, bot strecheʒ on faste, Til ʒe reche to a reset, rest ʒe neuer; For we schal tyne þis toun & trayþely disstrye,	for Sodom and Gomorrah shal destroyed.
908	Wyth alle þise wyʒeʒ so wykke wyʒtly de-voyde & alle þe londe <i>with</i> þise ledeʒ we losen at oneʒ; Sodomas schal ful sodenly synk <i>in-to</i> grounde, & þe grounde of gomorre <u>gorde</u> <i>in-to</i> helle,	
912	& vche a koste of þis kythe <u>clater</u> vpon hepes. þen laled loth, “lorde what is best? If I me fele vpon fote þat I fle moʒt, Hov schulde I huyde me fro hem þat hatʒ his hate <u>kynned</u> ,	Lot asks what is best to be dor that he may escape.
916	<i>In</i> þe brath of his breth þat brenneʒ alle <u>þinkeʒ</u> , To crepe fro my creatour & know not wheder, Ne wheþer his <u>fooschip</u> me folʒeʒ bifore <i>oper</i> bihynde?” þe freke sayde “no foschip oure fader hatʒ þe schewed,	<i>þinkeʒ</i>] <i>þingeʒ</i> .
920	Bot hiʒly heuened þi hele fro hem þat arn combred: Nov <u>walle</u> þe a <u>wonnyng</u> þat þe warisch myʒt, & he schal saue hit for þy sake þat hatʒ <i>vus</i> sende hider, For þou art oddely þyn one out of þis fylþe,	He is told to choose himself a dwelling which shall be saved from destruction.
924	& als Abraham þyn <u>em</u> hit at him self asked.” “Lorde, loued he worþe,” <i>quod</i> loth, “vpon erþe! þen is a cite herbisyde þat segor hit hatte, Here <u>vtter</u> on a rounde hil hit houeʒ hit one,	<i>em</i>] <i>broþer</i> is written over in later hand.
928	I wolde, if his wylle <u>wore</u> , to þat won scape.” “þenn fare forth,” <i>quod</i> þat fre, “& fyne þou neuer With þose ilk þat þow wylt þat þrengc þe after, & ay goande on <i>your</i> gate, wyth-uten agayn-tote,	He chooses Zoar.
932	For alle þis londe schal be lorne, longe er þe sonne rise.” þe wyʒe wakened his wyf & his wlonk deʒteres, & <i>oper</i> two myri men þo maydeneʒ schulde wedde; & þay token hit as tyt & tented hit lyttel,	The angels command Lot to depart quickly.
936	þaʒ fast laped hem loth, þay leʒen ful styлле.	He wakes his wife and daughte
64	þe aungeleʒ hasted þise <i>oper</i> & aʒly hem þratten, & enforsed alle fawre forth at þe ʒateʒ, þo wern loth & his lef, his luflyche deʒter,	[Fol. 70
940	þer soʒt no mo to sauement of cities aþel fyue. þise aungeleʒ hade hem by hande out at þe ʒateʒ, Prechande hem þe perile, & beden hem passe fast. “Lest ʒe be taken <i>in</i> þe teche of tyraunteʒ here,	All four are hastened on by the angels, who “preach to them the peril’ delay..
944	Loke ʒe bowe now bi bot, boweʒ fast hence!” & þay kayre-ne con & kenely flowen; Erly, er any heuen glem, þay to a hil comen. þe grete god <i>in</i> his <u>greme</u> bygynneʒ onlofte;	Before daylight Lot comes to a hill.
948	To <u>wakan</u> wedereʒ so wylde þe wyndeʒ he calleʒ,	God aloft raises a storm.

& þay wroþely vp-wafte & wrastled togeder,
 Fro fawre half of þe folde, flytande loude.
 Clowde3 clustered bytwene kesten vp torres,
 952 Þat þe þik þunder þrast þirled hem ofte.
 Þe rayn rueled adoun, ridlande þikke,
 Of felle flaunkes of fyr & flakes of soufre,
 Al in smolderande smoke smachande ful ille,
 956 Swe aboute sodamas & hit syde3 alle,
 Gorde to gomorra þat þe grounde lansed;
 Abdama & syboym, þise ceteis alle faure,
 Al birolled wyth þe rayn, rostted & brenned,
 960 & ferly flayed þat folk þat in þose fees lenged;
 For when þat þe helle herde þe hounde3 of heuen
 He wat3 ferlyly fayn, vnfolded bylyue.

A rain falls thick of fire and sulphur.

Swe] Sweyed (?).

Upon the four cities it comes,

and frightens all folks therein.

FRUCTION OF THE CITIES.

Þe grete barre3 of þe abyne he barst vp at one3,
 964 Þat alle þe regioun to-rof in riftes ful grete,
 & clouen alle in lyttel cloutes þe clyffe3 aywhere,
 As lance leue3 of þe boke þat lepes in twynne.
 Þe brethe of þe brynston bi þat hit blende were,
 968 Al þo citees & her sydes sunkken to helle.
Rydelles wern þo grete rowtes of renkkes *with-inne*,
 When þay wern war of þe wrake þat no wy3e achaped,
 Such a 3omerly 3arm of 3ellyng þer rysed;
 972 Þer-of clatered þe cloudes þat kryst my3t haf rawþe.
 65 Þe segge herde þat soun to segor þat 3ede,
 & þe wenches hym wyth þat by þe way fol3ed;
 Ferly ferde wat3 her flesch, þat flowen ay ilyche,
 976 Trynande ay a hy3e trot þat torne neuer dorsten.
 Loth & þo luly-whit his lefly two de3ter,
 Ay fol3ed here face, bifore her boþe y3en;
 Bot þe balleful burde, þat neuer bode keped,

The great bars of the abyss do burst.

Cliffs cleave asunder.

The cities sink to hell.

Such a cry arises that the clowd clatter again.

[Fol. 7

Lot and his companions are frightened,

but continue to follow their fa

FE BECOMES A STIFF STONE.

980 Blusched by-hynden her bak, þat bale forto herkken;
 Hit wat3 lusty lothes wyf þat ouer he[r] lyfte schulder.
 Ones ho bluschet to þe bur3e, bot bod ho no lenger,
 Þat ho nas stadde a stiffe ston, a stalworth image
 984 Al so salt as ani se & so ho 3et stande3.
 Þay slypped bi & sy3e hir not þat wern hir samen feres,
 Tyl þay in segor wern sette, & sayned our lorde;
 Wyth ly3t loue3 vplyfte þay loued hym swyþe,
 988 Þat so his seruantes wolde see & saue of such woþe.
 Al wat3 dampned & don, & drowned by þenne;
 Þe lede3 of þat lyttel toun wern lopen out for drede,
 In-to þat malscrande mere, marred bylyue,
 992 Þat no3t saued wat3 bot segor þat sat on a lawe,
 Þe þre lede3 þer-in, loth & his de3ter;
 For his make wat3 myst, þat on þe mount lenged
 In a stonen statue þat salt sauor habbes,
 996 For two fautes þat þe fol wat3 founde in mistrauþe;
 On, ho serued at þe soper salt bifore dry3tyn
 & syþen, ho blusched hir bihynde, þa3 hir forboden were;
 For on ho standes a ston, & salt for þat oþer,

Lot's wife looks behind her,

and is turned to a stiff stone "a salt as any sea."

Her companions do not miss h
 till they reach Zoar.

By this time all were drowned
 The people of Zoar, for dread,
 rush into the sea and are
 destroyed.

Only Zoar with three therein (and his daughters) are saved.

Lot's wife is an image of salt f
 two faults:

1. She served salt before the L

1000 & alle lyst on hir lik þat arn on launde bestes.
 Abraham ful erly wat3 vp on þe morne,
 þat alle nazt [so] much niye hade no mon in his hert,
 Al in longing for loth leyn in a wache,
 1004 þer he lafte hade oure lorde, he is on lofte women;
 He sende toward sodomas þe syzt of his y3en,
 þat euer hade ben an erde of erþe þe swettest
 As aparaut to paradis þat plantted þe dryztyn,
 66 1008 Nov is hit plunged in a pit like of pich fylled.
 Suche a ropun of a reche ros fro þe blake,
 Aske3 vpe in þe ayre & vselle3 þer flowen,
 As a fornes ful of flot þat vpon fyr boyles,
 1012 When bryzt brennande brondez ar bet þer an-vnder.
 Þis wat3 a uengauce violent þat voyded þise places,
 þat foundered hat3 so fayr a folk & þe folde sonkken.

D SEA COVERS THE FIVE CITIES.

þer faure citees wern set, nov is a see called,
 1016 þat ay is drouy & dym, & ded in hit kynde,
 Blo, blubrande, & blak, vnblyþe to ne3e,
 As a stynkande stanc þat stryed synne,
 þat euer of synne & of smach, smart is to fele;
 1020 For-þy þe derk dede see hit is demed euer more,
 For hit dede3 of deþe duren þere 3et.
 For hit is brod & boþemle3, & bitter as þe galle,
 & no3t may lenge in þat lake þat any lyf bere3,
 1024 & alle þe coste3 of kynde hit combrez vchone;
 For lay þer-on a lump of led & hit on loft flete3,
 & folde þer-on a lyzt fyþer & hit to founs synkke3.
 & þer water may walter to wete any erþe,
 1028 Schal neuer grene þer-on growe, gresse ne wod nawþer.
 If any schalke to be schent wer schowued þer-inne,
 Þa3 he bode in þat boþem broþely a monyth,
 He most ay lyue in þat lo3e in losyng euer-more,
 1032 & neuer dry3e no dethe, to dayes of ende;
 & as hit is corsed of kynde & hit cooste3 als,
 þe clay þat clenges þer-by arn corsyes strong,
 As alum & alkaran, þat angré arn boþe,
 1036 Soufre sour, & saundyuer, & oþer such mony;
 & þer walte3 of þat water in waxlokes grete,
 þe spuniande asfaltoun þat spysere3 sellen;
 & suche is alle þe soyle by þat se halues,
 1040 þat fel fretes þe flesch & festred bones.
 & þer ar tres by þat terne of traytours;
 & þay borgoune3 & beres blome3 ful fayre,
 & þe fayrest fryt þat may on folde growe,
 67 1044 As oreng & oþer fryt & apple garnade
 Also red & so ripe & rychely hwed,
 As any dom myzt deuce of dayntye3 oute;
 Bot quen hit is brused oþer broken, oþer byten in twynne,
 1048 No worlde3 goud hit wyth-inne, bot wydowande askes;

KEN OF WICKEDNESS AND VENGEANCE.

Alle þyse ar teches & tokenes to trow vpon 3et,

at supper.
 2. She looked behind her.
 Abraham is up full early on the morn.
 He looks towards Sodom,
 now only a pit filled with pitch
 [Fol. 7
 from which rise smoke, ashes
 cinders, as from a furnace.

A sea now occupies the place of
 the four cities.

It is a stinking pool,
 and is called the Dead Sea.

Nothing may live in it.

Lead floats on its surface.
 A feather sinks to the bottom of
 Lands, watered by this sea, never
 bear grass or weed.

A man cannot be drowned in it.

The clay clinging to it is
 corrosive,
alkaran] *alkatran* (?).
angré] *augre* = *aigre* (?).
 as alum, alkaran, sulphur, etc.,
spuniande] *spinnande* (?).
festred] *festres* (?).

which fret the flesh and fester
 bones.

On the shores of this lake grow
 trees bearing fair fruits,

[Fol. 7
 which, when broken or bitten,
 taste like ashes.

wydowande] MS. *wyndowar*

& wittnesse of þat wykked werk & þe wrake after,
 þat oure fader forferde for fylpe of þose ledes.
 1052 þenne vch wyȝe may wel wyt þat he þe wlonk louies,
 & if he louyes clene layk þat is oure lorde ryche,
 & to be coupe *in his courte* þou coueytes þenne
 To se þat semly *in sete* & his swete face,
 1056 Clerrer counseyl, counsayl con I non, bot þat þou clene worpe.
 For clopyngnel *in þe compas* of his clene rose,
 þer he expounez a speche, to *hym* þat spede wolde,
 Of a lady to be loued, loke to hir sone,
 1060 Of wich beryng þat ho be, & wych ho best louyes,
 & be ryȝt such *in vch* a borȝe of body & of dedes,
 & folȝ þe fet of þat fere þat þou fre haldes.
 & if þou wyrkkes on þis wyse, þaȝ ho wyk were,
 1064 Hir schal lyke þat layk þat lyknes hir tylle.
 If þou wyl dele drwrye wyth dryȝtyn þenne,
 & lelly louy þy lorde & his leef worpe.
 þenne *confourme* þe to kryst, & þe clene make,
 1068 þat euer is polyced als playn as þe perle seluen.
 For loke fro fyrst þat he lyȝt *with-inne* þe lel mayden!

VAS EVER PURE.

By how comly a kest he watȝ clos þere,
 When venkkyst watȝ no *vergynyte*, ne vyolence maked,
 1072 Bot much clener watȝ hir corse, god *kynned* þerinne;
 & efte when he borne watȝ *in* beþelen þe ryche,
 In wych puryté þay departed; þaȝ þay pouer were,
 Watȝ neuer so blysful a *bour* as watȝ *abos* þenne
 1076 Ne no schroude *hous* so schene as a *schepon* þare,
 Ne non so glad vnder god as ho þat grone schulde;
 68 For þer watȝ seknesse al sounde þat sarrest is halden,
 & þer watȝ rose *reflayr* where *rote* hatȝ ben euer,
 1080 & þer watȝ solace & songe wher sorȝ hatȝ ay cryed;
 For *aungelles* *with instrumentes* of organes & pypes,
 & rial ryngande rotes & þe *reken fypel*,
 & alle hende þat honestly moȝt an hert glade,
 1084 Aboutte my lady watȝ lent, quen ho delyuer were.
 þenne watȝ her blyþe barne burnyst so clene,
 þat boþe þe ox & þe asse hym hered at-ones;
 þay knewe *hym* by his clannes for *kyng* of nature,
 1088 For non so clene of such a clos com neuer er þenne;
 & ȝif clarly he þenne com, ful cortays þer-after,
 þat alle þat longed to luper ful lodly he hated;
 By nobleye of his norture he nolde neuer towche
 1092 Oȝt þat watȝ vngoderly oþer ordure watȝ *inne*.
 Ȝet comen lodly to þat lede, as lazares monye,
 Summe lepre, *summe lome*, & *lomerande blynde*,
 Poysened & parlatyk & pyned *in fyres*,
 1096 Drye folk & ydropike, & dede at þe laste;
 Alle called on þat cortayse & claymed his *grace*.
 He heled hem wyth hynde speche of þat þay ask after,
 For what-so he towched also-tyd tourned to hele,
 1100 Wel clanner þen any crafte cowþe devyse;
 So clene watȝ his hondelyng vche ordure hit schonied,
 & þe gropyng so goud of god & man boþe,

All these are tokens of
 wickedness and vengeance.

God loves the pure in heart.

Strive to be clean.

Jean de Meun tells how a lady
 to be loved.

By doing what pleases her bes

Love thy Lord!

Conform to Christ, who is
 polished as a pearl.

By how comely a contrivance
 he enter the womb of the virgi

In what purity did he part from
 her!

abos] *abof* (?).

No abode was better than his.

The sorrow of childbirth was
 turned to joy.

[Fol. 7

Angels solaced the virgin with
 organs and pipes.

The child Christ was so clean
 ox and ass worshipped him.

He hated wickedness,

and would never touch ought t
 was vile.

Yet there came to him lazars a
 lepers, lame and blind.

Dry and dropsical folk.

He healed all with kind speech

His handling was so good,

þat for fetys of his fyngeres fonded he neuer
 1104 Nauper to cout ne to kerue, with knyf ne wyth egge,
 For-þy brek he þe bred blades wyth-outen;
 For hit ferde freloker *in fete in* his fayre honde,
 Displayed more pryuyly when he hit part schulde,
 1108 Þenne alle þe toles of tolowse mozt tyzt hit to kerue,
 Þus is he kyryous & clene þat þou his cort askes;
 Hov schulde þou com to his kyth bot if þou clene were?
 Nov ar we sore & synful & sov[er]ly vch one,
 1112 How schulde we se, þen may we say, þat syre vpon throne?
 69 3is, þat mayster is mercyable; þa3 þou be man fenny,
 & al to-marred *in myre whyl* þou on molde lyuyes,
 Þou may schyne þur3 schryfte, þa3 þou haf schome serued,

3 MAKES MAN PURE AS A PEARL.

1116 & pure þe with penaunce tyl þou a perle worþe.
 Perle praysed is prys, þer perre is schewed,
 Þa3 hym not derrest be demed to dele for penies,
 Quat may þe cause be called, bot for hir clene hwes,
 1120 Þat wynnes worschyp, abof alle whyte stones?
 For ho schynes so schyr þat is of schap rounde,
 Wyth-outen faut oþer fylþe 3if ho fyn were;
 & wax euer *in þe worlde in* weryng so olde,
 1124 3et þe perle payres not whyle ho *in pyese* lasttes
 & if hit cheue þe chaunce vncheryst ho worþe,
 Þat ho blyndes of ble in bour þer ho lygges,
 No-bot wasch hir wyth wourchyp *in wyn* as ho askes,
 1128 Ho by kynde schal be-com clerer þen are;
 So if folk be defowled by vnfre chaunce,
 Þat he be sulped *in sawle*, seche to schryfte
 & he may polyce hym at þe prest, by penaunce taken,
 1132 Wel bryzter þen þe beryl oþer browden perles.
 Bot war þe wel, if þou be waschen wyth water of schryfte,
 & polysed als playn as parchmen schauen,
 Sulp no more þenne *in synne* þy saule þer-after,
 1136 For þenne þou dryztyn dyspleses *with dedes* ful sore,
 & entyses hym to tene more trayþly þen euer
 & wel hatter to hate þen hade þou not waschen;
 For when a sawele is saztled & sakred to dryztyn,
 1140 He holly haldes hit his & haue hit he wolde,
 Þenne efte lastes hit likkes, he loses hit ille,
 As hit were rafte wyth vn-ryzt & robbed wyth þewes.
 War þe þenne for þe wrake, his wrath is achaufed,

ISHES IMPURITY.

1144 For þat þat ones wat3 his schulde efte be vn-clene,
 Þa3 hit be bot a bassyn, a bolle, oþer a scole,
 70 A dysche oþer a dobler þat dryztyn one3 serued,
 To defowle hit euer vpon folde fast he for-bedes,
 1148 So is he scoymus of scape þat scylful is euer.
 & þat wat3 bared *in babyloyn in* Baltazar tyme,
 Hov harde vnhap þer hym hent & hastyly sone,
 For he þe vesselles avyled þat vayled *in þe temple*
 1152 In seruyse of þe souerayn sum tyme byfore.
 3if 3e wolde tyzt me a tom telle hit I wolde,

cout] cut (?).

that he needed no knife to cut
carve with.

The bread he broke

more perfectly than could all t
tools of Toulouse.

How can we approach his cou
except we be clean?

sov[er]ly] MS. sovly.

God is merciful.

Through penance we may shin
a pearl.

[Fol. 7

Why is the pearl so prized?

She becomes none the worse f
wear.

If she should become dim, wa
her in wine.

She then becomes clearer than
before.

So may the sinner polish him l
penance.

Beware of returning to sin.

For then God is more displeas
than ever.

The reconciled soul God holds
His own.

þewes] þeues. (?).

Ill deeds rob Him of it.

God forbids us to defile any
vessels used in His service.

In Belshazzar's time, the defili
of God's vessels brought wrat
upon the king.

Hov charged more wat3 his chaunce þat hem cherych nolde
 þen his fader forloyne þat feched hem wyth strenþe,
 1156& robbed þe relygioun of relykes alle.

[Fol. 7]

XII.

Danyel in his dialoke3 de-vysed sum tyme,
 As 3et is proued ex-presse in his profecies,
 Hov þe gentryse of Iuise & Iherusalem þe ryche
 1160Wat3 disstryed wyth distres, & drawen to þe erþe,
 For þat folke in her fayth wat3 founden vnrwe,
 þat hadn hy3t þe hy3e god to halde of hym euer;
 & he hem hal3ed for his & help at her nede
 1164In mukel meschefes mony, þat meruayl [is] to here;
 & þay forloyne her fayth & fol3ed oþer goddes,
 & þat wakned his wrath & wrast hit so hy3e,
 þat he fylsened þe faythful in þe falce lawe
 1168To for-fare þe falce in þe faythe trwe;
 Hit wat3 sen in þat syþe þat zedechyas rengned,
 In Iuda, þat iustised þe iuyn kynge.
 He sete on Salamones solie, on solemne wyse,
 1172Bot of leaute he wat3 lat to his lorde hende;
 He vsed abominaciones of idolatrye,
 & lette ly3t bi þe lawe þat he wat3 lege tulle;
 For-þi oure fader vpon folde a foman hym wakned,
 1176Nabigo-de-no3ar nuyed hym swyþe.
 He pur-sued in to palastyn with proude men mony,
 & þer he wast wyth werre þe wones of þorpes.
 He her3ed vp alle israel & hent of þe beste,

Daniel in his prophecies tells of
 the destruction of the Jews.

For their unfaithfulness

in following other gods,

God allowed the heathen to
 destroy them,

zedechyas] MS. *zedethyas*.

in the reign of Zedekiah,

who practised idolatry.

Nebuchadnezzar becomes his

wyth] MS. *wyth with*.

ADNEZZAR BESIEGES JERUSALEM.

1180& þe gentylest of Iudee in Ierusalem biseged,
 71 Vmbe-walt alle þe walles wyth wy3es ful stronge,
 At vche a dor a do3ty duk, & dutte hem wyth-inne;
 For þe bor3 wat3 so bygge baytayled alofte,
 1184& stoffed wyth-inne with stout men to stalle hem þer-oute.
 Þenne wat3 þe sege sette þe Cete aboute,
 Skete skarmoch skelt, much skape lached;
 At vch brugge a berfray on basteles wyse,
 1188þat seuen syþe vch a day asayled þe 3ates,
 Trwe tulkkes in toures teueled wyth-inne,
 In bigge brutage of borde, bulde on þe walles;
 Þay fe3t & þay fende of, & fylter togeder
 1192Til two 3er ouer-torned, 3et tok þay hit neuer.
 At þe laste vpon longe, þo ledes wyth-inne,
 Faste fayled hem þe fode, enfaminied monie;
 þe hote hunger wyth-inne hert hem wel sarre,
 1196þen any dunt of þat douthe þat dowelled þer-oute.
 Þenne wern þo rowtes redles in þo ryche wones,
 Fro þat mete wat3 myst, megre þay wexen,
 & þay stoken so strayt, þat þay ne stray my3t
 1200A fote fro þat forselet to forray no goudes.
 Þenne þe kyng of þe kyth a counsayl hym takes,
 Wyth þe best of his burnes, a blench forto make;

He besieges Jerusalem, and
 surrounds the walls.

The city is stuffed full of men.

Brisk is the skirmish.

[Fol. 7]

Seven times a day are the gate
 assailed.

For two years the fight goes on
 yet the city is not taken.

The folk within are in want of
 food.

Meager they become.

For so shut up are they that escape
 seems impossible.

þay stel out on a stylle nyȝt er any steuen rysed,
 1204 & harde hurles þurȝ þe oste, er enmies hit wyste,
 Bot er þay at-wappe ne moȝt þe wach wyth-oute,
 Hiȝe skelt watȝ þe askry þe skewes an-vnder,
 Loude alarom vpon launde lulted watȝ þenne;
 1208 Ryche, ruþed of her rest, ran to here wedes,
 Hard hattes þay hent & on hors lepes;
 Cler claryoun crak cryed onlofte.
 By þat watȝ alle on a hepe hurlande swyþee,
 1212 Folȝande þat oþer flote, & fonde hem bilyue,
 Ouer-tok hem, as tyd, tult hem of sadeles,
 Tyl vche prynce hade his per put to þe grounde;

3 OF JUDAH IS MADE PRISONER.

But on a quiet night they steal
and rush through the host.

They are discovered by the
enemy.

A loud alarm is given.

They are pursued

and overtaken.

Their king is made prisoner.

His chief men are presented as
prisoners to Nebuchadnezzar.

His sons are slain.

His own eyes are put out.

He is placed in a dungeon in
Babylon.

[Fol. 7

All for his “bad bearing” again
the Lord,
who might otherwise have bee
his friend.

Nebuchadnezzar ceased not ur
he had destroyed Jerusalem.

Nebuzaradan was “chief of the
chivalry.”

The best men were taken out c
the city.

so] The MS. reads *fo*.

Nevertheless Nebuzaradan spa
not those left.

Brains of bairns were spilt.

Priests pressed to death.

Wives and wenches foully kill

All that escaped the sword we
taken to Babylon,

& þer watȝ þe kyng kaȝt wyth calde prynces,
 72 1216 & alle hiȝe gentyle for-iusted on ierico playnes,
 & presented wern as presoneris to þe prynce rychest,
 Nabigo-de-noȝar noble in his chayer,
 & he þe faynest freke þat he his fo hade,
 1220 & speke spitously hem to & spylt þerafter.
 Þe kynges sunnes in his syȝt he slow euer vch one,
 & holkked out his auen yȝen heterly boþe
 & bede þe burne to be broȝt to babyloyn þe ryche,
 1224 & þere in dongoun be don to dreȝe þer his wyrdes.
 Now se, so þe soueray[n] set hatȝ his wrake;
 Nas hit not for nabugo ne his noble nauþer,
 Þat oþer depnyed watȝ of pryde with paynes stronge,
 1228 Bot for his beryng so badde agayn his blyþe lorde;
 For hade þe fader ben his frende þat hym bifore keped,
 Ne neuer trespass to him in teche of mysseleue.
 To Colde wer alle Calde & kythes of ynde,
 1232 Ȝet take torkye hem wyth her tene hade ben little;
 Ȝet nolde neuer nabugo þis ilke note leue,
 Er he hade tuyred þis toun & torne hit to grounde;
 He ioyned vnto Ierusalem a gentyle duc þenne,
 1236 His name watȝ nabu-ȝardan, to noye þe iues;
 He watȝ mayster of his men & myȝty him seluen,
 Þe chef of his cheualrye his chekkes to make,
 He brek þe bareres as bylyue, & þe burȝ after,
 1240 & enteres in ful earnestly, in yre of his hert.
 What! þe maysterry watȝ mene, þe men wern away,
 Þe best boȝed wyth þe burne þat þe borȝ ȝemed;
 & þo þat byden wer so biten with þe bale hunger,
 1244 Þat on wyf hade ben worþe þe welgest fourre;
 Nabizardan noȝt for-þy nolde not spare,
 Bot bede al to þe bronde vnder bare egge.
 Þay slowen of swettest semlych burdes,
 1248 Baped barnes in blod & her brayn spylled;
 Prestes & prelates þay presed to deþe,
 Wyues & wenches her wombes tocoruen,
 Þat her boweles out-borst aboute þe diches,
 73 1252 & al watȝ carfully kylde þat þay cach myȝt,
 & alle [þat] swypped vnswoȝed of þe sworde kene,
 Þay wer cagged & kaȝt on capeles al bare,
 Festned fettres to her fete vnder fole wombes,

1256 & broþely broȝt to babyloyn þer bale to suffer,
 To sytte *in* seruage & syte; þat sumtyme wer gentyle,
 Now ar chaunged to chorles & charged wyth werkkes,
 Boþe to cayre at þe kart & þe kuy mylke,
 1260 Þat sumtyme sete *in* her sale syres & burdes.

and were made to drag the car
 milk the kine.

[Fol. 7

RDAN PILLAGES THE TEMPLE.

& ȝet nabuzardan nyl neuer stynt,
 Er he to þe tempple tee wyth his tulkkes alle;
 Betes on þe barers, brestes vp þe ȝates,
 1264 Slouen alle at a slyp þat serued þer-inne,
 Pulden prestes bi þe polle & plat of her hedes,
 Diȝten dekenes to deþe, dungen down clerkkes,
 & alle þe maydenes of þe munster maȝtyly hokyllen
 1268 Wyth þe swayf of þe sworde þat swolȝed hem alle.
 Þenne ran þay to þe relykes as robbors wylde,
 & pyled alle þe appaurent þat pented to þe kyrke,
 Þe pure pyleres [o]f bras pourtrayd *in* golde,
 1272 & þe chef chaundeler charged with þe lyȝt,
 Þat ber þe lamp vpon lofte, þat lemed euer more,
 Bifore þ[e] sancta *sanctorum* þer selcouth watȝ ofte.
 Þay caȝt away þat condelstik, & þe crowne als,
 1276 Þat þe auter hade vpon, of aþel golde ryche;
 Þe gredirne & þe goblotes garnyst of syluer,
 Þe bases of þe bryȝt postes & bassynes so schyre;
 Dere disches of golde & dubleres fayre,
 1280 Þe vyoles & þe vesselment of *vertuous* stones.
 Now hatȝ nabuzardan nomen alle þyse noble þynges,
 & pyled þat *precious* place & pakked þose godes;
 Þe golde of þe ȝaȝafylace to swyþe gret noumbre,
 1284 Wyth alle þe vrnmentes of þat hous, he hamppred to-geder.
 Alle he spoyled spitously *in* a sped whyle,
 Þat salomon so mony a sadde ȝer soȝt to make,
 74 Wyth alle þe coyntyse þat he cowþe clene to wyrke;
 1288 De-uised he þe vesselment, þe vestures clene,
 Wyth slyȝt of his ciences, his souerayn to loue,
 Þe hous & þe anournementes he hyȝtled to-gedere.
 Now hatȝ nabuzardan *numnend* hit al samen,
 1292 & syþen bet down þe burȝ & brend hit *in* askes;
 Þenne wyth legiounes of ledes ouer londes he rydes,
 Herȝeȝ of Israel þe hyrne aboute.
 Wyth charged chariotes þe cheftayn he fynde[ȝ],

Nebuzaradan burst open the
 temple,

and slew those therein.

Priests, pulled by the poll, wer
 slain along with deacons, clerk
 and maidens.

The enemy pillages the temple

of its pillars of brass,
 and the golden candlestick

from off the altar.

Goblets,
 basins,
 golden dishes,
 all are taken by Nebuzaradan,

and hampered together.

Solomon had made them with
 much labour.

numnend] *nummen* (?).

The temple he beats down,

and returns to Babylon.

ADNEZZAR IS PLEASED WITH THE SPOIL.

1296 Bikennes þe catel to þe kyng, þat he caȝt hade,
 Presented him þe prisoneres *in* pray þat þay token,
 Moni a worply wyȝe whil her worlde laste,
 Moni semly syre sone, & swyþe ryche maydenes,
 1300 Þe pruddest of þe prouince, & prophetes childer,
 As Ananie & azarie & als Miȝael,
 & dere daniel also, þat watȝ deuine noble,
 With moni a *modey* moder chylde mo þen *in*-noghe.
 1304 & nabugo-de-noȝar makes much ioie,
 Nov he þe kyng hatȝ conquest & þe kyth wunnen,
 & dreped alle þe doȝtyest & derrest *in* armes,

[Fol. 7

Presents the prisoners to the ki

among whom were Daniel and
 three companions.

Nebuchadnezzar has great joy,

& þe lederes of her lawe layd to þe grounde,
1308 & þe pryce of þe *profecie* prisoners maked;

S GREATLY THE SACRED JEWELRY.

Bot þe ioy of þe iuelrye so gentyle & ryche,
When hit wat3 schewed hym so schene, scharp wat3 his wonder,
Of such vessel auayed þat vayled so huge,
1312 Neuer zet nas nabugo-de-nozar er þenne.
He sesed hem *with* solemneté, þe souerayn he praysed,
þat wat3 aþel ouer alle, israel dry3tyn;
Such god, such gomes, such gay vesselles
1316 Comen neuer out of kyth, to Caldee reames.
He trussed hem *in* his tresorye *in* a tryed place
Rekenly wyth reuerens, as he ry3t hade;
& þer he wro3t as þe wyse, as 3e may wyt here-after,
1320 For hade he let of hem ly3t, hym mo3t haf lumpen worse.
þat ryche *in* gret rialté rengned his lyue,
75 As *conquerour* of vche a cost he cayser wat3 hatte,
Emperour of alle þe erþe & also þe saudan,
1324 & als þe god of þe grounde wat3 grauen his name
& al þur3 dome of daniel, *fro* he deuised hade,
þat alle goudes com of god, & gef hit hym bi samples,
þat he ful clantly *bi-cnv* his carp bi þe laste,
1328 & ofte hit mekned his mynde, his maysterful werkkes.
Bot al drawes to dy3e *with* doel vp[o]n ende;
Bi a haþel neuer so hy3e he *heldes* to grounde,
& so nabugo-de-nozar as he nedes moste;
1332 For alle his empire so hi3e *in* erþe is he *grauen*.
Bot þenn þe bolde baltazar, þat wat3 his barn aldest,
He wat3 stalled *in* his stud, & stabled þe rengne;
In þe bur3 of babiloyne þe biggest he trawed,
1336 þat nauþer *in* heuen ne *no* erþe hade no pere;
For he bigan *in* alle þe glori þat hym þe gome lafte,
Nabugo-de-Nozar, þat wat3 his noble fader;
So kene a kyng *in* Caldee com neuer er þenne.
1340 Bot honoured he not hym þat *in* heuen wonies,
Bot fals fantummes of fendes, formed with handes
Wyth tool out of harde tre, & telded on lofte,
& of stokkes & stones, he stoute goddes call3
1344 When þay ar gilde al with golde & gered wyth syluer,
& þere he kneles & calle3, & clepes after help.
& þay reden him ry3t rewarde he hem hetes,
& if þay gruchen him his grace to gremen his hert,
1348 He cleches to a gret klubbe & knokkes hem to peces;
Þus in pryde & olipraunce his Empyre he haldes,
In lust & *in* lecherye, & loþelych werkkes;
& hade a wyf forto welde, a worþelych quene,
1352 & mony a lemman, neuer þe later, þat ladis wer called.
In þe clernes of his *concubines* & curious wede3,
In notyng of nwe metes & of nice gettes,
Al wat3 þe mynde of þat man, *on* misschapien þinges,
1356 Til þe lorde of þe lyfte liste hit abate.

because his enemies are slain.

Great was his wonder when he
saw the sacred jewelry.

He praises the God of Israel.

Such vessels never before cam
Chaldea.

They are thrust into the treasur

Nebuchadnezzar reigns as
emperor of all the earth,

fro] *for* (?).

through the “doom of Daniel,”

bi-cnv] Looks like *bicuver* in
MS.

who gave him good counsel.

Bi] *be* (?).

Nebuchadnezzar dies and is
buried.

[Fol. 7

Belshazzar succeeds him.

He holds himself the biggest in
heaven or on earth.

no] *on* (?).

He honours not God,
but worships false phantoms.

&] *An* (?).

He promises them rewards if ȝ
fortune befall.

If they vex him he knocks ther
pieces.

He has a wife, and many
concubines.

The mind of the king was fixe
upon new meats and other vau
things.

XIII.

T henne þis bolde Baltazar biþenkkes hym ones,
 To vouche on a vayment of his vayne g[l]orie;
 Hit is not innoghe to þe nice al noȝty þink vse,
 1360 Bot if alle þe worlde wyt his wykked dedes.
 Baltazar þurȝ babiloyn his banne gart crye,
 & þurȝ þe cuntre of caldee his callyng con spryng,
 Þat alle þe grete vpon grounde schulde geder hem samen
 1364 & assemble at a set day at þe saudans fest.
 Such a mangerie to make þe man watȝ auised,
 Þat vche a kythyn kyng schuld com þider;
 Vche duk wyth his duthe & oþer dere lordes,
 1368 Schulde com to his court to kyþe hym for lege,
 & to reche hym reuerens & his reuel herkken;
 To loke on his lemanes & ladis hem calle,
 To rose hym in his rialty rych men soȝtten,
 1372 & mony a baroun ful bolde, to babyloyn þe noble.
 Þer bowed toward babiloyn burnes so mony,
 Kynges, Cayseres ful kene, to þe court wonnen,
 Mony ludisch lordes þat ladies broȝten,
 1376 Þat to neuen þe noumbre to much nye were.
 For þe bourȝ watȝ so brod & so bigge alce,
 Stalled in þe fayrest stud þe sterreȝ an-vnder,
 Prudly on a plat playn, plek alþer-fayrest,
 1380 Vmbe-sweyed on vch a syde with seuen grete wateres,
 With a wonder wroȝt walle wruxeled ful hiȝe,
 With koynt carneles aboue, coruen ful clene,
 Troched toures bitwene twenty spere lenþe,
 1384 & þiker þrowen vmbe þour-with ouer-þwert palle.
 Þe place, þat plyed þe pursaunt wyth-inne,
 Watȝ longe & ful large & euer ilych sware,
 & vch a syde vpon soyle helde seuen myle,
 1388 & þe saudans sete sette in þe myddes;
 Þat watȝ a palayce of pryde passande alle oþer,
 Boþe of werk & of wunder & walle al aboute;
 77 Heȝe houses with-inne þe halle to hit med,
 1392 So brod bilde in a bay, þat blonkkes myȝt renne.

H KINGS AND EMPERORS ARE INVITED.

When þe terme of þe tyde watȝ to vsched of þe feste,
 Dere droȝen þer-to & vpon des metten,
 & baltazar vpon bench was busked to sete,
 1396 Stepe stayred stones of his stoute throne.
 Þenne watȝ alle þe halle flor hiled with knyȝtes,
 & barounes at þe side-bordes bounet ay-where,
 For non watȝ dressed vpon dece bot þe dere seluen,
 1400 & his clere concubynes in cloþes ful bryȝt.
 When alle segges were þer set, þen seruyse bygynnes,
 Sturnen trumþen strake steuen in halle,
 Aywhere by þe woves wrasten krakkes,
 1404 & brode baneres þer-bi blusnande of gold;
 Burnes berande þe bredes vpon brode skeles,
 Þat were of sylueren syȝt & seerved þer-wyth,
 Lyfte logges þer-ouer & on lofte coruen,

Belshazzar, to exhibit his
vainglory

þink] *þing* (?).

proclaims throughout Babylon

that all the great ones should
assemble on a set day, at the
Sultan's feast.

Kings, dukes, and lords were
commanded to attend the cour

[Fol. 7

To do the king honour many
nobles came to Babylon.

It would take too long to name
number.

The city of Babylon is broad a
big.

It is situated on a plain,
surrounded by seven streams,
a high wall, and towers.

þour] *þore* (?).

The palace was long and large

each side being seven miles in
length.

High houses were within the
walls.

The time of the feast has come

Belshazzar sits upon his throne

the hall floor is covered with
knights.

When all are seated, service
begins.

Trumpets sound everywhere.

[Fol. 7

þe] MS. *þe* *þe*.

1408 Pared out of paper & poynted of golde,
 Broþe baboynes abof, besttes an-vnder,
 Foles *in foler flakerande* bi-twene,
 & al *in asure* & ynde enaumayld ryche,
 1412 & al on blonkken bak bere hit on honde.
 & ay þe nakeryn noyse, notes of pipes,
 Tymbres & tabornes, tulket among,
 Symbales & soneteȝ sware þe noyse,
 1416 & bougounȝ busch batered so þikke;
 So watȝ serued fele syþe þe sale alle aboute,
 With solace at þe sere course, bifore þe self lorde,
 Þer þe lede & alle his loue lenged at þe table.
 1420 So faste þay weȝed to him wyne, hit warmed his hert
 & breyþed vppe *in* to his brayn & blemyst his mynde,
 & al waykned his wyt, & wel neȝe he foles,
 For he wayteȝ onwyde, his wenches he byholdes,
 1424 & his bolde baronage, aboute bi þe woȝes;
 Þenne a dotage ful depe drof to his hert,
 & a caytif counsayl he caȝt bi hym seluen.

Bread is served upon silver dishes.

seerved] MS. *severed*.

golde] MS. *glolde* (?).

All sorts of musical instrumen
are heard in the hall.

The king, surrounded by his
loves, drinks copiously of win

It gets into his head and stupif
him.

A cursed thought takes posses
of him.

He commands his marshal to
bring him the vessels

taken from the temple by
Nebuchadnezzar,

and to fill them with wine.

The marshal opens the chests.

Covers the cupboard with vess

[Fol. 7

ierusalem] MS. *iesuralem*.

The Jewels of Jerusalem deck
sides of the hall.

The altar and crown,
blessed by bishop's hands,
and anointed with the blood of
beasts,

are set before the bold Belshaz

Upon this altar were noble ves
curiously carved,

so] MS. *fo*.

basins of gold,

78

ZAR BRINGS OUT THE SACRED VESSELS

Maynly his marschal þe mayster vpon calles,
 1428 & comaundes hym cofly coferes to lance,
 & fech forþe vessel þat his fader broȝt
 Nabugo-de-noȝar, noble *in* his strenþe,
 Conquerd with his knyȝtes & of kyrk rafte
 1432 *In iude, in ierusalem in gentyle wyse:*
 “Bryng hem now to my borde, of beuerage hem fylles,
 Let piȝe ladyes of hem lape, I luf hem *in* hert;
 Þat schal I cortaysly kyþe & þay *schin* knawe sone,
 1436 Þer is no bounté *in* burne lyk baltazar þewes.”
 Þenne towched to þe tresour þis tale watȝ sone,
 & he *with* keyes vn-closes kystes ful mony;
 Mony burþen ful bryȝt watȝ broȝt *in-to* halle,
 1440 & couered mony a cupborde with cloþes ful quite.
 Þe iueles out of *ierusalem* *with* gemmes ful bryȝt,
 Bi þe syde of þe sale were semely arayed;
 Þe aþel auter of brasse watȝ hade *in-to* place;
 1444 Þe gay coroun of golde gered on lofte,
 Þat hade ben blessed bifore wyth bischopes hondes
 & wyth besten blod busily anoynted,
 In þe solempne sacrefyce þat goud sauor hade,
 1448 Bifore þe lorde of þe lyfte *in louyng* hym seluen,
 Now is sette for to serue satanas þe blake,
 Bifore þe bolde baltazar wyth bost & wyth pryde.

THE FESTIVE HALL.

Houen vpon þis auter watȝ aþel vessel,
 1452 Þat wyth *so curious* a crafte coruen watȝ wylȝ;
 Salamon sete him s[eue]n ȝere & a syþe more,
 With alle þe syence þat hym sende þe souerayn lorde,
 For to compas & kest to haf hem clene wroȝt;
 1456 For þer wer bassynes ful bryȝt of brende golde clere,
 En-aumaylde *with* aȝer & eweres of sute;
 Couered cowpes *foul* clene, as casteles arayed,

basins of gold,

Enbaned vnder batelment *with* bantelles quoynt,
 1460 & fyled out of fygures of *ferlyle* schappes.
 Þe coperounes of þe canacles þat on þe cuppe reres,
 Wer fetysely formed out *in* fylloles longe,
 79 Pinacles pyȝt þer apert þat *profert* bitwene,
 1464 & al boiled abof *with* braunches & leues,
 Pyes & papeiayes purtrayed *with-inne*,
 As þay prudly hade piked of pomgarnades;
 For alle þe blomes of þe boȝes wer blyknande perles
 1468 & alle þe fruyt *in* þo formes of flaumbeande *gemmes*,
 Ande safyres, & sardiners, & semely topace,
 Alabaunderynes, & amaraunȝ & amaffised stones,
 Casydoynes, & crysolytes, & clere rubies,
 1472 Penitotes, & pynkardines, ay perles bitwene,
 So trayled & tryfled a trauerce wer alle,
 Bi vche bekyrande þe bolde, þe brurdes al vmbe;
 Þe gobelotes of golde grauen aboute,
 1476 & fyoles fretted *with* flores & fleeȝ of golde,
 Vpon þat avter watȝ al aliche dresset.
 Þe candelstik bi a cost watȝ cayred þider sone,
 [V]pon þe pyleres apyked þat praysed hit mony,
 1480 Vpon hit baseȝ of brasse þat ber vp þe werkes,
 Þe boȝes bryȝt þer abof, brayden of golde,
 Braunches bredande þer-on, & bryddes þer seten
 Of mony kyndes, of fele-kyn hues,
 1484 As þay *with* wynges vpon wynde hade waged her fyperes,
 In-mong þe leues of þe lampes wer grayped;
 & oþer *louelych* lyȝt þat lemed ful fayre,
 As mony morteres of wax merkked *with-out*e,
 1488 *With* mony a borlych best al of brende golde.
 Hit watȝ not wonte *in* þat wone to wast no serges,
 Bot *in* temple of þe traupe trwly to stonde;
 Bifore þe *sancta*, *sanctorum* soþefast dryȝtyn,
 1492 Expounded his speche *spiritually* to special prophetes.

RED VESSELS ARE DEFILED.

Leue þou wel þat þe lorde þat þe lyfte ȝemes
 Displesed much, at þat play *in* þat plyt stronge,
 Þat his ineles so gent wyth *iaueles* wer fouled,
 1496 Þat *presyous* *in* his presens wer proued sum whyle.
 Soberly *in* his sacrafyce summe wer anoynted,
 Þurȝ þe somones of him selfe þat syttes so hyȝe;
 80 Now a boster on benche bibbes þerof
 1500 Tyl he be dronkken as þe deuyl, & dotes þer he syttes;
 So þe worcher of þis worlde *wlates* þer-wyth,
 Þat *in* þe poynt of her play he poruayes a mynde;
 Bot er harme hem he wolde *in* haste of his yre,
 1504 He *wayned* hem a warnyng þat wonder hem þoȝt.
 Nov is alle þis guere geten *glotounes* to serue;
 Stad *in* a ryche stal & stared ful *bryȝtȝ*,
 Baltazar *in* a brayd bede *vus* þer-of.
 1508 “Weȝe wyn *in* þis won, wassay!” he cries.
 Swyfte swaynes ful swyþe swepen þer-tylle,
Kyppe kowpes *in* honde kynges to serue,
In bryȝt bolleȝ, ful bayn *birlen* pise oþer,

foul] *ful* (?).

cups arrayed like castles with battlements,

ferlyle] *ferlyke* (?).

and towers with lofty pinnacle

Upon them were pourtrayed branches and leaves,

the flowers of which were whi pearls,

and the fruit flaming gems.

[Fol. 7

The goblets were ornamented with flowers of gold.

The candlestick was brought in with its pillars of brass, and ornamental boughs, upon which sat birds of variou hues.

Lights shone bright from the candlestick,

louelych] Looks like *louflyci*

which once stood before the “Holy of Holies.”

The pollution of the sacred vessels is displeasing to God.

For “a boaster on bench” drink from them till he is as “drunke the devil.”

God is very angry.

Before harming the revellers I sends them a warning.

bryȝtȝ] ? *bryȝte*.

Belshazzar commands the saci vessels to be filled with wine.

The cups and bowls are soon filled.

1512 & vche mon for his mayster machches alone.
 Per wat3 rynging, on ryzt, of ryche metalles,
 Quen renkkes in þat ryche rok rennen hit to cache,
 Clatering of conacle3 þat kesten þo burdes,
 1516 As sonet out of sau[t]eray songe als myry.
 Pen þe dotel on dece drank þat he myzt,
 & þenne arn dressed duke3 & prynces,
 Concubines & kny3tes, bi cause of þat merthe;
 1520 As vchon hade hym in helde he haled of þe cuppe,
 So long likked þise lordes þise lykores swete,
 & gloryed on her falce goddes & her grace calles,
 þat were of stokkes & stones, stille euer more;
 1524 Neuer steuen hem astel, so stoken is hor tonge,
 Alle þe goude golden goddes þe gaule3 zet neuenen,
 Belfagor & belyal & belssabub als,
 Heyred hem as hy3ly as heuen wer þayres,
 1528 Bot hym þat alle goudes giues, þat god þay for-zeten,
 For þer a ferly bifel þat fele folk se3en;
 Fyrst knew hit þe kyng & alle þe cort after,

DWRITING ON THE WALL.

81 In þe palays pryncipale vpon þe playn wowe,
 1532 In contrary of þe candelstik þat clerest hit schyned.
 Per apered a paume, with poyntel in fyngres
 þat wat3 grysly & gret, & grymly he wrytes,
 Non oþer forme bot a fust faylande þe wryste,
 1536 Pared on þe parget, purtrayed lettres.
 When þat bolde baltazar blusched to þat neue,
 Such a dasande drede dusched to his hert,
 þat al falewed his face & fayled þe chere;
 1540 Þe stronge strok of þe stonde strayned his ioyntes,
 His cnes cachches to close & cluchches his hommes,
 & he with plat-tyng his paumes displayes his lers,
 & romyes as a rad ryth þat rore3 for drede,
 1544 Ay biholdand þe honde til hit hade al grauen,
 & rasped on þe ro3 wo3e runisch saue3.
 When hit þe scrypture hade scraped wyth a scrof penne,
 As a coltour in clay cerues þo forzes,
 1548 Þenne hit vanist verayly & voyded of syzt,
 Bot þe lettres bileued ful large vpon plaster.
 Sone so þe kyng for his care carping myzt wynne,
 He bede his burnes bo3 to þat were bok lered,
 1552 To wayte þe wryt þat hit wolde & wyter hym to say,
 “For al hit frayes my flesche þe fyngres so grymme.”
 Scoleres skelten þeratte þe skyl forto fynde,
 Bot þer wat3 neuer on so wyse coupe on worde rede,
 1556 Ne what ledisch lore ne langage nauþer
 What tyþyng ne tale tokened þo dra3tes.
 Þenne þe bolde baltazar bred ner wode.
 & ede þe Ceté to seche segges þur3-out,

3 CONSULTS HIS DIVINERS.

1560 þat wer wyse of wyche-crafte & warla3es oþer,
 þat con dele wyth demerlayk, & deuine lettres:
 “Calle hem alle to my cort þo calde clerkkes,

[Fol. 7

Music of all kind is heard in th
 hall.

Dukes, princes, concubines, ar
 knights, all are merry.

Drinking of the sweet liquors t
 ask favours of their gods,

is] MS. īs.

who, although dumb,

are as highly praised “as if hea
 were theirs.”

A marvel befalls the feasters.

The king first saw it.

Upon the plain wall,

“a palm with pointel in fingers
 seen writing.

The bold Belshazzar becomes
 frightened.

His knees knock together.

lers] MS. lerns.

He roars for dread, still behold
 the hand, as it wrote on the rot
 wall.

scrof] MS. strof.

[Fol. 7

The hand vanishes but the lette
 remain.

The king recovers his speech &
 sends for the “book-learned;”

but none of the scholars were
 wise enough to read it.

Belshazzar is nearly mad.

ede] bede (?).

Commands the city to be searc
 throughout for the “wise of
 witchcraft.”

Vn-folde hem alle þis ferly þat is bifallen here,
 1564 & calle wyth a hiȝe cry; 'he þat þe kyng wysses,
 In expounyng of speche þat sprede*s* in þise lettres,
 & make þe mater to malt my mynde wyth-inne,
 þat I may wyterly wyt what þat wryt menes,
 1568 He schal þe gered ful gaye in gounes of porpre,
 & a coler of cler golde clos vmbe his þrote;
 82 He schal be prymate & prynce of pure clergie,
 & of my þreuenest lordeȝ þe þrydde he schal
 1572 & of my reme þe ryche*st* to ryde wyth myseluen,
 Out-taken bare two & þenne he þe þrydde."'
 Þis cry watȝ vp-caste, & þer comen mony
 Clerkes out of caldye þat kennest wer knauen,
 1576 As þe sage sathrapas þat sorsory couþe;
 Wycheȝ & walkyries wonnen to þat sale,
 Deuinore*s* of demorlaykes þat dremes cowþe rede,
 Sorsers & exorsismus & fele such clerkes;
 1580 & alle þat loked on þat letter as lewed þay were,
 As þay had loked in þe leþer of my lyft bote.
 Þenne cryes þe kyng & kerues his wedes;
 What! he corsed his clerkes & calde hem chorles,
 1584 To henge þe harlotes he heȝed ful ofte,
 So watȝ þe wyȝe wytles, he wed wel ner.
 Ho herde hym chyde to þe chambre þat watȝ þe chef quene;
 When ho watȝ wytered bi wyȝes what watȝ þe cause,
 1588 Suche a chaungande chaunce in þe chef halle,
 Þe lady to lauce þat los þat þe lorde hade,
 Glydes down by þe grece & gos to þe kyng;
 Ho kneles on þe colde erþe & carpes to hym seluen,
 1592 Wordes of worchyp wyth a wys speche.
 "Kene kyng," quod þe quene, "kayser of vrþe,
 Euer laste þy lyf in lenþe of dayes;
 Why hatȝ þou rended þy robe for redles here-inne,
 1596 Þaȝ pose ledes ben lewed lettres to rede,
 & hatȝ a hape*l* in þy holde, as I haf herde ofte,
 þat hatȝ þe gostes of god þat gyes alle soþes;
 His sawle is ful of syence, saȝes to schawe,
 1600 To open vch a hide þyng of aunteres vn-cowþe;
 þat is he þat ful ofte hatȝ heuened þy fader
 Of mony anger ful hote with his holy speche.
 When nabugo-de-noȝar watȝ nyed in stoundes,
 1604 He de-vysed his dremes to þe dere trawþe,
 He keuered hym with his counsayl of caytyf wyrdes;
 83 Alle þat he spured hym in space he expowned clene,
 Þurȝ þe sped of þe spyryt þat sprad hym with-inne,
 1608 Of þe godelest goddeȝ þat gaynes ay-where.
 For his depe diuinité & his dere sawes,

S SENT FOR.

þy bolde fader baltazar bede by his name,
 þat now is demed danyel of derne coninges,
 1612 þat caȝt watȝ in þe captyuidé in cuntre of iues;
 Nabuzardan hym nome & now is he here,
 A prophete of þat prouince & pryce of þe worlde.
 Sende in-to þe ceté to seche hym bylyue,

He who expounds the strange
 letters,

shall be clothed in "gowns of
 purple."

A collar of gold shall encircle
 throat.

He shall be the third lord in the
 realm.

As soon as this cry was upcast
 the hall came clerks out of
 Chaldea,

witches and diviners,

sorcerers and exorcists.

But after looking on the letters
 they were as ignorant as if they
 had looked into the leather of a
 left boot.

The king curses them all and calls
 them churls.

[Fol. 7

He orders the harlots to be
 hanged.

The queen hears the king chide
 She inquires the cause.

lauce] lance (?).

Goes to the king, kneels before
 him,

and asks why he has rent his robe
 for grief,

when there is one that has the
 Spirit of God,

the counsellor of
 Nebuchadnezzar,

the interpreter of his dreams,

through the holy Spirit of God

by] be (?).

The name of this man is Danie*l*
 who was brought a captive from
 Judæa.

1616 & wyne hym *with* þe worchyp to wayne þe bote,
 & þa3 þe mater be merk þat merked is 3ender,
 He schal de-clar hit also, as hit on clay stande.”
 Þat gode counseyl at þe quene wat3 cached as swyþe,
 1620 Þe burne byfore baltazar wat3 bro3t in a whyle,
 When he com bifore þe kyng & clanly had halsed,
 Baltazar vmbe-brayde hym & “leue *sir*,” he sayde,
 “Hit is tolde me bi tulkes, þat þou trwe were
 1624 Profete of þat prouynce þat prayed my fader,
 Ande þat þou hat3 in þy hert holy connyng,
 Of sapyence þi sawle ful soþes to schawe;
 Goddes gost is þe geuen þat gyes alle þynges,
 1628 & þou vnhyles vch hidde þat heuen kyng myntes;
 & here is a ferly byfallen, & I fayn wolde
 Wyt þe wytte of þe wryt, þat on þe wowe clyues,
 For alle calde clerkes han cowwardely fayled;
 1632 If þou *with* quayntyse conquere hit, I quyte þe þy mede.
 For if þou redes hit by ry3t & hit to resoun brynges,
 Fyrst telle me þe tyxte of þe tede lettres,
 & syþen þe mater of þe mode, mene me þer-after,
 1636 & I schal halde þe þe hest þat I þe hy3t haue;
 Apyke þe in porpre cloþe, palle alþer-fynest,
 & þe by3e of bry3t golde abowte þyn nekke,
 & þe þryd þryuenest þat þrynges me after,
 1640 Þou schal be baroun vpon benche, bede I þe no lasse.”

DESCRIBES HOW NEBUCHADNEZZAR

The queen tells the king to sen for Daniel.

as] MS. *as as*.

Her counsel is accepted.

[Fol. 7

Daniel comes before Belshazz

The king tells him that he has heard of his wisdom,

and his power to discover hidde things,

and that he wants to know the meaning of the writing on the wall.

Promises him, if he can explai the text of the letters and their interpretation,

to clothe him in purple and pal and put a ring about his neck,

and to make him “a baron upo bench.”

Daniel addresses the king,

and reminds him how that God supported his father,

and gave him power to exalt o abase whomsoever he pleased.

Nebuchadnezzar was establish

on account of his faith in God.

So long as he remained true, n man was greater.

[Fol. 8

But at last pride touches his he

He forgets the power of God, & blasphemes His name.

He says that he is “god of the ground,”

and the builder of Babylon.

84 Derfly þenne danyel deles þyse wordes:
 “Ryche kyng of þis rengne rede þe oure lorde,
 Hit is surely soth, þe souerayn of heuen
 1644 Fylsened euer þy fader & vpon folde cheryched,
 Gart hym grattest to be of gouernores alle,
 & alle þe worlde in his wyll welde as hym lykes.
 Who-so wolde wel do, wel hym bityde,
 1648 & quos deth so he de3yre he dreped als fast;
 Who-so hym lyked to lyft, on lofte wat3 he sone,
 & quo-so hym lyked to lay, wat3 lo3ed bylyue.
 So wat3 noted þe note of nabugo-de-no3ar,
 1652 Styfly stabled þe rengne bi þe stronge dry3tyn,
 For of þe hy3est he hade a hope in his hert,
 Þat vche pouer past out of [þ]at prynce euen;
 & whyle þat wat3 cle3t clos in his hert,
 1656 Þere wat3 no mon vpon molde of my3t as hym seluen,
 Til hit bitide on a tyme, towched hym pryde
 For his lordeschyp so large, & his lyf ryche;
 He hade so huge an insy3t to his aune dedes,
 1660 Þat þe power of þe hy3e prynce he purely for3etes.
 Þenne blynnes he not of blasfemyon to blame þe dry3tyn,
 His my3t mete to goddes he made *with* his wordes:
 “I am god of þe grounde, to gye as me lykes,
 1664 As he þat hy3e is in heuen his aungeles þat weldes;
 If he hat3 formed þe folde & folk þer vpone,
 I haf bigged babiloyne, bur3 alþer-rychest,
 Stabled þer-inne vche a ston in strenkþe of myn armes,
 1668 Mo3t neuer my3t bot myn make such anoþer.”

Wat3 not þis ilke worde women of his mowþe one,
 Er þenne þe souerayn saze souned in his eres,
 “Now nabugo-de-nozar inno3e hat3 spoken,
 1672 Now is alle þy pryncipalté past at ones,
 & þou, remued fro monnes sunes, on mor most abide,
 & in wasterne walk & wyth þe wylde dowelle,
 As best, byte on þe bent of braken & erbes,
 1676 With wroþe wolfes to won & wyth wylde asses.”
 In mydde þe poynt of his pryde de-parted he pere,

Hardly had Nebuchadnezzar
 spoken,
 when God’s voice is heard,
 saying, “Thy principality is
 departed.

Thou, removed from men, mu
 abide on the moor, and walk w
 wild beasts, eat herbs, and dw
 with wolves and asses.”

85

ISHED FOR HIS PRIDE.

Fro þe soly of his solempneté, his solace he leues,
 & carfully is out-kast to contré vnknawen,
 1680 Fer in-to a fyr fryth þere frekes neuer comen.
 His hert heldet vnhole, he hoped non oþer
 Bot a best þat he be, a bol oþer an oxe.
 He fares forth on alle faure, fogge wat3 his mete,
 1684 & ete ay as a horce when erbes were fallen,
 þus he countes hym a kow, þat wat3 a kyng ryche,
 Quyle seuen syþe3 were ouer-seyed someres I trawe.
 By þat, mony þik thy3e þry3t vmbe his lyre,
 1688 þat alle wat3 dubbed & dy3t in þe dew of heuen;
 Faxe fyltered, & felt flosed hym vmbe,
 þat schad fro his schulderes to his schyre wykes,
 & twenty-folde twynande hit to his tos razt
 1692 þer mony clyuy as clyde hit cly3t to-geder.
 His berde I-brad alle his brest to þe bare vrþe,
 His browes bresed as breres aboute his brode chekes;
 Hol3e were his y3en & vnder campe hores,
 1696 & al wat3 gray as þe glede, with ful grymme clawres
 þat were croked & kene as þe kyte paune;
 Erne-hwed he wat3 & al ouer-brawden,
 Til he wyst ful wel who wro3t alle my3tes,
 1700 & cowþe vche kyndam tokerue & keuer when hym lyked;
 þenne he wayned hym his wyt þat hade wo soffered,
 þat he com to knawlach & kenned hym seluen,
 þenne he laued þat lorde & leued in trawþe,
 1704 Hit wat3 non oþer þen he þat hade al in honde.
 þenne sone wat3 he sende agayn, his sete restored;
 His barounes bo3ed hym to, blyþe of his come,
Hazerly in his aune hwe his heued wat3 couered,
 1708 & so 3eþly wat3 zarked & 3olden his state.
 Bot þou baltazar his barne & his bolde ayre,
 Se3 þese syngnes with sy3t & set hem at lyttel,
 Bot ay hat3 hofen þy hert agaynes þe hy3e dry3t[yn],
 1712 With bobaunce & with blasfamy bost at hym kest,
 & now his vessayles avyled in vanyté vnclene,
 þat in his hows hym to honour were heuened of fyrst;
 Bifore þe baroun3 hat3 hom bro3t, & byrled þerinne
 1716 Wale wyne to þy wenches in waryed stoundes;
 Bifore þy borde hat3 þou bro3t beuerage in þede,
 þat blyþely were fyrst blest with bischopes hondes,
 Louande þeron lese godde3, þat lyf haden neuer,
 1720 Made of stokkes & stone3 þat neuer styry mo3t.
 & for þat froþande fylþe, þe fader of heuen

For his pride he becomes an
 outcast.

He believes himself to be a bu
 an ox.

Goes “on all fours,”

like a cow,

for seven summers.

His thighs grew thick.

His hair became matted and th
 from the shoulders to the toes.

His beard touched the earth.

His brows were like briars.

[Fol. 8

His eyes were hollow,
 and grey as the kite’s.

paune] ? *panne*.

Eagle-hued he was.

At last he recovered his “wit,”

laued] *loued* (?).

and believed in God.

Then soon was he restored to l
 seat.

But thou, Belshazzar, hast
 disregarded these signs,

and hast blasphemed the Lord,
 defiled his vessels,

filling them with wine for thy
 wenches,

and praising thy lifeless gods.

86

Hat3 sende in-to þis sale þise sy3tes vncowþe,
 þe fyste with þe fyngeres þat flayed þi hert,
 1724 þat rasped renyschly þe wo3e with þe ro3 penne.

INTERPRETATION OF THE HANDWRITING.

þise ar þe wordes here wryten *with-out*e werk more,
 By vch fygure, as I fynde, as oure fader lykes.
 “Mane, techal, phares, merked *in þrynn*e,
 1728 þat þretes þe of þyn vnþryfte vpon þre wyse;
 Now expowne þe þis speche spedly I þenk.
 Mane menes als much as, maynful gode
 Hat3 counted þy kyndam bi a clene noumbre,
 1732 & ful-fylled hit *in* fayth to þe fyrre ende.
 To teche þe of techal, þat terme þus menes,
 þy wale rengne is walt *in* we3tes to heng,
 & is funde ful fewe of hit fayth dedes.
 1736 & phares fol3es for þose fawtes to frayst þe trawþe,
 In phares fynde I forsoþe þise felle sa3es;
 De-parted is þy pryncipalté, depnyed þou worþes,
 þy rengne rafte is þe fro, & razt is þe perses,
 1740 þe medes schal be maysteres here, & þou of menske schowued.”
 þe kyng comaunded anon to clepe þat wyse,
 In frokkes of fyn cloþ, as forward hit asked;
 þenne sone wat3 danyel dubbed *in* ful dere porpor
 1744 & a coler of cler golde kest vmbe his swyre.
 þen wat3 demed a de-cre bi þe duk seluen,
 Bolde baltaza[r] bed þat hym bowe schulde
 þe comynes a lof calde þat to þe kyng longed,
 87 1748 As to þe prynce pryuyest preued þe prydde,
 He3est of alle oþer, saf onelych tweyne,
 To bo3 after baltazar *in* bor3e & *in* felde.
 þys wat3 cryed & knawen *in* cort als fast,
 1752 & alle þe folk þer-of fayn þat fol3ed hym tylle;
 Bot how-so danyel wat3 dy3t, þat day ouer-3ede,
 Ny3t ne3ed ry3t now *with* nyes fol mony,
 For dazed neuer an oþer day þat ilk derk after,
 1756 Er dalt were þat ilk dome þat danyel deuysed,
 þe solace of þe solemneté *in* þat sale dured
 Of þat farand fest, tyl fayled þe sunne;
 þenne blykned þe ble of þe bry3t skwes,
 1760 Mourkenes þe mery weder, & þe myst dryues
 þor3 þe lyst of þe lyfte, bi þe lo3 medoes;
 Vche hapel to his home hy3es ful fast,
 Seten at her soper & songen þer-after,
 1764 þen founde3 vch a felazschyp fyrre at forþ naztes.

THE SIEGE TO BABYLON.

Baltazar to his bedd with blysse wat3 caryed,
 Reche þe rest as hym lyst, he ros neuer þer-after;
 For his foes *in* þe felde *in* flokkes ful grete
 1768 þat longe hade layted þat lede his londes to strye,
 Now ar þay sodenly assembled at þe self tyme,

For this sin God has sent thee
 strange sight,

Hat3 sende] MS. *hat3 sende*
sende.

the fist with the fingers writing
 the wall.

These are the words:

“Mene, Tekel, Peres.

[Fol. 8

Mene.— God has counted thy
 kingdom and finished it.

Tekel.— Thy reign is weighed
 and is found wanting in deeds
 faith.

Peres.— Thy kingdom is divid

and given to the Persians.

The Medes shall be masters he

The king commands Daniel to
 clothed in a frock of fine cloth

Soon is he arrayed in purple, v
 a chain about his neck.

coler] MS. *cloler.*

A decree is made, that all shou
 bow to him,

as the third lord that followed
 Belshazzar.

The decree was made known,
 all were glad.

The day, however, past.

Night came on.

Before another day dawned,
 Daniel's words were fulfilled.

The feast lasts till the sun falls

blykned] *blaykned* (?)

The skies become dark.

Each noble hies home to his
 supper.

Belshazzar is carried to bed, b
 never rises from it,

[Fol. 8

for his foes are seeking to dest
 his land, and are assembled

Of hem wylt no wyȝe þat in þat won dowelled.
 Hit watȝ þe dere daryus þe duk of þise medes,
 1772 Þe prowde prynce of perce & porros of ynde,
 With mony a legioun ful large, with ledes of armes,
 þat now hatȝ spyed a space to spoyle caldeeȝ.
 Þay þrongen þeder in þe þester on þrawn hepes,
 1776 Asscaped ouer þe skyre watteres & scaped þe walles,
 Lyfte laddres ful longe & vpon lofte wonen,
 Stelen stylly þe toun er any steuen rysed,
 With-inne an oure of þe nyȝt an entré þay hade;
 1780 Bet a frayd þay no freke, fyrre þay passen,
 & to þe palays pryncipal þay aproched ful styll;
 Þenne ran þay in on a res, on rowtes ful grete,
 Blastes out of bryȝt brasse brestes so hyȝe,
 88 1784 Ascry scarred on þe scue þat scomfyted mony.
 Segges slepande were slayne er þay slyppe myȝt,
 Vche hous heyred watȝ, with-inne a honde-whyle;

ZAR IS BEATEN TO DEATH.

Baltazar in his bed watȝ beten to deþe,
 1788 þat boþe his blod & his brayn blende on þe cloþes;
 The kyng in his cortyn watȝ kaȝt bi þe heles,
 Feryed out bi þe fete & fowle dyspyȝed;
 þat watȝ so doȝty þat day & drank of þe vessayl,
 1792 Now is a dogge al so dere þat in a dyȝh lyȝges;
 For þe mayster of þyse medes on þe morne ryȝes,
 Dere daryous þat day dyȝt vpon trone,
 þat ceté seses ful sounde, & saȝtlyȝ makes
 1796 Wyth alle þe barounȝ þer-about, þat bowed hym after.
 & þus watȝ þat londe lost for þe lordes synne,
 & þe fylþe of þe freke þat defowled hade
 þe orne-mentes of goddeȝ hous þat holy were maked;
 1800 He watȝ corsed for his vn-clannes, & cached þer-inne,
 Done down of his dyȝneté for dedeȝ vnfayre,
 & of þyse worldes worchyp wrast out for euer,
 & ȝet of lykyȝes on lofte letted, I trowe,
 1804 To loke on oure lofly lorde late bitydes.
 þus vpon þryȝne wyses I haf yow þro schewed,
 þat vn-clannes to-cleues in corage dere
 Of þat wynnelyȝ lorde þat wonyes in heuen,
 1808 Entyses hym to be tene, telled vp his wrake;
 Ande clannes is his comfort, & coȝntyȝe he louyes,
 & þose þat seme arȝ & swete schyn se his face.
 þat we gon gay in oure gere þat grace he vus sende,
 1812 þat we may serue in his syȝt, þer solace neuer blyȝneȝ.
 Amen.

NOTES TO CLEANNESS.

The Notes were printed in a group, immediately before the Index. They have been distributed among the three poems for convenience.

suddenly.

The enemy is Darius, leader of Medes.

He has legions of armed men.

Under cover of the darkness, they cross the river.

By means of ladders they get upon the walls,

nyȝt] MS. *myȝt*.

and within an hour enter the city without disturbing any of the watch.

They run into the palace, and make a great cry.

Men are slain in their beds.

Belshazzar is beaten to death,

and caught by the heels, is found cast into a ditch.

Darius is crowned king,

and makes peace with the barons.

Thus the land was lost for the king's sin.

He was cursed for his uncleanness,

and deprived of his honour, as well as of the joys of heaven.

Thus in three ways has it been shown,

that uncleanness

telled] *telles* (?).

makes God angry.

Cleanness is His comfort.

The seemingly shall see his face.

God give us grace to serve in His sight!

Page 37. l. 3 *forering* = *for-bering*. (?)

10 *reken*, reverently, solemnly.

12 *cleche gret mede*, take great reward.

16 & *hym to greme cachen*, and him to wrath drive.

18 *hagherlych*, fitly, decently.

21 *scoymous* & *skyg*, scrupulous and particular; *skyg* implies dread, fear, shyness.

23 *in a carp*, in a discourse.

24 *heuened aȝt happeȝ*, exhibited eight blessings.

25 *me mynez*, I remember.

¹⁰⁹
P. 38. l. 27 *hapenez*, is happy, blessed.

29 *as so saytȝ*, as one says.

32 *May not byde þat burne (? burre) þat hit his body neȝen*,

May not abide (suffer) that man (? blow), that it (? he) should approach his body.

39 *helded*, approached.

41 *toteȝ* = *totȝ* = toes.

49 *worplych*, worshipful (? *worldlych*, worldly).

50 *in her (? herin)*.

52 *here dere*, beloved heir.

54 *comly quoyntis*, comely attire.

56 *with sclazt*, against (for) slaughter.

59 *ropeled*, ready prepared, literally hastened.

62 *skyly*, device, excuse.

P. 39. l. 65 *nayed*, refused; *nurned*, uttered.

71 *a-drez*, aback, aside.

76 *More to wyte is her wrange, þen any wylle gentyl*,

More to blame is their fault, than any forlorn gentile.

Wylle has the significations of wandering, astray; as “*wyl dremes*,” wandering dreams, “*wylle of wone*,” astray from human habitations, having lost one’s way; and hence *wylle* is often used to denote uncertainty, bewilderment.

81 *lapeȝ*, invite.

90 *stȝtled*, established, placed.

91 *þe marchal*, i.e. the marshal of the hall, whose duty it was, at public festivals, to place every person according to his rank and station.

95 *at þi banne*, at thy command.

96 *renischche renkeȝ*, strange men.

97 *layteȝ ȝet ferre*, search yet farther.

P. 40. l. 99 *wayteȝ*, watch.

103 *balterande cruppeleȝ*, limping cripples. *Balter* signifies to jump, skip, hop, etc.

110 *demed*, decreed.

112 *Hit weren not alle on wyueȝ suneȝ, wonen with on fader*,

They were not all one wife’s sons, begotten with one father.

127 *& rehayte rekenly þe riche & þe poueren*,

And cheer, prince-like (nobly), the rich and the poor.

Rehete is the most common form of the word:

“Him would I comferte and *rehete*.” —Rom. Rose, l. 6509.

131 *syled fyrre*, proceeded farther.

132 *Tron fro table to table*, went from table to table. *Tron* is the pret. of the verb *tryne*, to go, walk.

- P. 41. l. 134 *Hit wat3 not*, there was one (who) was not.
 135 *þryzt*, thrust; *unþryuandely*, badly.
 144 *ratted*, rent, torn.
 145 *goun febele*. Cf. *feble wede*, bad or poor clothing. —Havelok the Dane, l. 418.
 149 *brope worde3*, angry (fierce) words.
 150 *Hurkele*, cower, hang. *Hurkele* signifies, literally, to squat, nestle, rest.
 153 *laled*, spoke (quickly).
 164 *ful3ed*, baptised.
 166 *harne lache*, take hurt.
- P. 42. l. 179 *As*, also; *bolnande priyde*, swelling pride.
 180 *Proly in-to þe deuelez þrote man þrynge3 bylyue*,
 Roughly into the devil's throat man is thrust soon.
 181 *colwarde*, deceitful, treacherous. I have not been able to meet with the word *colle* used as noun or verb in any writer of the 14th or 15th century. *Col* occurs, however, as a prefix, in *Col-prophet* (false prophet), *Col-fox* (crafty fox), used by Chaucer; *Col-knyfe* (treacherous knife), which occurs in the "Townley Mysteries."
 200 *hatel of his wyll*, anger of his will.
- P. 43. l. 207 *attled*, endowed.
 215 *met3* = *mess* (?), pity.
 216 *tynt þe tybe dool*, lost the tenth part.
 222 *weued*, cut off. *swap*, blow.
 230 *þe wrech sa3tled*, appeased the vengeance.
 231 *wylnesful*, wilfulness.
 233 *For-þy þa3 þe rape were rank, þe rawþe wat3 lyttel*,
 Wherefore, though the blow were smart, the sorrow was little.
 237 *in obedyent* = *in-obedyent* (?), disobedient.
- ¹¹⁰P. 44. l. 246 *drepe*, destroy (slay).
 257 *forme-foster* should be *forme-fostere3*, being in apposition with *auncetere3*.
 261 For *lede* read *lede3* (?).
 270 *dezter of þe douþe*, the daughters of the mighty (doughty) ones.
 271 *on folken wyse*, after the manner of men.
- P. 45. l. 273 *meþele3*, immoderate, intemperate.
 274 *alosed*, (? noted).
 298 *þryuen*, grown up, adult.
 306 *nwyed* = annoyed, *i.e.* displeased.
- P. 46. l. 320 *dutande*, shutting.
 321 *halke3*, recesses.
 331 *þis meyny of a3te*, this company (household) of eight.
 335 *horwed*, unclean.
- P. 47. l. 350 *with-ouen þrep*, without contradiction, gainsaying.
 354 *a rowtande ryge*, a rattling shower.
 359 *styste3* = *stynte3* stops, ceases.
 362 & *alle woned in þe whichche*, and all abode in the ark. *Whichche* is another (and genuine) form of *hutch*.
 364 *Waltes out vch walle-heued, in ful wode streme3*,
 Bursts out each well-head (spring, fountain) in full wild streams.

365 *brymme*, stream.

366 *þe mukel lauande loghe*, the great flowing deep.

369 *fon*, ceased.

373 *moon*, moan, sorrow.

374 *dowed*, availed.

375 *wylger*, wilder, fiercer.

376 *dowelled* = *dwelled*.

377 *feng to þe flyzt*, took to flight.

378 *Vuche burde with her barne*, each woman with her child (bairn).

P. 48. 1. 379 *bowed*, hastened; *brentest*, highest, steepest.

380 *heterly*, quickly, (hotly); *haled*, rushed.

381 *Bot al wat3 nedlez her note*, but their device was altogether in vain.

382 *þe roze raynande ryg*, the rough raining shower; *raykande wawe3*, flowing waves.

383 *bopom*, a bottom or valley.

384 *demmed*, collected, accumulated.

391 *þe hy3e*, the heights, high grounds.

392 *bausene3*, badgers.

394 *re-coverer*, succour, refuge.

395 *þat amounted*, etc., read *þat amounted þe mase*, etc., that the astonishment increased. (Professor Child).

397 *Bi þat*, by that time. This phrase is still preserved in the North of England.

399 *Frende3, fellen in fere, faþmed to-geder*.

Friends, fallen in company, *embraced* (fathomed) together.

The verb *faþme* in Early English also signifies to *grope*.

400 *dry3*, suffer; *delful*, doleful.

404 *freten*, devoured; *waze3*, waves.

406 *hukled*, rested. This word is still preserved in the local dialects of the North of England, with the sense of "to cower," "squat."

407 *mourkne*, rotten.

409 *here*, company.

411 *a3t-sum*, in care, sorrowful.

413 *hurlande gote3*, rushing streams.

414 *kythe3 vncouþe*, unknown regions.

P. 49. 1. 421 *flyt*, current, flitting.

424 *lumpen*, the passive participle of *lympen*, to befall, happen.

430 *yre3* is evidently an error for *yþe3*, waves.

433 *Rac*, moving clouds, mists. Still in provincial use.

436 *meth*, pity, mercy.

438 *lasned*, lessened, became smaller.

439 *stac vp þe stange3*, closed up the pools. *Stang* = *stanc*, *stank*, a word still used in the North of England.

441 *lo3* = *logh*, deep.

443 *lome* = *loom*, i.e., the ark.

446 *rasse* = the provincial *raise*, a mound.

449 *kyste* = chest (ark); *wern* = *were* (?).

P. 50. 1. 451 *egge3*, edges, banks, hills; *vnhuled*, uncovered.

452 *bynne*, within. Cf. *boute*, without.

- 461 *smach* smack, scent; *smoltes* (? *smolte*, i.e. smelt).
 463 *zederly*, quickly, soon; *steuen*, command, literally voice.
 466 *fodez*, persons; *ellez*, provided that.
 469 *doune* = *dovene*, a female dove (see line 481).
 476 *dreȝly*, drearily, sorrowfully.
 480 *naytly*, dexterously (neatly).
 482 *borne* = *burne*, stream.
 483 *skwe*, sky, cloud; *skowteȝ*, looks.
- III
 P. 51. l. 485 *downe* = *dovene* (see ll. 469, 481).
 487 *What!* lo!
 490 *saztlyng*, reconciliation.
 496 *woned* = *waned*, decreased, gone down.
 498 *tyned*, enclosed.
 499 *godeȝ glam*, God's message (word); *glod*, came, literally glided.
 501 *walt wafte* (?) (see B. l. 857).
 504 *proly prublande in þronge*, quickly pressing in throng (crowd), i.e., huddling together.
 509 *breȝe*, steam, savour.
 511 *spedeȝ & spylleȝ*, prospers (speeds) and spoils.
 517 *barnage*, childhood.
- P. 52. l. 525 *sadde*, sharp, bitter.
 529 *þen watȝ a skyllȝ skyualde*, then was a design (purpose) manifested (ordered).
 531 *nayte*, use, employ.
 533 *wryȝeȝ*, crawl, creep.
 534 *folmarde*, polecat.
 536 *lake ryftes*, fissures of the lake.
 537 *Herneȝ* = *erneȝ*, eagles.
 539 *at a brayde*, in a moment.
- P. 53. l. 558 *merked*, ordained.
 561 *raȝt*, extended to, gave.
 566 *syt*, fault.
 567 *quykeȝ*, living (things); *qued*, wickedness.
 573 *vnhappen glette*, unfortunate filth, unhappy sin.
 579 *heȝyng of seluen*, contempt of [God's] self.
 583 *steppe yȝe*, bright eye; *steppe* = *stepe* is often explained by steep, deep set; but we often meet with such phrases as "*stepe* stones," bright stones, "*stepe* starres," bright stars.
 586 *losed þe listen*, lost the hearing; *lysten*, in O.E. has frequently the meaning of *to hear*.
 587 *trave* = *trawe*, trow, believe.
 588 *þer is no dede so derne þat ditteȝ his yȝen*.
 There is no deed so secret that closes His eyes (i.e. that He does not see).
- P. 54. l. 591 *gropande*, searching, examining.
 592 *Rypande of vche a ring þe reynȝeȝ & hert*
 Trying (probing) the reins and heart of every man.
Rype is still used in the North of England in the sense of to plunder. Cf. our modern use of the word *ransack* with its earlier meanings of to try, probe, search.
 596 *honyȝeȝ*, disgraces, ruins, destroys.
 598 *scarreȝ*, literally *scares*, is frightened, startled.

599 *to drawe allyt* = *to draw a lyte* = to draw back a little.

603 *blykked*, shone, glared.

605 *schunt*, aside, from *schunt*, to slip away, retreat.

P. 55. 1. 623 *orppedly*, quickly, hastily.

626 *happe*, cover, still in use in the north provincial dialects.

627 *som quat fat*, some sort of a vessel; *þe fyr bete*, make up the fire; *bete* signifies, literally, to mend.

632 *deruely* = *derfely*, quickly.

635 *þerue kakeȝ* = *therfe* or *tharfe* cakes, *i.e.*, cakes made without leaven.

646 *mensk*, thanks.

648 *leþe*, cease.

652 *ȝark*, select, chosen.

653 *for busmar*, in scorn.

654 *sothly* = truly (? *sotly*, foolishly or *softly*).

Numbered 655 and printed after following note. The word "sothely" also occurs in 657, but the text note ("sotly...") refers to 654.

655 *May þou traw for tykel þat þou tonne moȝteȝ,*

Mayst thou trow (believe) for the uncertainty (of such a thing) that thou mightest conceive;
for tykel, on account of the uncertainty.

P. 56. 1. 659 *byene* = *ben*, been or *bycame*. The sense would require *hade* before *byene*, if *byene* = *ben*.

668 *Þat for lot þat þay lansed ho laȝed neuer,*

That for (any) sound that they uttered, she never laughed;
lot = late, in the sense of *sound*, is not very common in Old English authors.

670 *a-loȝ* = lowly, softly.

686 *blod*, child.

687 *bos*, behoves.

688 *atlyng*, intention, purpose; *vn-haspe*, disclose.

¹¹²P. 57. 1. 696 *fylter*, join.

698 *amed*, placed; *oddely dere*, singularly dear. *Oddely* occurs in some northern works with the sense of illustriously, nobly.

699 *drwry*, love; *doole alþer-swettest*, the sweetest of all gifts; gift the sweetest of all.

703 *conne* is probably an error for *come*, but it may signify, be kindled, produced, begotten.

706 *stollen*, stealthy, secret.

711 *smod* = the Scotch *smot*, *smad*, stain, filth.

719 *þe worre half*, the weaker portion, literally, the worse half.

723 *laue*, law.

P. 58. 1. 732 *smolt*, be at peace.

740 *for hortying*, for hurting = for fear of hurting. This sense of *for* is very common in writers of the 16th and 17th centuries.

743 *fryst*, delay, put off.

747 *vsle*, ashes, cinders.

752 *leþe*, destroy.

754 *I schal my þro steke*, I shall moderate (literally, shut up) my anger.

756 *reken*, wise.

P. 59. 1. 764 *mese þy mode*, temper thy wrath.

778 *mere*, boundary, *meer*.

784 *lened* = leaned, reclined; but we may read *leued* = *beleued*, remained.

P. 60. 1. 796 *vnder-zede* = *vnder-zete*, understood.

801 *knauez kote*, servant's house. It looks at first sight like *kuchiez kote*.

802 *fatte* = *vat*, vessel.

803 *norne* = *nurne*, request.

810 *gruzt*, gruched = begrudged.

813 *coupe*, knew.

814 *haylsed*, saluted.

824 *boute*, without.

830 *of glam debonere*, of pleasant, courteous conversation.

831 *wela-wynnely*, very joyfully.

P. 61. 1. 832 *woze* = *wowe*, wall.

835 *wakker* comp. *wayk*, weak.

836 *vmbe-lyze*, surround.

838 *scowte-wach*, sentinel; *asscry*, cry, shout, noise.

846 *zezed* = chattered, gaggled; *zestande sorze*, afflicting (or frothing) sorrow.

848 *brych* = what is low, vile, filthy (? *bryth*, breath); *vpbraydez*, raises.

849 *glyfte with þat glam*, was frightened at that speech.

855 *wonded no woþe*, avoided no danger (hurt).

859 *meled*, spoke.

860 *hendelayk*, courtesy, civility.

P. 62. 1. 871 *tayt* = lively.

874 *azly* = *awly*, fearfully.

876 *out-comlyng*, a stranger. In this form it is still known in the North of England. *Comlyng* is the more usual form of the word in our early literature; *carle* = *churl*.

881 *zornen*, ran.

882 *wapped*, beat.

885 *in blande* = together (?); *banned*, cursed.

888 *nyteled*, laboured, toiled.

889 *of tayt*, from fear. *Teyt*, fear, alarm, occurs in the northern romance of Alexander.

890 *ropeled*, hastened.

892 *vglokest vnhap*, the most dreadful misfortune.

893 *Ruddon of þe day-rawe ros vpon vzten.*

The light of the day-break rose on the morn.

894 *merk*, darkness.

895 *ruþen*, rouse.

901 *cayre tid of þis kythe*, depart quickly from this land.

P. 63. 1. 905 *stemme no stepe*, stop (keep back), no step. Cf. our modern phrase “*stem* the tide.”

909 *losen*, destroy.

911 *gorde*, rush.

912 *clater*, shatter.

915 *kynned*, kindled.

916 *þe brath of his breth*, the fierceness of his wrath.

918 *foo-schip*, enmity.

921 *walle* = *wale*, choose; *wonnyng*, dwelling, abode.

927 *vtter*, without.

928 *wore* = *ware* = *were*. Cf. *thore* = *thare* = *there*.

931 *agayn-tote*, looking back; *tote* (toot) occurs frequently with the sense of “to peep,” “look,” in Early English.

P. 64. 1. 944 *Loke 3e bowe now bi bot*, Look ye go now by (according to) command.

947 *greme*, wrath.

948 *wakan*, arouse, stir up.

950 *flytande*, chiding, murmuring.

955 *smachande*, savouring, smelling.

964 *riftes*, fissures.

113

965 *cloutes*, pieces.

969 *Rydelles* = *redeless* = without counsel, helpless; *rowtes*, companies.

971 *Such a 3omerly 3arm of 3ellyng þer rysed,*
 Such a mournful (pitiful) outcry of yelling there rose.

P. 65. 1. 976 *Trynande ay a hy3e trot*, going ever (at) a great pace.

987 *louez*, not *loaves*, but = the provincial *looves* = hands.

989 *damppe* = *dumped*, beaten down.

991 *malscrande mere*, accursed lake.

992 *on a lawe*, on a hill.

1000 & *alle lyste on hir lik* (i.e. *lick*) *þat arn on launde bestes*.

“Als so sco loked hir behind,
 A stan sco standes bi þat way
 And sua sal do to domesday;
 In a salt stan men seis hir stand
 Þat best likes o þat land;
 Þat anes o þe wok day,
 Þan is sco liked al away
 And þan þai find hir on þe morn,
 Hale als sco was ar befor.”

(Cott. MS. Vesp. A. iii. fol. 17b.)

1002 *niye*, anguish.

P. 66. 1. 1009 *a robun of a reche*, a rush of smoke, a mass of vapour; *blake*, the black (pit).

1011 *flot*, fat, grease.

1016 *drouy*, turbid, from *droue*, to trouble.

1024 *costez of kynde* = natural properties.

1030 *bopem broþely*, filthy pit.

1031 *losyng*, perdition.

1033 *coostez* = properties.

1035 *alkaran*, Mandeville employs the term *alkatran*; *angré* = poisonous or grievous, or *augre* = *aigre*, sharp.

1036 *saundyuer* = *sandiver*, glass-gall.

1037 *waxlokes*, waves.

1038 *spuniande*, cleaving, sticky.

1039 *se halues*, sea coasts.

1041 *terne* = *tarne*, lake.

1044 *apple garnade* = pomegranate.

P. 67. 1. 1072 *kynned*, conceived.

- 1076 *a schepon* = a stable.
- P. 68. 1. 1079 *reflayr*, smell, odour; *rote*, decay.
 1082 *þe reken fypel*, the merry fiddle.
 1094 *lomerande blynde*, the hesitating (slow, creeping), blind. The primitive meaning of *lomerande* seems to be that of *slow*, sluggish.
 1108 *tyzt*, endeavour.
- P. 69. 1. 1113 *fenny*, dirty, filthy, and hence sinful.
 1118 *to dele*, to exchange.
 1123 For “& *wax euer*,” etc., the sense seems to require that we should read “& *wax ho euer*,” etc.
 1124 *in pyese* = whole.
 1126 *blyndes of ble*, becomes dull of hue, loses its colour.
 1127 *No-bot*, only.
 1141 *lastes*, vices.
 1142 *þewes* = *þeues* (?), thieves, or *unþewes*, vices (?)
- P. 70. 1. 1153 *tyzt me a tom* = give me an opportunity; *tom* has the sense of *leisure* and not of *time*.
 1167 *fylsened*, helped, aided.
 1172 *lat*, late, slow.
 1178 *þorpes*, cities.
- P. 71. 1. 1186 *skete skarmoch*, *skelt*, brisk skirmish, hastened (came on quickly).
 1190 *brutage* = *bretage*, parapets of a wall.
 1202 *blench*, stratagem.
 1205 *at-wappe*, escape.
 1206 *skelt*, spread.
 1208 *ruped*, roused.
 1209 *hard hattes*, (?) hats made of tow; *herd*, *hard* (*harden*, *hards*), in O. English signify cloth made of tow.
- P. 72. 1. 1219 *faynest*, gladdest.
 1224 *dreze þer his wyrdes*, endure there his destiny.
 1246 *to þe bronde*, to the sword.
- P. 73. 1. 1254 *on capeles*, on horses.
 1255 *fole wombess*, bellies of foals.
- 114 1259 *to cayre at þe kart & þe kuy mylke*, to drag at the cart and milk the cows.
 1265 *plat of*, strike off.
 1284 *hamppred* = *hampered*, packed up for removal.
- P. 74. 1. 1290 *hyztled*, ornamented.
 1303 *modey* = *moody*, proud.
 1313 *sesed*, took possession of.
- P. 75. 1. 1327 *bi-cnv* = *bicneu*, acknowledged.
 1330 *heldes*, descends.
 1332 *grauen*, buried.
 1334 *stalled in his stud*, placed in his stead (position).
 1342 *tre*, wood; *telded*, raised.
 1344 *gered*, covered, decked.
 1346 *reden*, advise.
 1354 *notyng*, devising, contriving; *gettes*, devices.

- P. 76. l. 1358 *avayment*, exhibition.
 1361 *banne*, proclamation.
 1362 *callyng*, decree.
 1366 *vche a kythyn kyng*, every king of countries.
 1375 *ludisch lordes*, lords of nations.
 1379 *plek*, spot (plot of ground).
- P. 77. l. 1396 *Stepe stayred [þe] stones of his stoute throne*,
 Bright shone the stones of his firm throne.
 1397 *hiled* = covered.
 1398 *bounet*, went about.
 1402 *strake steuen* = struck up sound.
 1403 *wrasten krakkes*, sounds (notes) are raised.
 1410 *foles*, fowls, birds. *flakerande*, flickering, fluttering.
 1412 *on blonkken bak*, on the back of horses. In lines 1407-1412 we have evidently an allusion to the "table subtilties" of the fourteenth century.
 1420 *wezed*, served.
 1425 *dotage*, folly.
- P. 78. l. 1435 *schin*, shall.
 1446 *besten blod*, blood of beasts; *busily*, laboriously.
 1462 *fylyoles*, round towers.
- P. 79. l. 1472 Penitotes. So in MS., but read *Peritotes*.
 1478 *cost*, contrivance.
 1495 *iaueles* = worthless wretches, used by Hall and Spenser.
- P. 80. l. 1501 *wlates*, is disgusted.
 1504 *wayned*, granted.
 1505 *glotoun*, a general term of reproach.
 1507 *vus* = *use*, drink.
 1510 *kyppe*, take, seize, catch up.
 1511 *birlen*, pour out.
 1517 *dotel*, fool.
 1520 as each one was disposed so tossed he off the cup.
- P. 81. l. 1537 *neue*, fist.
 1542 *lers*, features, but (?) *fers*, fears.
 1543 *as a rad ryth*, as a frightened hound (literally mastiff).
 1545 *runisch sauez*, strange words.
 1554 *skelten*, hasten.
 1557 *þo dražtes*, the characters.
 1559 *ede* = went, but *bede*, bade, commanded.
 1560 *warlažes*, wizards.
 1566 *malt*, to soothe.
 1568 *gered*, clothed.
- P. 82. l. 1585 *he wed wel ner*, he became nearly mad.
 1603 *in stoundes*, at times.
- P. 83. l. 1606 *spured*, asked, enquired of.
 1634 *tede* = *tene*, ten (?)

- 1637 *apyke*, adorn, clothe.
- P. 84. l. 1650 *lozed*, made low.
 1654 *pouer*, power.
 1674 *wasterne*, wilderness; *dowelle*, dwelle.
 1675 *braken*, fern.
- P. 85. l. 1678 *soly*, seat.
 1684 *ay* (?) = hay.
 1686 *ouer-seyed*, passed over.
 1690 *wykes*, members.
 1692 *clyde*, plaister (?).
 1694 *bresed*, rough, bristly; Sir F. Madden interprets it *broken*.
 1695 *campe hores*, shaggy hairs.
 1696 *glede*, kite.
 1701 *wayned*, recovered.
 1707 *hazerly*, properly.
- P. 86. l. 1713 *auyled*, defiled.
 1716 *wale wyne*, choice wine; *in waryed stoundes*, in accursed moments.
- P. 87. l. 1755 *dazed*, dawned.
 1759 *blykned* = *blaykned*, became dark, blackened.
 1760 *Mourkenes*, becomes murky.
 1761 *lyst*, path.
 1768 *layted*, sought.
 1773 *ledes of armes*, men of arms.
 1775 *pester*, darkness.
- ¹¹⁵P. 88. l. 1785 *slyppe*, escape.
 1786 *honde-whyle*, a moment.
 1788 *blende*, mingled.
 1792 *now is a dogge also dere*, now is as valuable as a dog.
 1808 *telled* = raised (?) *telles* = raises.
 1811 *gere*, clothing.

PATIENCE.

I.

Pacience is a poynt, þaȝ hit displese ofte,
 When heuy herttes ben hurt wyth hepyng oþer elles,
 Suffraunce may aswagen hem & þe swelme leþe,
 4 For ho quelles vche a qued, & quenches malyce;
 For quo-so suffer cowþe syt, sele wolde folȝe,
 & quo for þro may noȝt þole, þe þikker he sufferes;

[Fol. 8]

Patience is often displeasing,
aswagen] MS. *aswagend*.
 but it assuages heavy hearts, a
 quenches malice.
 Happiness follows sorrow.

- Pen is better to abyde þe bur vmbe-stoundes,
 8 þen ay þrow forth my þro, þaʒ me þynk ylle.
 I herde on a halyday at a hyʒe masse,
 How mathew melede, þat his mayster his meyny con teche,
Aʒt happes he hem hyʒt & vche on a mede,
 12 Sunderlupes for hit dissert vpon a ser wyse:
 Thay ar happen þat han in hert pouerté,
 For hores is þe heuen-ryche to holde for euer;
 Þay ar happen also þat haunte mekenesse,
 16 For þay schal welde þis worlde & alle her wylle haue;
 Thay ar happen also þat for her harme wepes,
 For þay schal comfort encroche in kythes ful mony;
 Þay ar happen also þat hungeres after ryʒt,
 20 For þay schal frely be refete ful of alle gode;
 Thay ar happen also þat han in hert rauþe,
 For mercy in alle maneres her mede schal worþe;
 Þay ar happen also þat arn of hert clene,
 24 For þay her sauour in sete schal se with her yʒen;
 90 Thay ar happen also þat halden her pese,
 For þay þe *gracious* godes sunes schal godly be called;
 Þay ar happen also þat con her hert stere,
 28 For hores is þe heuen-ryche, as I er sayde.
 These arn þe happes alle aʒt þat *vus* bihyʒt weren,
 If we þyse ladyes wolde lof in *lyknyng* of þewes;
 Dame pouert, Dame pitee, Dame penaunce þe þrydde,
 32 Dame Mekenesse, Dame mercy & Miry clannesse,
 & þenne Dame pes & pacyence put in þer-after.
 He were happen þat hade one, alle were þe better,
 Bot *syn* I am put to a poynt þat pouerte hatte,
 36 I schal me poruay pacyence, & play me with boþe;
 For in þe tyxte, þere þyse two arn in teme layde,
 Hit arn fettled in on forme, þe forme & þe laste,
 & by quest of her quoyntyse enquylen on mede,
 40 & als in myn vpynyoun hit arn of on kynde;
 For þer as pouert hir proferes ho nyl be put vtter,
 Bot lenge where-so-euer hir lyst, *lyke oþer greme*,
 & þere as pouert enpresses, þaʒ mon pyne þynk,
 44 Much maugre his *mun*, he mot nede suffer,
 Thus pouerte & pacyence arn nedes play-feres.
 Syþen I am sette with hem samen, suffer me by-houes,
 Þenne is me *lyʒtloker* hit lyke & her *lot*es prayse,
 48 Þenne wyþer wyth & be wroth & þe wers haue.
 ʒif me be dyʒt a destyné due to haue,
 What dowes me þe dedayn, oþer dispit make?
 Oþer ʒif my lege lorde lyst on lyue me to bidde,
 52 Oþer to ryde, oþer to reme, to rome in his ernde,
 What *grayþed* me þe grychchyng bot grame more seche?
 Much ʒif he me ne made, maugref my chekes,
 & þenne þrat moste I þole, & vnþonk to mede,
 56 Þe[t] had bowed to his bode, bongre my hyure.
 Did not Ionas in Iude suche lape sum-whyle,
 To sette hym to sewrte, vnsounde he hym feches?
 Wyl ʒe tary a lyttel *tyme* & tent me a whyle,
 60 I schal wysse yow þer-wyth as holy wryt telles.

It is better to suffer than to be angry.

Matthew tells us of the promis made by Christ: Blessed are th poor, for theirs is the kingdom heaven.

Blessed are the meek, for they shall "wield the world."

Blessed are the mourners, for t shall be comforted.

Blessed are the hungry, for the shall be filled.

Blessed are the merciful, for mercy shall be their reward.

Blessed are the clean of heart, they shall see the Saviour.

Blessed are the peace-makers, they shall be called God's son:

Blessed are they that live aright for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

These blessings are promised t those who follow

[Fol. 8

poverty, pity, penance, meekne mercy, chastity, peace and patience,

syn] MS. *fyn*.

Poverty and patience are to be treated together.

They are "fettled in one form," and have one meed.

Poverty will dwell where she l

mun] *mon* (?).

and man must needs suffer.

Poverty and patience are play-fellows.

What avails impatience,

if God send affliction?

Patience is best.

Did not Jonah incur danger by folly?

tyme] MS. *tyne*.

II.

Hit bi-tydde *sum-tyme in þe termes of Iude*,
 Ionas ioyned wat3 *þer-inne ientyle prophete*;
 Goddes glam to *hym glod*, þat *hym vnglad made*,
 64 *With a roghlych rurd rowned in his ere*;
 “Rys radly,” he says, “& rayke forth euen,
 Nym þe way to nynyue, *wyth-outen oþer speche*,
 & in þat cete *my sazes soghe alle aboute*,
 68 þat, in þat place at þe poynt, I put in þi hert;
 For Iwysse hit arn so wykke þat in þat won dowelle3,
 & her malys is so much I may not abide,
 Bot venge me on her vilanye & venym bilyue;
 72 Now swe3e me þider swyftly & say me þis arende.”
 When þat steuen wat3 stynt, þat stowned his mynde,
 Al he wrathed in his wyt & wyþerly he þo3t,
 If I bowe to his bode & bryng hem þis tale,
 76 & I be Nummen in Nunieue, my nyes begynes;
 He telles me þose traytours arn *typped schrewes*,
 I com wyth þose tyþynges, þay ta me bylyue,
 Pyne3 me in a prysoun, put me in stokkes,
 80 Wryþe me in a warlok, wrast out myn y3en.
 Þis is a meruayl message a man for to preche,
 Amonge enmyes so mony & *mansed fendes*;
 Bot if my gaynlych god such gref to me wolde,
 84 For desert of *sum sake* þat I slayn were,
 At alle peryles, *quod þe prophete*, I aproche hit no nerre,
 I wyl me *sum oþer waye*, þat he ne wayte after;
 I schal tee in-to tarce, & tary þere a whyle,
 88 & ly3tly, when I am lest, he letes me alone.
 Þenne he rysses radly, & raykes bilyue
 Ionas toward port Iaph, ay Ianglande for tene,
 Þat he nolde þole, for no-þyng, non of þose pynes,
 92 Þa3 þe fader þat *hym formed* were fale of his hele.
 “Oure syre syttes,” he says, “on sege so hy3e
 In his g[l]wande glorie, & *gloumbes* ful lyttel,

Jonah was a prophet of the
 gentiles.
 God’s word came to him, sayi

“Rise quickly, take the way to
 Nineveh.

[Fol. 8

Say that which I shall put in th
 heart.

Wickedness dwells in that city

Go swiftly and carry my
 message.”

Jonah is full of wrath.

He is afraid that the shrews

will put him in the stocks,
 or put out his eyes.

He thinks that God desires his
 death.

For] MS. fof.

He determines not to go near t
 city,

but fly to Tarshish.

Grumbling, he goes to port Jo

He says that God will not be a
 to protect him.

92

FOR TARSHISH.

Þa3 I be nummen in nunieue & naked dispoyled,
 96 On rode rwly to-rent, *with rybaudes mony*.”
 Þus he passes to þat port, his passage to seche,
 Fyndes he a fayr schyp to þe fare redy;
 Maches hym *with þe maryneres*, makes her paye,
 100 For to towe hym in-to tarce, as tyd as þay my3t.
 Then he tron on þo tres & þay her *tramme* ruchen,
 Cachen vp þe crossayl, cables þay fasten,
 Wi3t at þe wyndlas we3en her ankres,
 104 Sprude spak to þe sprete þe spare bawe-lyne,
 Gederen to þe gyde ropes, þe grete cloþ falles;
 Þay layden in on *ladde-borde* & þe lofe wymes.
 Þe blyþe breþe at her bak þe bosum he fyndes,
 108 He swenges me þys swete schip swefte fro þe hauen.
 Wat3 neuer so loyful a Iue, as Ionas wat3 þenne,
 Þat þe daunger of dry3tyn so derfly ascaped;
 He wende wel þat þat wy3 þat al þe world planted,

Jonah reaches the port, finds a
 ship ready to sail.

The seamen catch up the cross
 sail, fasten the cables, weigh tl
 anchors,

[Fol. 8

and spread sail.

A gentle wind wafts the ship
 along.

Was never a Jew so joyful as v
 Jonah then.

- 112 Hade no maȝt in þat mere no man forto greue.
 Lo! þe wyteles wrechche, for he wolde noȝt suffer,
 Now hatȝ he put hym in plyt of peril wel more;
 Hit watȝ a wenyng vn-war þat welt in his mynde,
 116 þaȝ he were soȝt fro samarye þat god seȝ no fyrre,
 Ȝise he blusched ful brode, þat burde hym by sure,
 þat ofte kyd hym þe carpe þat kyng sayde,
 Dyngne dauid on des, þat demed þis speche,
 120 In a psalme þat he set þe sauter *with-inne*;
 O Foleȝ in folk feleȝ oþer whyle,
 & vnderstondes vmbe-stounde, þaȝ he be stape fole,
 Hope ȝe þat he heres not þat eres alle made?
 124 Hit may not be þat he is blynde þat bigged vche yȝe.
 Bot he dredes no dynt þat dotes for elde,
 For he watȝ fer in þe flod foundande to tarce;
 Bot, I trow, ful tyd, ouer-tan þat he were,
 128 So þat schomely to schort he schote of his ame.
 For þe welder of wyt, þat wot alle þynges,
 þat ay wakes & waytes, at wylle hatȝ he slyȝtes;

He has, however, put himself i
 peril,

in fleeing from God.

The words of David.

Does He not hear, who made a
 ears?

He is not blind that formed eac
 eye.

Jonah is now in no dread.

He is, however, soon overtake.

The wielder of all things has
 devices at will.

93

ERTAKEN BY A TEMPEST.

- He calde on þat ilk crafte he carf *with* his hondes,
 132 þay wakened wel þe wroþeloker, for wroþely he cleped:
 “Ewrus & aquiloun, þat on est sittes,
 Blowes boþe at my bode vpon blo watteres.”
 þenne watȝ no tom þer bytwene his tale & her dede,
 136 So bayn wer þay boþe two, his bone for to wyrk.
 An-on out of þe norþ est þe noys bigynes,
 When boþe breþes con blowe vpon blo watteres;
 Roȝ rakkes þer ros *with* rudnyng an-vnder,
 140 þe see souȝed ful sore, gret selly to here;
 þe wyndes on þe wonne water so wrastel to-geder,
 þat þe wawes ful wode waltered so hiȝe,
 & efte busched to þe abyme þat breed fysches;
 144 Durst nowhere for roȝ arest at þe bothem.
 When þe breth & þe brok & þe bote metten,
 Hit watȝ a ioyles gyn þat Ionas watȝ inne,
 For hit reled on roun[d] vpon þe roȝe yþes.
 148 þe bur ber to hit baft þat braste alle her gere,
 þen hurled on a hepe þe helme & þe sterne,
 Furst to murte mony rop & þe mast after.
 þe sayl sweyed on þe see, þenne suppe bihoued
 152 þe coge of þe colde water, & þenne þe cry ryses;
 Ȝet coruen þay þe cordes & kest al þer-oute.
 Mony ladde þer forth-lep to laue & to kest,
 Scopen out þe scapel water, þat fayn scape wolde;
 156 For be monnes lode neuer so luþer, þe lyf is ay swete.
 þer watȝ busy ouer-borde bale to kest
 Her bagges, & her feþer beddes, & her bryȝt wedes,
 Her kysttes, & her coferes, her caraldes alle,
 160 & al to lyȝten þat lome, ȝif leþe wolde schape;
 Bot euer watȝ ilyche loud þe lot of þe wyndes,
 & euer wroþer þe water, & wodder þe stremes.
 þen þo wery for-wroȝt wyst no bote,
 164 Bot vchon glewed on his god þat gayned hym beste;

He commands Eurus and Aqu
 to blow.

The winds blow obedient to H
 word.

Out of the north-east the noise
 begins.

[Fol. 8

Storms arose,
 winds wrestled together, the
 waves rolled high,

and never rested.

Then was Jonah joyless.

The boat reeled around.

The gear became out of order.

Ropes and mast were broken.

colde] MS. *clolde*.

A loud cry is raised, Many a la
 labours to lighten the ship.

lode] *lote* (?)

They throw overboard their ba
 and feather beds.

But still the wind rages, and th
 waves become wilder.

Each man calls upon his god.

Some called upon Vernagu,
Diana, and Neptune, to the sur
and to the moon.

Summe to vernagu þer vouched a-vowes solemne,
Summe to diana deuout, & derf nepturne,
94 To mahoun & to mergot, þe mone & þe sunne,
168 & vche lede as he loued & layde had his hert.

CONDEMNED TO DEATH,

þenne bispeke þe spakest dispayred wel nere:
I leue here be *sum* losynger, *sum* lawles wrech,
þat hat3 greued his god & got3 here amonge *vus*;
172 Lo al synkes *in* his synne & for his sake marres!
I *lovne* þat we lay lotes on ledes vchone,
& who-so lympeþ þe losse, lay hym þer-oute;
& quen þe gulty is gon what may gome trawe,
176 Bot he þat rules þe rak may rwe on þose oþer?
þis wat3 sette *in* asent, & sembled þay were,
Her3ed out of vche hyrne to hent þat falles.
A lodes-mon ly3tly lep vnder hachches,
180 For to layte mo ledes & hem to lote bryng,
Bot hym fayled no freke þat he fynde my3t,
Saf Ionas þe Iwe þat Iowked *in* derne.
He wat3 flowen for ferde of þe flode lotes
184 *In*-to þe boþem of þe bot, & on a *brede* lyggede,
On helde by þe *hurrok*, for þe heuen wrache,
Slypped vpon a sloumbe, selepe, & sloberande he routes.
þe freke hym frunt *with* his fot & bede hym ferk vp,
188 þer ragnel *in* his rakentes hym rere of his dremes;
Bi þe haspede he hentes hym þenne,
& bro3t hym vp by þe brest & vpon borde sette,
Arayned hym ful *runyschly* what raysoun he hade
192 *In* such *slaztes* of sor3e to slepe so faste;
Sone haf þay her sortes sette & serelych deled,
& ay þe lote, vpon laste, lympeþ on Ionas.
þenne ascryed þay hym sckete, & asked ful loude,
196 “What þe deuel hat3 þou don, doted wrech?
What seches þou on see, synful schrewe,
With þy *lastes* so luper to lose *vus* vchone?
Hat3 þou, gome, no *gouernour* ne god on to calle,
200 þat þou þus slydes on slepe when þou slayn worþes?
Of what londe art þou lent, what laytes þou here
Whyder *in* worlde þat þou wylt, & what is þyn arnde?
95 Lo þy dom is þe dy3t, for þy dedes ille!
204 Do gyf glory to þy godde, er þou glyde hens.”
“I am an Ebru,” *quod* he, “of Israyl borne;
þat wy3e I worchyp, Iwysse, þat wro3t alle þynges,
Alle þe worlde *with* þe welkyn, þe wynde & þe sternes,
208 & alle þat wone3 þer *with-inne*, at a worde one.
Alle þis meschef for me is made at þys tyme,
For I haf greued my god & gulty am founden;
For-þy bere3 me to þe borde, & *bapeþes* me þer-oute,
212 Er gete 3e no happe, I hope forsoþe.”

AST OVERBOARD.

He ossed hym by *vnnynge*s þat þay vnder-nomen,
þat he wat3 flawen fro þe face of frelych dry3tyn;
þenne such a ferde on hem fel & flayed hem *with-inne*,

Then said one of the sailors:
“Some lawless wretch, that ha
grieved his God, is in the ship.

I advise that we lay lots upon
man.

[Fol. 8

When the guilty is gone the
tempest may cease.”

This is agreed to.

All are assembled, from all
corners of the ship,

save Jonah the Jew,
who had fled into the bottom c
the boat.

There he falls asleep.

Soon he is aroused,

and brought on board.

Full roughly is he questioned.

The lot falls upon Jonah.

þe] MS. *þe þe*.

Then quickly they said:
“What the devil hast thou done
doted wretch?

What seekest thou on the sea?

Hast thou no God to call upon?

Of what land art thou?

Thou art doomed for thy ill
deeds.”

Jonah says: “I am a Hebrew,
a worshipper of the world’s
Creator.

All this mischief is caused by
therefore cast me overboard.”

[Fol. 8

bapeþes] *bapes* (?).

hym] *hem* (?).

- 216 Þat þay ruyt hym to rowwe & letten þe rynk one.
 Hapeles hyzed *in* haste *with* ores ful longe,
 Syn her sayl wat3 hem aslypped on syde3 to rowe;
 Hef & hale vpon hyzt to helpen hym seluen,
 220 Bot al wat3 nedles note, þat nolde not bityde:
 In bluber of þe blo flod bursten her ores,
 Þenne hade þay no3t *in* her honde þat hem help myzt;
 Þenne nas no coumfort to keuer, ne counsel non oþer,
 224 Bot ionas *in*-to his Iuis Iugge bylyue.
 Fyrst þay prayen to þe prynce þat prophetes seruen,
 Þat he gef hem þe *grace* to greuen hym neuer,
 Þat þay *in* balele3 blod þer blenden her hande3,
 228 Þa3 þat habel wer his, þat þay here quelled.
 Tyd by top & bi to þay token hym synne,
 In-to þat lodlych lo3e þay luche hym sone;
 He wat3 no tytter out-tulde þat tempest ne sessed,
 232 Þe se sa3tled þer-*with*, as sone as ho mozt.
 Þenne þa3 her takel were torne, þat totered on yþe3,
 Styffe stremes & stre3t hem strayned a whyle,
 Þat drof hem dry3lych adoun þe depe to serue,
 236 Tyl a swetter ful swyþe hem swe3ed to bonk.
 Þer wat3 louyng on lofte, when þay þe londe wonnen,
 To oure mercyable god, on moyses wyse,
 96 With sacrafyse vp-set, & solempne vowes,
 240 & graunted hym vn-to be god & graythly non oþer;
 Þa3 þay be Iolef for loye, Ionas 3et dredes,
 Þa3 he nolde suffer no sore, his seele is on anter;
 For what-so worped of þat wy3e, fro he *in* water dipped,
 244 Hit were a wonder to wene, 3if holy wryt nere.

WHALE SWALLOWS JONAH.

III.

- Now is ionas þe Iwe Iugged to drowne;
 Of þat schended schyp men schowued hym sone.
 A wylde walterande whal, as wyrde þen schaped,
 248 Þat wat3 beten fro þe abyne, bi þat bot flotte,
 & wat3 war of þat wy3e þat þe water so3te,
 & swyftely swenged hym to swepe & his swol3 opened;
 Þe folk 3et haldande his fete þe fysch hym tyd hentes,
 252 *With*-outen towche of any tothe he tult *in* his prote.
 Thenne he swenge3 & swayues to þe se boþem,
 Bi mony rokke3 ful ro3e & rydelande strondes,
 Wyth þe mon *in* his mawe, malskred *in* drede.
 256 As lyttel wonder hit wat3 3if he wo dre3ed,
 For nade þe hy3e heuen kyng, þur3 his honde myzt,
 Warded þis wrech man *in* warlowes gutte3,
 What lede mozt lyue bi lawe of any kynde,
 260 Þat any lyf myzt be lent so longe hym *with*-inne?
 Bot he wat3 sokored by þat syre þat syttes so hi3e,
 Þa3 were waule3 of wele, *in* wombe of þat fische,
 & also dryuen þur3 þe depe, & *in* derk waltre3.
 264 Lorde! colde wat3 his cumfort & his care huge,
 For he knew vche a cace & kark þat hym lymped;

He proves to them that he was guilty.

The mariners are exceedingly frightened.

They try to make way with the oars,

but their endeavours are useless

Jonah must be doomed to death

They pray to God,

that they may not shed innocent blood.

Jonah is cast overboard.

out-tulde] *out-tulte* (?).

The tempest ceases and the sea settles.

The stiff streams drive the ship about.

serue] *sterue* (?).

At last they reach a bank.

The seamen thank God,
and perform solemn vows.

Jonah is in great dread.

Jonah is shoved from the ship.

to] MS. to to.

[Fol. 8

A wild whale swims by the boat

He opens his swallow,

and seizes the prophet.

swayues] *swaynes* (?).

It is not to be wondered at that
Jonah suffered woe.

waule3] *wanle3* (?).

The prophet is without hope.

Cold was his comfort.

- How fro þe bot *in-to* þe blober wat3 *with* a best lachched,
 & þrwe *in* at hit þrote, *with-uten* þret more,
 268 As mote *in* at a munster dor, so mukel wern his chawle3,
 He glydes *in* by þe giles, þur3 glaymande glette,
 Relande *in* by a rop, a rode þat hym þo3t,
 Ay hele ouer hed, hourlande aboute,
 272 Til he blunt *in* a blok as brod as a halle;
 97 & þer he festnes þe fete & fathme3 aboute,
 & stod vp *in* his stomak, þat stank as þe deuel;
 Þer *in* saym & *in* sor3e þat sauoured as helle,
 276 Þer wat3 bylded his bour, þat wyl no bale suffer;
 & þenne he lurkkes & laytes where wat3 le best,
 In vche a nok of his nauel, bot nowhere he fynde3
 No rest ne recouerer, bot ramelande myre,
 280 In wych gut so euer he got3; bot euer is god swete;
 & þer he lenged at þe last & to þe lede called.
 “Now prynce, of þy prophete pité þou haue!
 Þa3 I be fol, & fykel, & falce of my hert,
 284 De-woyde now þy vengauce, þur3 vertu of rauthe;
 Tha3 I be gulty of gyle as gaule of prophetes,
 Þou art god, & alle gowde3 ar graybely þyn owen;
 Haf now mercy of þy man & his mys-dedes,
 288 & preue þe lyztly a lorde, *in* londe & *in* water.”
 With þat he hitte to a hyrne & helde hym þer-inne,
 Þer no de-foule of no fylþe wat3 fest hym abute;
 Þer he sete also sounde, saf for merk one,
 292 As *in* þe bulk of þe bote, þer he by-fore sleped.
 So in a bouel of þat best he bide3 on lyue,
 Þre dayes & þ[r]e ny3t ay þenkande on dry3tyn,
 His my3t & his merci, his mesure þenne;
 296 Now he knawe3 hym *in* care þat coupe not *in* sele.

LE WANDERS ABOUT.

- Ande euer walteres þis whal bi wyldren depe,
 þur3 mony a regioun ful ro3e, þur3 ronk of his wylle,
 For þat mote *in* his mawe mad hym, I trowe,
 300 Þa3 hit lyttel were, hym wyth to wamel at his hert,
 Ande assayled þe segge; ay sykerly he herde
 þe bygge borne on his bak & bete on his sydes;
 Þen a prayer ful prest þe prophete þer maked
 304 On þis wyse, as I wene, his worde3 were mony:

AYS FOR HIS DELIVERANCE.

- “Lorde to þe haf I cleped, *in* care3 ful stronge,
 Out of þe hole þou me herde, of hellen wombe
 98 I calde, & þou knew myn vncler steuen;
 308 Þou dipte3 me of þe depe se, *in-to* þe dymme hert,
 þe grete flem of þy flod folded me vmbe;
 Alle þe gote3 of þy guferes, & groundele3 powle3,
 & þy stryuande streme3 of strynde3 so mony,
 312 *In* on daschande dam, dryue3 me ouer;
 & 3et I say, as I seet *in* þe se boþem,

þrwe] *þrwen* (?).

Jonah was only a mote in the whale's jaws.

He entered in by the gills, and means of one of the intestines the fish, came into a space as large as a hall.

The prophet fixes his feet firm in the belly of the whale.

He searches into every nook o navel.

The prophet calls upon God.

[Fol. 8

He cries for mercy.

He sits safely in a recess,

in a bowel of the beast,
 for three days and three nights

The whale passes through mar rough region.

Jonah makes the whale feel sic

The prophet prays to God in th wise:

“Lord! to thee have I cried out hell's womb.

Thou dippedst me in the sea.
 Thy great floods passed over r

The streams drive over me.

IV.

‘Care-ful am I kest out fro þy cler yȝen
 & deseuered fro þy syȝt; ȝet surely I hope,
 316 Efte to trede on þy temple & teme to þy seluen.’
 I am wrapped *in water* to my wo stoundeȝ,
 Þe abyme byndes þe body þat I byde inne;
 Þe pure poplande *hourle* playes on my heued,
 320 To laste mere of vche a mount man am I fallen;
 Þe barreȝ of vche a bonk ful bigly me haldes,
 þat I may lachche no *lont* & þou my lyf weldes;
 Þou schal releue me renk, whil þy ryȝt slepeȝ,
 324 Þurȝ myȝt of þy mercy þat mukel is to tryste.
 For when þacces of anguych watȝ hid *in* my sawle,
 Þenne I remembred me ryȝt of my rych lorde,
 Prayande him for peté his prophete to here,
 328 þat in-to his holy hous myn orisoun moȝt entre.
 I haf *meled with* þy maystres mony longe day,
 Bot now I wot wyterly, þat þose vnwyse ledes
 þat affyen *hym in* vanyté & *in* vayne þynges,
 332 For *þink* þat mountes to noȝt, her mercy forsaken;
 Bot I dewoutly awowe þat verray betȝ halden,
 Soberly to do þe sacrafyse when I schal saue worþe,
 & offer þe for my hele a ful hol gyfte,
 336 & halde goud þat þou me hetes; haf here my traute.”

LE VOMITS UP JONAH.

99 Thenne oure fader to þe fysch ferslych biddeȝ,
 þat he hym sput spakly vpon *spare drye*;
 Þe whal wendeȝ at his wylle & a warþe fyndeȝ,
 340 & þer he brakeȝ vp þe buyrne, as bede hym oure lorde.
 Þenne he swepe to þe sonde *in sluchched* clopes,
 Hit may wel be þat mester were his mantyle to wasche;
 Þe bonk þat he blosched to & bode hym bisyde,
 344 Wern of þe regiounes ryȝt þat he renayed hade;
 Þenne a wynde of goddeȝ worde efte þe wyȝe *bruxleȝ*,
 “Nylt þou neuer to nuniue bi no-kynneȝ wayeȝ?”
 “Ȝisse lorde,” *quod* þe lede, “lene me þy grace
 348 For to go at þi gre, me gayneȝ *non* oþer.”
 “Ris, aproche þen to prech, lo þe place here!
 Lo! my lore is *in* þe *loke*, lance hit þer-inne.”
 Þenne þe renk radly ros as he myȝt,
 352 & to niniue þat naȝt he neȝed ful euen;
 Hit watȝ a ceté ful syde & selly of brede,
 On to þrenge þer-þurȝe watȝ þre dayes dede.

PHET PREACHES AGAINST NINEVEH.

þat on Iournay ful Ioynt Ionas hym ȝede,
 356 Er euer he warpped any worde to wyȝe þat he mette,
 & þenne he cryed so cler, þat kenne myȝt alle;
 Þe trwe tenor of his teme he tolde on þis wyse:
 “Ȝet schal forty dayeȝ fully fare to an ende,
 360 & þenne schal Niniue be nomen & to noȝt worþe;
 Truly þis ilk toun schal tylte to grounde,
 Vp-so-doun schal ȝe *dumpe* depe to þe abyme,
 To be swolȝed swyftly wyth þe swart erþe,
 364 & alle þat lyuyes here-inne *lose* þe swete.”

I am cast out from thy sight.

The abyss binds me.

[Fol. 8

The rushing waves play on my head.

lont] *lond* (?).

Thou possessest my life.

In my anguish I remembered r
God,

and besought His pity.

hym] *hem* (?).

þink] *þing* (?).

When I am delivered from this danger,

I will obey thy commands.”

God speaks fiercely to the whale
and he vomits out the prophet
a dry space.

Jonah has need to wash his
clothes.

God’s word comes to the prophet

non] MS. *mon*.

He is told to preach in Nineveh

loke] *loken* (?).

By night Jonah reaches the city
Nineveh was a very great city.

[Fol. 8

Jonah delivers his message;

“Yet forty days and Nineveh shall
come to an end.

It shall be turned upside down
and swallowed quickly by the
black earth.”

Bis speche sprang in þat space & spradde alle aboute,
 To borges & to bacheleres, þat in þat burȝ lenged;
 Such a hidor hem bent & a hatel drede,
 368 Þat al chaunged her chere & chylled at þe hert.
 Þe segge sesed not ȝet, bot sayde euer ilyche
 “Þe verray vengauce of god schal voyde þis place.”
 Þenne þe peple pitosly pleyned ful styлле,
 372 & for þe drede of dryȝtyn doured in hert;
Heter hayreȝ þay hent þat asperly bited,
 & þose þay bounden to her bak & to her bare sydeȝ,
 Dropped dust on her hede & dymly bisoȝten,
 376 Þat þat penaunce plesed him þat playneȝ on her wronge.
 & ay he cryes in þat kyth tyl þe kyng herde;
 & he radly vp-ros & ran fro his chayer,
 100 His ryche robe he to-rof of his rigge naked,
 380 & of a hep of askes he hitte in þe myddeȝ;
 He askeȝ heterly a hayre & hasped hym vmbe,
 Sewed a sekke þer abof, & syked ful colde;
 Þer he dased in þat duste, *with* droppande teres,
 384 Wepande ful wonderly alle his wrange dedes.
 Þenne sayde he to his seriauntes, “samnes yow bilyue,
 Do dryue out a decre demed of my seluen,
 Þat alle þe bodyes þat ben *with-inne* þis borȝ quyke,
 388 Boȝe burnes & bestes, burdeȝ & childer,
 Vch prynce, vche prest & prelates alle,
 Alle faste frely for her falce werkes;
 Seseȝ childer of her sok, soghe hem so neuer,
 392 Ne best bite on no brom, ne no bent nauȝer,
 Passe to no pasture, ne pike non erbes,
 Ne non oxe to no hay, ne no horse to water;
 Al schal crye for-clemmed, *with* alle oure clere strenȝe,
 396 Þe rurd schal ryse to hym þat rawȝe schal haue;
 What wote oȝer wyte may ȝif þe wyȝe lykes,
 Þat is hende in þe hyȝt of his gentryse?
 I wot his myȝt is so much, þaȝ he be mysse-payed,
 400 Þat in his mylde amesyng he mercy may fynde;
 & if we leuen þe layk of oure layth symnes,
 & styлле steppen in þe styȝe he styȝtleȝ hym seluen,
 He wyl wende of his wodschip, & his wrath leue,
 404 & for-gif *vus* þis gult ȝif we hym god leuen.”
 Þenne al leued on his lawe & laften her symnes,
 Par-formed alle þe penaunce þat þe prynce radde;
 & god þurȝ his godnesse forgef as he sayde,
 408 Þaȝ he oȝer bihyȝt, [*&*] *with*-helde his vengauce.

ERCY DISPLEASES JONAH.

V.

Muche sorȝe þenne sattede vpon segge Ionas,
 He wex as wroth as þe wynde towarde oure lorde,
 So hatȝ anger onhit his hert; he calleȝ
 412 A prayer to þe hyȝe prynce, for pyne, on þys wyse:
 101 “I biseche þe syre now þou self iugge,
 Watȝ not þis ilk my worde þat worþen is nouȝe,

This speech spreads throughout the city.

Great fear seizes all.

The people mourn secretly,

clothe themselves in sackcloth

and cast ashes upon their head

The message reaches the ears of the king.

He rends his robes,

clothes himself in sackcloth,

and mourns in the dust.

He issues a decree,

that all in the city, men, beasts, women and children, prince, priest, and prelates,

should fast for their sins.

[Fol. 8

Children are to be weaned from the breast.

The ox is to have no hay, nor the horse any water.

Who can tell if God will have mercy?

Though He is mighty,

He is merciful,

and may forgive us our guilt.

All believed and repented.

God forgave them through his goodness.

Much sorrow settles upon Jonah

He becomes very angry.

He prays to God and says:

“Was not this my saying, when Thy message reached me in me?”

þat I kest *in* my cuntre, when þou þy carp sendeþ,
 416 þat I schulde tee to þys toun, þi talent to preche?
 Wel knew I þi cortaysye, þy quoynt soffraunce.
 Þy bounté of debonerté & þy bene *grace*,
 Þy longe abydyng wyth *lur*, þy late vengauce,
 420 & ay þy mercy is mete, be mysse neuer so huge.
 I wyst wel when I hade worded quatsoeuer I cowþe,
 To manace alle þise mody men þat *in* þis mote dowelleþ,
 Wyth a prayer & a pyne þay myzt her pese gete,
 424 & þer-fore I wolde haf flowen fer *in-to* tarce.
 Now lorde lach out my lyf, hit lastes to longe,
 Bed me bilyue my *bale stour*, & bryng me on ende,
 For me were swetter to swelt, as swyþe as me þynk,
 428 Þen lede lenger þi lore, þat þus me les makeþ.”
 Þe soun of oure souerayn þen swey *in* his ere,
 þat vpbraydes þis burne vpon a breme wyse:
 “Herk renk! is þis ryzt so ronkly to wrath,
 432 For any dede þat I haf don *oper* demed þe 3et?”
 Ionas al Ioyles & Ianglande vp-ryses
 & haldeþ out on est half of þe hyze place,
 & farandely on a felde he fetteleþ hym to bide,
 436 For to wayte on þat won what schulde worþe after.
 Þer he busked hym a *bour*, þe best þat he myzt,
 Of hay & of euer-ferne & erbeþ a fewe,
 For hit watþ playn *in* þat place for plyande greueþ,
 440 For to schylde fro þe schene, *oper* any schade keste.
 He bowed vnder his lyttel boþe, his bak to þe sunne,
 & þer he swowed & slept sadly al nyzt,

SHELTERED BY A WOODBINE.

Þe whyle god of his grace ded growe of þat soyle,
 444 Þe fayrest bynde hym abof þat euer burne wyste.
 When þe dawande day dryztyn con sende,
 Þenne wakened þe wyþ vnder wodbynde,
 Loked alofte on þe lef þat lylled grene;
 448 Such a *lefsel* of lof neuer lede hade,
 102 For hit watþ brod at þe boþem, boztet onlofte,
 Happed vpon ayþer half a hous as hit were,
 A nos on þe norþ syde & nowhere non elleþ,
 452 Bot al schet *in* a schaze þat schaded ful cole.
 Þe gome glyzt on þe grene *graciouse* leues,
 þat euer wayued a wynde so wyþe & so cole;
 Þe schyre sunne hit vmbe-schon, þaþ no schafte myzt
 456 Þe mountaunce of a lyttel mote, vpon þat man schyne,
 Þenne watþ þe gome so glad of his gay logge,
 Lys loltrande þer-*inne*, lokande to toun,
 So blyþe of his wodbynde he balteres þer vnde[r],
 460 þat of no diete þat day þe *deuel* haf, he rozt;
 & euer he lazed as he loket þe loge alle aboute,
 & wysched hit were *in* his kyth, þer he wony schulde,
 On heze vpon Effraym *oper* ermomes hilleþ,
 464 “I-wysse a worþloker won to welde I neuer keped.”
 & quen hit nezed to naþt nappe hym bihoued;
 He slydeþ on a sloumbe, slep sloghe vnder leues,
 Whil god wayned a worme þat wrot vpe þe rote,

own country?

I knew Thy great goodness,

Thy long-suffering,
and Thy mercy.

I knew these men might make
their peace with Thee,
therefore I fled unto Tarshish.
Take my life from me, O Lord

[Fol. 8

It is better for me to die than
live.”

God upbraids Jonah, saying:
“Is this right to be so wroth?”

Jonah, jangling, uprises,

and makes himself a bower,
of hay and ever-fern,

to shield him from the sun.

He slept heavily all night.

God prepared a woodbine.

Jonah awakes, and is exceedin
glad of the bower.

The prophet, under its graciou
leaves,

is protected from the sun’s ray

þe] *de* altered to þe.

Jonah wishes he had such a lo
in his own country.

[Fol. 8

468 & wyddered wat3 þe wodbynde bi þat þe wy3e wakned;
 & syþen he warne3 þe west to waken ful softe,
 & saye3 vnte 3eferus þat he syfle warme,
 þat þer quikken no cloude bi-fore þe cler sunne,
 472 & ho schal busch vp ful brode & brenne as a candel.
 þen wakened þe wy3e of his wyl dremes,
 & blusched to his wodbynde þat broþely wat3 marred,
 Al welwed & wasted þo worþelych leues;
 476 þe schyre sunne hade hem schent, er euer þe schalk wist,
 & þen hef vp þe hete & heterly brenned;
 þe warm wynde of þe weste wertes he swyþe3.

NTS ITS DESTRUCTION.

þe man marred on þe molde þat mozt hym not hyde,
 480 His wodbynde wat3 away, he weped for sor3e,
 "With hatel anger & hot, heterly he calle3:
 A! þou maker of man, what maystery þe þynke3
 þus þy freke to forfare forbi alle oþer,
 103 484 With alle meschef þat þou may, neuer þou me spare3?
 I keuered me a cumfort þat now is ca3t fro me,
 My wod-bynde so wlonk þat wered my heued,
 Bot now I se þou art sette my solace to reue;
 488 Why ne dy3tte3 þou me to di3e; I dure to longe?"
 3et oure lorde to þe lede lanced a speche:
 "Is þis ry3t-wys þou renk, alle þy ronk noyse,
 So wroth for a wodbynde to wax so sone,
 492 Why art þou so waymot wy3e for so lyttel?"
 "Hit is not lyttel," *quod* þe lede, "bot lykker to ry3t,
 I wolde I were of þis worlde wrapped in molde3."
 "Þenne byþenk þe mon, if þe for-þynk sore,
 496 If I wolde help my honde werk, haf þou no wonder;
 þou art waxen so wroth for þy wod-bynde,
 & trauaylede3 neuer to tent hit þe tyme of an howre,
 Bot at a wap hit here wax & away at an oþer,
 500 & 3et lyke3 þe so luþer, þi lyf wolde3 þou tyne;

IFIES HIS MERCY AND FORBEARANCE.

Þenne wyte not me for þe werk þat I hit wolde help,
 & rwe on þo redles þat remen for synne.
 Fyrst I made hem myself of materes myn one,
 504 & syþen I loked hem ful longe & hem on lode hade;
 & if I my trauayl schulde tyne of *termes* so longe,
 & type down 3onder toun when hit turned were,
 þe sor of such a swete place burde synk to my hert,
 508 So mony malicious mon as mourne3 þer-inne;
 & of þat somme 3et arn summe such sotte3 for madde,
 As lyttel barne3 on barme þat neuer bale wro3t,
 & wymmen vnwytté þat wale ne couþe
 512 þat on hande fro þat oþer for alle þis hy3e worlde,
 Bitwene þe stele & þe stayre disserne no3t cunen,
 What rule renes in roun bitwene þe ry3t hande
 & his lyfte, þa3 his lyf schulde lost be þer-for;
 516 & als þer ben doumbe beste3 in þe bur3 mony,
 þat may not synne in no syt hem seluen to greue,

God prepared a worm,
 that made the woodbine wither:
 vnte] vnto (?).

Jonah awakes and finds his
 woodbine destroyed.

The leaves were all faded.

The sun beat upon the head of
 Jonah.

He is exceedingly angry,

and prays God that he may die
 God rebukes the prophet.

"Dost thou well," He says, "to
 angry for the gourd?"

Jonah replies, "I would I were
 dead."

God asks if it is to be wondere
 that He should help His handy
 work.

Is not Jonah angry that his
 woodbine is destroyed, which
 him no labour?

[Fol. 8

God is not to be blamed for tal
 pity upon people that He made

Should He destroy Nineveh th
 sorrow of such a sweet place
 would sink to His heart.

In the city there are little bairn
 who have done no wrong.

for] MS. fol.

And there are others who cann
 discern between their right har
 and their left hand.

There are also dumb beasts in
 city incapable of sinning.

- Why schulde I wrath wyth hem, syþen wyȝeȝ wyl torne,
& *cum* & cawe me for kyng, & my carpe leue? *cum] Or cun.*
- 104 520 Wer I as hastif a[s] þou, heere were harme lumpen,
Couþe I not þole bot as þou þer þryued ful fewe;
I may not be so mal[i]cious & mylde be halden,
For malyse is noȝ[t] to mayntyne boutte mercy *withinne*;
524 Be noȝt so gryndel god man, bot go forth þy wayes.”
Be preue & be pacient, *in* payne & *in* loye,
For he þat is to *rakel* to renden his cloþeȝ,
Mot efte sitte *with* more vn-sounde to sewe hem togeder.
528 For-þy when pouerté me enpreceȝ & payneȝ *in*-noȝe,
Ful softly *with* suffraunce saȝttel me bihoueȝ,
For þe penaunce & payne to preue hit *in* syȝt,
Þat pacience is a nobel poynt, þaȝ hit displese ofte. Amen.
- Judgment must be tempered w
mercy.
He that is too hasty to rend his
clothes must afterwards sit wit
worse ones to sew them togeth
Poverty and pain must be
endured.
Patience is a noble point, thou
it displeases oft.

115

NOTES TO PATIENCE.

All Notes were originally printed here, between *Patience* and the Glossarial Index. The Notes for *The Pearl* and *Cleanness* come immediately after their respective poems.

- Page 89. 1. 3 *þe swelme leþe*, lessen the heat.
4 *qued*, evil.
5 *syt*, sorrow; *sele*, happiness.
6 *pro*, anger.
7 *þen* is better to abyde þe bur vmbe-stoundes,
Then is it better to abide the blow sometimes.
10 *melede*, related.
11 *aȝt*, eight.
12 *sunder-lupes*, severally.
13 *happen*, blessed.
- P. 90. 1. 30 *lyknyng*, likeness; *þewes*, virtues.
42 *lyke oþer greme*, pleasing or displeasing.
47 *lyȝtloker*, more easily; *lotes*, forms.
50 *what dowes me þe dedayn*, what avails me anger.
53 *grayþed*, availed.
56 *þe(t) had bowed*, etc., That should have been obedient.
- P. 91. 1. 63 *Goddes glam to hym glod*, God's message came to him.
66 *wythouten oþer speche*, without contradiction, without more words.
67 *my saȝes soghe*, etc., my saws (words) sow, etc.
77 *typped schrewes*, great sinners; literally, extreme, tip-top, schrews.
78 *ta me*, take me, seize me.
82 *mansed*, cursed.
94 *glwande*, glowing, bright; *gloumbes*, sees (indistinctly).
- P. 92. 1. 98 *to the fare*, to the voyage.
101 *tramme*, gear.
104 *Sprude spak to þe sprete þe spare bawlyne*,
Spread quickly to the sprit the spar bowline (?).

- 106 *ladde-borde*, larboard.
- 107 *blype brepe*, gentle wind; *bosum*, tide.
- 108 *He* refers to *brepe*.
- 112 *mazt*, might; *mere*, sea.
- 115 *wenyng*, supposition.
- 117 *burde*, behoved.
- 119 *demed*, uttered.
- 122 *stapefole* = *stapeful* = high (?)

- P. 93. l. 131 *crafte*, power.
 135 *tom*, interval.
 140 *souzed*, sobbed, moaned; *selly*, marvel.
 141 *wonne*, pale.
 143 *busched* = *busked*, went.
 144 *for roȝ* = for roughness.
 148 *bur* = wave.
 150 *to murte*, (?) *to-marte*, crushed, broken in pieces.
 152 *coge*, boat.
 155 *scapel*, hurtful, dangerous.
 156 *lode* = *lote*, lot.
 160 *lepe*, calm, quiet.
 161 *lot*, noise, roar.
- P. 94. l. 173 *I lovne*, I offer (this advice), propose.
 183 *flode lotes*, the noises of the flood.
 184 *brede*, board.
 185 *hurrok*, oar.
 191 *runyschly*, fiercely.
 192 *slazte*, strokes.
 198 *lastes*, crimes.
- P. 95. l. 208 *at a worde one*, at a word alone.
 213 *ossed*, showed, proved; *vnnynge*s, signs.
 216 *ruyt*, rush, hasten.
 227 *balelez*, innocent.
 229 *synne*, after.
- P. 96. l. 247 *as wyrde þen schaped*, as fate then devised.
 255 *malskred*, entranced, bewildered.
 258 *warlowes*, monster's.
 259 *lyue* = *leue*, believe.
 262 *wauleȝ* = shelterless, destitute, but *wanleȝ* = *wonleȝ* = hopeless, is perhaps a better reading.
 268 *chawleȝ*, jaws.
 269 *glaymande glette*, slimy mud.
 270 *rop*, gut, intestine.
- P. 97. l. 273 *fabmeȝ*, gropes.
 275 *saym*, fat, grease.
 277 *le*, shelter.
 291 *merk*, darkness.
 292 *bulk*, stern.

302 *borne* = *burne*, man.

P. 98. 1. 309 *flem* = *flum*, stream.

317 *to my wo stoundez* = ? until my woe over-powers (confounds) me.

320 *to laste* ? to the last; *mere*, boundary.

325 *pacces*, blows.

329 *meled*, conversed.

338 *spare drye dry spar* (rafter) but ? *spare* = *space*.

339 *a warthe*, a ford.

341 *sluchched* = *sluched*, dirty, muddy.

342 *mester*, need.

116 P. 99. 1. 345 *bruxlez*, reproaches, upbraids,

350 *loke* = *loken*, fastened.

362 *dumpe*, be thrust.

364 *swete*, life; *to lose þe swete* = to lose the (sweet) life.

372 *doured*, mourned, grieved. Cf. Sc. *dour*.

373 *Heter hayrez þay hent*, etc., rough hair shirts they took, etc.

P. 100. 1. 395 *for-clemmed*, very hungry, starved.

396 *rurd*, cry.

400 *amesyng* = *mesyng* = *mese*, pity, mercy.

403 *wodschip*, wrath.

411 *on-hit*, struck or inflamed (?); *callez*, addresses.

P. 101. 1. 418 *bene*, bountiful, kind.

419 *hur*, loss.

426 *bale-stour*, death-pang; *bale* in the sense of death is not very common.

447 *lylled*, flourished.

448 *lefsel* = *leaf-bower*. See Glossary.

P. 102. 1. 449 *bozted*, curved.

450 *happed*, covered.

451 *a nos* = a projection, opening (?) or is it a clerical error for *abof* = *above*.

452 *schaze* = wood, shaw.

453 *glyzt*, glanced.

460 *þe deuel* ? *ded euel*, did evil.

470 *syfle*, blow.

473 *wyl*, wandering.

478 *wertes he swyþez*, herbs he scorches.

P. 103. 1. 486 *wered*, protected.

489 *lansed*, uttered.

492 *waymot* = angry, passionate.

502 *remen*, mourn, lament.

509 *soumme*, company.

P. 104. 1. 524 *gryndel*, angry.

526 *rakel*, hasty.